

WHITFIELD COUNTY GEORGIA



Annual Comprehensive Financial Report

For the Year Ended December 31, 2025

Prepared by Finance Department

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

ANNUAL COMPREHENSIVE FINANCIAL REPORT

*FOR THE
YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 2025*



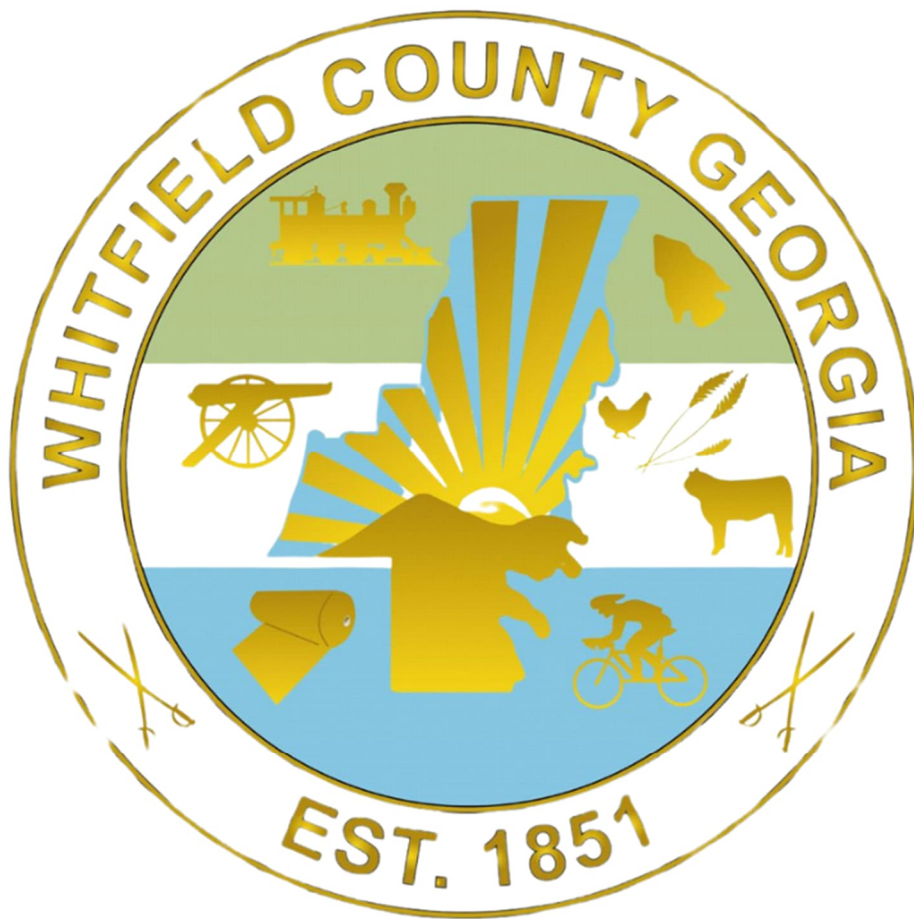
JEVIN JENSEN
CHAIRMAN

Prepared by the Whitfield County Finance Department

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Part I

Introductory Section



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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
ANNUAL COMPREHENSIVE FINANCIAL REPORT
For the year ended December 31, 2025

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Government Finance Officers Association

Certificate of
Achievement
for Excellence
in Financial
Reporting

Presented to

**Whitfield County
Georgia**

For its Annual Comprehensive
Financial Report
For the Fiscal Year Ended

December 31, 2024

Executive Director/CEO

Whitfield County, Georgia
General Government Officials
December 31, 2025

Legislative

Board of Commissioners

Jevin Jensen, Chairman

Barry W. Robbins, District 1

John Thomas District 3

Robbie Staten, District 2

Greg Jones, District 4

Executive

Administration

Robert Sivick - County Administrator

Blanca Cardona - County Clerk

Department Heads

Debbie Godfrey - Finance

Jackie Carlo - Human Recourses

Rick Lovelady - Information Technology

Charles Fetzer - Buildings and Grounds

Paul Patterson Sr. - Fire Department

David Metcalf - Emergency Services/911

Brian Chastain - Parks and Recreation

Whitney Dunn – Animal Shelter

Kent Benson - County Engineer

Kristi Queen - Chief Appraiser

Shaynee Bryson - Elections Supervisor

George Souther - Juvenile Court Judge

Mary Hammontree - Senior Center

Amanda McCoy - Public Defender

Jean Price-Garland - Zoning Enforcement

Valeria Molina - Public Relations

Diane Franklin - Transit

Constitutional Officers

Darren Pierce - Sheriff

Babs Bailey - Clerk of Court

Sherri Blevins - Probate Court Judge

Danny W. Sane - Tax Commissioner

Other Elected Officials

Christopher Griffin - Chief Magistrate Court Judge

Thomas Phillips - Magistrate Court Judge

Bradley Scott Martin - Magistrate Court Judge

Rodney Weaver - Magistrate Court Judge

Clyde McDaniel Jr. - Coroner

Benjamin Kenemer - District Attorney

Cindy Morris - Chief Superior Court Judge

Bert Poston - Superior Court Judge

Jim Wilbanks - Superior Court Judge

Scott Minter - Superior Court Judge

December 31, 2025



Whitfield County

Board of Commissioners



Board Members
Jevin Jensen, Chairman
Robby Staten
Greg Jones
Barry Robbins
John Thomas

June 26, 2026

The Honorable Jevin Jensen, Chairman
Members of the Board of Commissioners
and Citizens of Whitfield County, Georgia

State law requires that all general-purpose local governments publish within six months of the close of each fiscal year, unless an extension has been approved, a complete set of financial statements presented in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles (GAAP) and audited in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards by a firm of licensed certified public accountants. Pursuant to that requirement, we hereby issue the annual comprehensive financial report of Whitfield County for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2025.

This report consists of management's representations concerning the finances of Whitfield County. Consequently, management assumes full responsibility for the completeness and reliability of all the information presented in this report. To provide a reasonable basis for making these representations, management of Whitfield County has established a comprehensive internal control framework that is designed both to protect the government's assets from loss, theft, or misuse and to compile sufficient reliable information for the preparation of the Whitfield County financial statements in conformity with GAAP. Because the cost of internal controls should not outweigh their benefits, the Whitfield County comprehensive framework of internal controls has been designed to provide reasonable, rather than absolute, assurance that the financial statements will be free from material misstatement. As management, we assert that to the best of our knowledge and belief this financial report is complete and reliable in all material respects.

Whitfield County's financial statements were audited by Rushton, LLC, a firm of licensed certified public accountants. The goal of the independent audit was to provide reasonable assurance that the financial statements of Whitfield County for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2025 were free of material misstatement. The independent audit involved examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements; assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management; and evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. The independent auditor concluded, based upon the audit, that there was a reasonable basis for rendering an unmodified opinion that the Whitfield County financial statements for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2025 were fairly presented in conformity with GAAP. The independent auditor's report is presented as the first component of the financial section of this report.

GAAP require that management provide a narrative introduction, overview, and analysis to accompany the basic financial statements in the form of Management's Discussion and Analysis (MD&A). This letter of transmittal is designed to complement MD&A and should be read in conjunction with it. Whitfield County's MD&A can be found immediately following the report of the independent auditors.

Overview of the Annual Comprehensive Financial Report

The Annual Comprehensive Financial Report is presented in three sections: Introductory, Financial, and Statistical. The Introductory Section includes this letter of transmittal; a list of Whitfield County's principal officials, department directors and elected officials, and organizational chart. The Financial Section includes management's discussion and analysis, basic financial statements and schedules, as well as the independent auditor's report on these financial statements and schedules. The Statistical Section includes selected financial and demographic information, generally presented on a multi-year basis.

Reporting Entity

The financial reporting entity (Whitfield County, Georgia) includes all of the funds of the primary government, as well as all of its component units. Component units are legally separate entities for which the primary government is financially accountable. Blended component units, although legally separate entities, are, in substance, part of the primary government's operations and are therefore also included as part of the primary government. Based on the blended component unit criteria, no blended component units are included in this report.

Discretely presented component units are reported as a separate column in the combined financial statements to emphasize that they are legally separate from the primary government and to differentiate their financial position, results of operations and cash flows from the primary government. The Whitfield County Department of Public Health is included as a discretely presented component unit.

Profile of the Government

Whitfield County is located in the northwestern portion of Georgia. Considered to be the economic hub of the region, it occupies a land area of 290 square miles and serves an estimated population of 106,212. The County is empowered to levy a property tax on both real and personal properties located within its boundaries. Formed from a portion of Murray County in 1851 - making it Georgia's 97th county - it was named for the Reverend George Whitefield, the founder of the Bethesda Orphan House in Savannah. The spelling of the county's name was later changed to reflect its pronunciation.

Located at the foothills of the Appalachian Mountains, the County is blessed with natural beauty and a mild climate. It also is the gateway to the 150 miles long Chieftain's Trail, which traces the path of the Cherokee Indian sites, located in the Northwest Georgia area. Dalton/Whitfield County is, additionally, known as the "Floor Covering Capital of the World". Being located in 'Auto Alley' on Interstate 75, only 25 miles south of Chattanooga and 85 miles north of Atlanta, Whitfield is also a prime location for business expansion, relocation and economic development. This places the County within a day's drive of half the country's population, making it a great location for distribution.

The County has been operating under a Board-Administrator form of government since 1971. Policy-making and legislative authority are vested in the Board of Commissioners consisting of a Chairman elected at-large and four commissioners from four separate districts, elected by district on a partisan basis. The Chairman and Commissioners serve four-year staggered terms. The Board of Commissioners are responsible for passing ordinances, adopting the budget, appointing committees, and hiring the government's administrator, attorney and auditors, among other duties. The County Administrator is responsible for carrying out the policies and ordinances of the Board of Commissioners, for overseeing the day-to-day operations of the government, and for the hiring/dismissing of the Directors of various departments under the Board of Commissioners.

A full range of services, including police protection via the Sheriff's Office, maintenance of roads and other infrastructure, inspections and enforcement, court services, jail, 911, fire protection, animal control, parks and recreation, emergency management, planning and zoning, storm water management, transit bus operations, and a Senior Center are provided.

The annual budget serves as the foundation for Whitfield County's financial planning and control. In accordance with state law, an operating budget consistent with generally accepted accounting principles is adopted annually after required public notices and hearings. The final appropriated budget is adopted no later than December 31st and is prepared by fund and department. The legal level of budgetary control (the level at which expenditures may not legally exceed appropriations without approval of the governing body) is established at the department level for the General Fund, and the functional level for all other annually budgeted governmental funds. Transfers of appropriations that would revise the total budget at these levels require approval of the Board of Commissioners, while management may approve transfers within these levels in accordance with County policy. Budget-to-actual comparisons are provided for each individual governmental fund for which an appropriated annual budget has been adopted. Annual appropriated budgets are adopted on a basis consistent with generally accepted accounting principles for the general fund, debt service fund, and all special revenue funds. Annual operating budgets are not legally required for enterprise funds, but are prepared for use in planning, control, and evaluation purposes.

Factors Affecting Financial Conditions

Information presented in the financial statements is best understood when it is considered from the broader perspective of the specific environment within which the County operates.

For decades, Dalton/Whitfield County has been known as the "Floor Covering Capital of the World." However, recent community and economic development planning processes in Whitfield County have consistently arrived at a fundamental conclusion: in order to realize a sustainable economic future, the County must diversify its local economy. Specifically, studies have repeatedly concluded that the community is highly dependent on a single business sector: the carpet and flooring industry. The Board of Commissioners, along with the Joint Development Authority and other County-based municipalities, recognize the need for a more diversified local economy and thus, the necessity of recruiting new businesses to the area. The Dalton/Whitfield County Joint Development Authority (DWJDA) focuses on economic growth of the community by attracting and retaining jobs, diverse investments, and growing the tax base. Dalton's economic development policies are implemented by the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority (DWJDA). The DWJDA targets manufacturing, automotive, plastics/chemical, and food processing industries due to the area's skilled work force, water-rich community, and physical location.

In 2025, the community continued to experience meaningful economic development activity through both new investment and the restructuring of existing incentive agreements. Major activity included projects related to CoreWeave, Core Scientific, Blue Links 128 LLC, Blue Links 342 LLC, and Cameron Brickyard. These projects represent a mix of real estate, industrial equipment, and technology infrastructure investment, with several incentive schedules beginning in 2026.

The year also included updates to existing bond and incentive structures, including replacement schedules for Blue Links 128 LLC and Blue Links 342 LLC, as well as updates to Core Scientific's Industrial South project. These changes support accurate long-term incentive compliance, reporting, and billing while reflecting continued private investment in the community. Overall, 2025 activity demonstrated continued interest in Dalton-Whitfield as a location for advanced industry, technology infrastructure, and real estate development.

The DWJ DA reports updates on the following economic development projects:

- **CoreWeave – Industrial South (located in the city limits) \$1.2B**
CoreWeave was added in 2025 with Year 1 of its incentive schedule beginning in 2026 for the rebuild project on Industrial South. This project is primarily related to industrial/specialized equipment investment and reflects continued growth in high-technology infrastructure in the community.
- **Blue Links 128 LLC (development on Old Dixie Hwy) \$59,714,635**
Blue Links 128 LLC entered into a new incentive schedule in 2025, replacing a prior deal structure. Year 1 of the new schedule will begin in 2026. This update reflects continued investment activity tied to the property that **changed hands**, taxed at the new purchase price, and assumes the remaining 8 years of the tax savings schedule.
- **Blue Links 342 LLC (development on Old Dixie Hwy) \$56,785,365**
Blue Links 342 LLC also entered into a new incentive schedule in 2025, replacing a prior deal structure. Year 1 of the new schedule will begin in 2026. Similar to Blue Links 128 LLC, this reflects an updated agreement structure for ongoing investment and incentive compliance. This update reflects continued investment activity tied to the property that **changed hands**, taxed at the new purchase price, and assumes the remaining 9 years of the tax savings schedule.
- **Core Scientific – Old Tilton Road \$240M**
Core Scientific's Old Tilton Road project was added in 2025, with Year 1 beginning in 2026. This project is primarily a real estate investment and reflects continued activity related to large-scale technology and infrastructure development.
- **Core Scientific – Industrial South (located in the city limits) \$50M**
Core Scientific's Industrial South project was also updated in 2025, with Year 1 beginning in 2026. This project is primarily real estate investment and replaces the prior bond structure on this parcel only. The previously abated Core 2018 project unwound, and the Boring Drive facility is set to be 100% taxable. The building at this location was torn down in 2025 and is currently being rebuilt.
- **Cameron Brickyard \$25M**
Cameron Brickyard was added in 2025, with Year 1 beginning in 2026. This project is primarily a real estate investment. The new tenant is expected to be responsible for equipment investment; however, the real property investment may also include equipment or infrastructure used in manufacturing operations.
- **Single family housing –** Plans for the Hamilton Street Infill development were revealed in 2024 and work on that project began in 2025. The plans call for approximately 40 homes to be built on a site on South Hamilton located at 902 South Hamilton Street. We anticipate somewhere between \$6-10 million of new residential property in the city as a result of that project.

Both public and private schools in Whitfield County are major contributors to the local economy in the form of employment opportunities and capital investments being made in new and expanded school facilities.

During 2025, the average Whitfield County worker earned roughly \$61,197. The only counties with a higher annual wage than this are tied to the strong regional economies of Atlanta. As of 2025, however, per capita income (PCI) remained below that of its peers, equaling \$49,706, lower than the statewide amount of \$63,006 and the national average of \$73,204. There are several likely factors which may explain the gap between Whitfield County's high wages and low per capita income: Per Capita Income (PCI) is calculated based on total population. A relatively large portion of the County's population consists of individuals aged 18 and under who are not yet prime working age.

Long-Term Financial Planning

As is the case with most local governmental entities, the majority of services provided by Whitfield County are funded through an ad valorem tax levied against real and personal property. In the past, the fair market value of real property

had served as an excellent basis for funding governmental services since it had proven to be extremely stable and reliable. In accordance with state law, the millage rate is assessed on only 40% of the property valuation. In terms of the benefits being received from these taxes, there is often said to be a direct relationship between the quality of the services being provided and the fair market value of the property being served.

Whitfield County experienced a steady decline in Net M&O Digest Totals since the downturn in the economy in 2008 through 2012. The county experienced less than a 1% increase in the Net M&O digest in the years 2013 and 2014. In 2015 and 2016 the net digest experienced a 1.89% and .24% decline due to the effects of the elimination of the motor vehicle digest. In an effort to remain competitive with surrounding counties and to attract new business and jobs to the area, the Board of Commissioners voted in 2011 (effective 2012) to expand the Freeport Exemption to 100%. This increased Whitfield County's exemptions on the Gross Digest from approximately \$491 million dollars to \$835 million dollars, costing approximately \$4.7 million dollars in property tax revenue in 2016. In 2017, the county Board of Assessors office performed an urban land uniformity project intended to ensure equitability in land values across the county, and due in part to positive reassessments combined with new construction, a 6% increase in the total net digest occurred.

The County M&O millage rate for 2023 was set in September at 6.00. Due to a rollback of the rate for the portion which represents a positive reassessment county wide, plus an additional amount enacted by the Board of Commissioners, this totaled a reduction of 1.3 mil from the 2022 rate of 7.30. The special tax district millage rate for 2023 was simultaneously set at 3.0410. This rate was reduced from the 2022 rate of 3.438 mils due to the elimination of the Jointly Funded District. This rate is applied to tax bills of only unincorporated county residents as well as residents of all municipalities in the county other than the City of Dalton.

In 2024, the Board of Assessors did a total re-valuation of the County properties. There was controversy regarding what the digest value should be. Until the digest value could be decided, a temporary collection order was issued so that the taxing authorities could collect tax. The millage rate was set at 5.556 mils for the County M&O while the special tax districts millage rate was 3.041 for this temporary collection order. The final 2024 County M&O millage rate was approved at 4.3 mils. The special tax district millage remained unchanged at 3.0410 mils.

The 2025 digest and millage rate of 4.6 mils was approved in November of 2025.

Local Option Sales Tax (LOST) is one of the County's most significant sources of revenue. This and TAVT receipts provide the vast majority of the County's recurring monthly operating revenue. As required by state law, the County negotiated LOST percentages with the cities within its borders in 2022. The county faces the continuing challenge of providing both necessary and expected services, while balancing reductions of revenue against unwanted millage rate increases.

On June 9, 2020, voters approved a four year 1% 2020 SPLOST effective October 1, 2020. The County collected \$94.6 million to fund various county paving/resurfacing projects, public safety equipment, construction of Riverbend Park and other recreation improvements, and library capital improvements.

On May 21, 2024, the referendum was approved for a new four year 1% SPLOST beginning October 1, 2024. The 2024 SPLOST will fund capital improvements to public safety buildings, public safety vehicles and equipment, park improvements, and capital infrastructure improvements. The expected funding is \$80 million.

Independent Audit

The Georgia Code requires an annual audit of the books of account, financial records, and transactions of all administrative departments of the County by independent certified public accountants selected by the Board of Commissioners. The auditor's unmodified opinion has been included in this report.

Awards

The Government Finance Officers Association (GFOA) awarded a Certificate of Achievement for Excellence in Financial Reporting to Whitfield County for its annual comprehensive financial report for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2024. In order to be awarded the Certificate of Achievement, a government must publish an easily readable and efficiently organized annual comprehensive financial report. This report must satisfy both generally accepted accounting principles and applicable legal requirements.

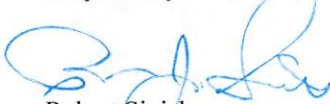
A Certificate of Achievement is valid for a period of one year only. We believe that our current annual comprehensive financial report continues to meet the Certificate of Achievement Program's requirements and we are submitting it to GFOA to determine its eligibility for another certificate.

Acknowledgments

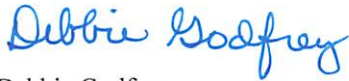
The preparation of this annual comprehensive financial report could not have been accomplished without the dedication and contributions of the entire Finance Department staff and the cooperation of the various elected officials and appointed management. We would also like to express our gratitude and appreciation to the staff of Rushton, LLC, Certified Public Accountants, for their technical guidance and assistance to make this a quality report.

In closing, we also wish to acknowledge the valuable contribution of the Board of Commissioners. Without their guidance and leadership, preparation of this report would not have been possible.

Respectfully Submitted,



Robert Sivick
County Administrator

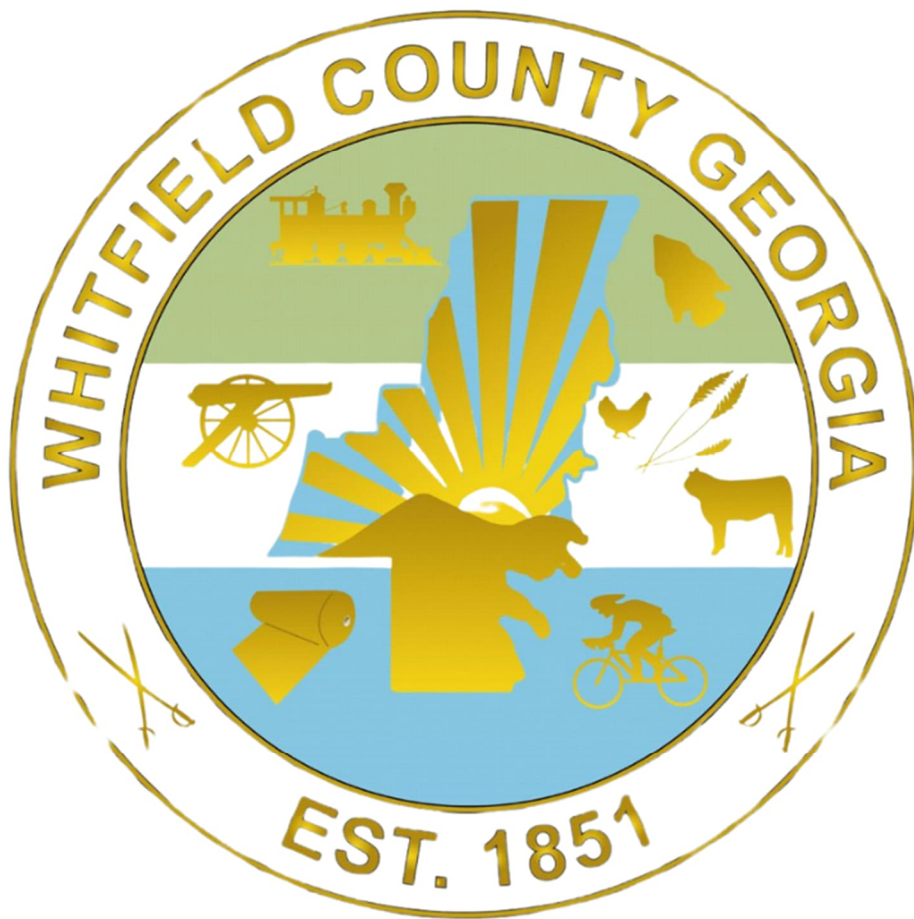


Debbie Godfrey
CFO

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Part II

Financial Section



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Independent Auditor's Report

Honorable Chairman and Members
of the Board of Commissioners
Whitfield County, Georgia

Report on the Audit of the Financial Statements

Opinions

We have audited the accompanying financial statements of the governmental activities, the business-type activities, the discretely presented component unit, each major fund, and the aggregate remaining fund information of Whitfield County, Georgia, as of and for the year ended December 31, 2025, and the related notes to the financial statements, which collectively comprise Whitfield County, Georgia's basic financial statements as listed in the table of contents.

In our opinion, based on our audit and the report of the other auditors, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the respective financial position of the governmental activities, the business-type activities, the discretely presented component unit, each major fund, and the aggregate remaining fund information of Whitfield County, Georgia, as of December 31, 2025, and the respective changes in the financial position and, where applicable, cash flows thereof, and the budgetary comparisons of the General Fund, Special Fire District Special Revenue Fund, and American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund for the year then ended in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

We did not audit the financial statements of Whitfield County Health Department, a discretely presented component unit of Whitfield County, Georgia. Those statements were audited by other auditors whose report has been furnished to us, and our opinion, insofar as it relates to the amounts included for Whitfield County Health Department, is based solely on the reports of the other auditors.

Basis for Opinions

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America and the standards applicable to financial audits contained in *Government Auditing Standards*, issued by the Comptroller General of the United States. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements section of our report. We are required to be independent of Whitfield County, Georgia and to meet our ethical responsibilities, in accordance with the relevant ethical requirements relating to our audit. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our audit opinion.

Responsibilities of Management for the Financial Statements

Management is responsible for the preparation and fair presentation of the financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America; and for the design, implementation, and maintenance of internal control relevant to the preparation and fair presentation of financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial statements, management is required to evaluate whether there are conditions or events, considered in the aggregate, that raise substantial doubt about Whitfield County, Georgia's ability to continue as a going concern for twelve months beyond the financial statement date, including any currently known information that may raise substantial doubt shortly thereafter.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements as a whole are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinions. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not absolute assurance and therefore is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards and *Government Auditing Standards* will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control. Misstatements are considered material if there is a substantial likelihood that, individually or in the aggregate, they would influence the judgment made by a reasonable user based on the financial statements.

In performing an audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards and *Government Auditing Standards*, we:

- Exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit.
- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error, and design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks. Such procedures include examining, on a test basis, evidence regarding the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control. Accordingly, no such opinion is expressed.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of significant accounting estimates made by management, as well as evaluate the overall presentation of the financial statements.
- Conclude whether, in our judgment, there are conditions or events, considered in the aggregate, that raise substantial doubt about Whitfield County, Georgia's ability to continue as a going concern for a reasonable period of time.

We are required to communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit, significant audit findings, and certain internal control-related matters that we identified during the audit.

Required Supplementary Information

Accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America require that the management's discussion and analysis and the required supplementary information, as referred to in the table of contents, be presented to supplement the basic financial statements. Such information is the responsibility of management and, although not a part of the basic financial statements, is required by the Governmental Accounting Standards Board who considers it to be an essential part of financial reporting for placing the basic financial statements in an appropriate operational, economic, or historical context. We have applied certain limited procedures to the required supplementary information in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America, which consisted of inquiries of management about the methods of preparing the information and comparing the information for consistency with management's responses to our inquiries, the basic financial statements, and other knowledge we obtained during our audit of the basic financial statements. We do not express an opinion or provide any assurance on the information because the limited procedures do not provide us with sufficient evidence to express an opinion or provide any assurance.

Supplementary Information

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming opinions on the financial statements that collectively comprise Whitfield County, Georgia's basic financial statements. The combining and individual fund financial statements, the schedules and the schedules of projects financed with special purpose local option sales tax (the "supplementary information"), and the schedule of supplemental official income, as listed in the table of contents, are presented for purposes of additional analysis and are not a required part of the basic financial statements. The schedule of expenditures of federal awards is presented for purposes of additional analysis as required by Title 2 U.S. *Code of Federal Regulations* Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards*, and is also not a required part of the basic financial statements. Such information is the responsibility of management and was derived from and relates directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the basic financial statements. The information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the basic financial statements and certain additional procedures, including comparing and reconciling such information directly to the underlying accounting and other records used to prepare the basic financial statements or to the basic financial statements themselves, and other additional procedures in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. In our opinion, the supplementary information and the schedule of expenditures of federal awards are fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the financial statements as a whole.

Other Information

Management is responsible for the other information included in the annual report. The other information comprises the introductory and statistical sections but does not include the basic financial statements and our auditor's report thereon. Our opinions on the basic financial statements do not cover the other information, and we do not express an opinion or any form of assurance thereon.

In connection with our audit of the basic financial statements, our responsibility is to read the other information and consider whether a material inconsistency exists between the other information and the basic financial statements, or the other information otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If, based on the work performed, we conclude that an uncorrected material misstatement of the other information exists, we are required to describe it in our report.

Other Reporting Required by Government Auditing Standards

In accordance with *Government Auditing Standards*, we have also issued our report dated June 26, 2026, on our consideration of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over financial reporting and our tests of its compliance with certain provisions of laws, regulations, contracts, grant agreements, and other matters. The purpose of that report is to describe the scope of our testing of internal control over financial reporting and compliance and results of that testing, and not to provide an opinion on the internal control over financial reporting or on compliance. That report is an integral part of an audit performed in accordance with *Government Auditing Standards* in considering Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over financial reporting and compliance.

Rushton, LLC

Gainesville, Georgia
June 26, 2026

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
MANAGEMENT'S DISCUSSION AND ANALYSIS
Year Ended December 31, 2025

Management's Discussion and Analysis of Whitfield County Government's Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR) provides an overall narrative and analysis of the County's financial statements for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2025. This discussion and analysis are designed to provide insight regarding the County's financial performance as a whole. The reader should also review the information presented here in conjunction with additional information which has been furnished in the financial statements and the notes to the financial statements to gain an enhanced understanding of Whitfield County's financial performance.

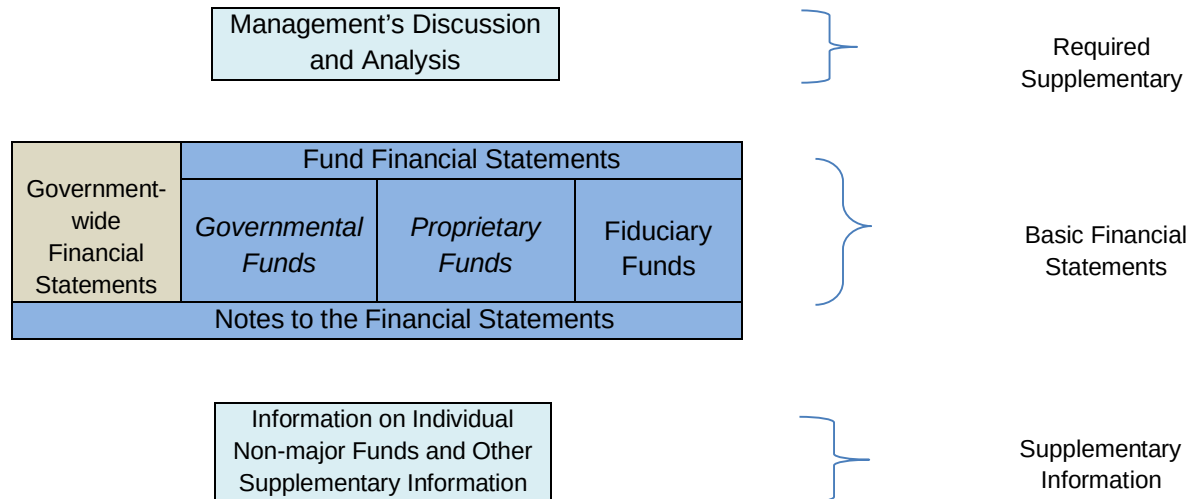
FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS

Key financial highlights for 2025 are as follows:

- ◆ The County's combined net position totaled \$263.0 million. Of this amount, \$247.1 million represents governmental activities and \$15.9 million represents business-type activities. This is a decrease of \$4.2 million from the prior year. \$0.3 million of the decrease represents an error correction due to differences in revenue recognition caused by differences in the temporary 2024 tax digest and the certified final 2024 tax digest.
- ◆ Total net position is comprised of the following:
 - (1) Net investment of capital assets of \$218.6 million includes property and equipment, net of accumulated depreciation and amortization, and reduced for outstanding debt related to the purchase or construction of capital assets.
 - (2) Net position of \$20.1 million is restricted by constraints imposed from outside the County such as debt covenants, grantors, laws, or regulations.
 - (3) Unrestricted net position of \$24.3 million represents the portion available to maintain the County's continuing obligations to citizens and creditors.
- ◆ Combined revenue totaled \$113.20 million, of which governmental activities totaled \$110.9 million and business-type activities totaled \$2.3 million.
- ◆ Overall expenses totaled \$117.0 million of which governmental activities totaled \$116.0 million and business-type activities totaled \$1.0 million.
- ◆ The County's governmental funds reported a total ending fund balance of \$42.2 million for this year, which is a decrease of \$5.5 million from the prior year.
- ◆ At December 31, 2025, the County's General Fund reported an unassigned fund balance of \$19.2 million.

OVERVIEW OF THE FINANCIAL STATEMENT

This is the twentieth Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR) Whitfield County has issued under the Governmental Accounting Standards Board (GASB) Statement 34. The following illustration is provided as a guide for the financial statements:



This discussion and analysis are intended to serve as an introduction to Whitfield County's basic financial statements. The basic financial statements include: (1) government-wide financial statements, (2) fund financial statements, and (3) notes to the financial statements. The County also includes in this report additional information to supplement the basic financial statements. Comparative data is presented when available.

Government-wide Financial Statements

The Government-wide financial statements provide a broad view of the County's operations in a manner similar to a private-sector business. The statements provide both short-term and long-term information about the County's financial position, which assists in assessing the economic condition at the end of the fiscal year. These statements are prepared using the flow of economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting. This means the statements consider all revenues and expenses connected with the fiscal year even if cash involved has not been received or paid. There are two government-wide financial statements, the Statement of Net Position and the Statement of Activities, which are both described below.

The Statement of Net Position presents information on all the County's assets, deferred outflows of resources, liabilities, and deferred inflows of resources, with residual of all other elements reported as net position. Over time, increases or decreases in net position may serve as a useful indicator of whether the financial position of the County is improving or deteriorating.

The Statement of Activities presents information showing how the County's net position changed during the most recent fiscal year. All changes in net position are reported as soon as the underlying event giving rise to the change occurs, regardless of the timing of related cash flows. This means that revenues and expenses are reported in this statement for some items that will not result in cash flows until future fiscal periods. An example of this would be uncollected taxes and earned but unused paid time off.

Both of the government-wide financial statements distinguish functions of Whitfield County Government that are principally supported by taxes and intergovernmental revenues from other functions that are intended to recover all or a significant portion of their costs through user fees and charges. The governmental activities include general government, judicial, public safety, public works, health and welfare, culture and recreation and housing and development. The business-type activities include the Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center, Whitfield Transit System, and Dalton-Whitfield Solid Waste Management Authority. The government-wide financial statements also include a discretely presented component unit which is the Whitfield County Health Department. Component units are legally separate organizations for which the elected officials of the County are financially accountable.

Fund Financial Statements

A fund is a grouping of related accounts that is used to maintain control over resources that have been segregated for specific activities or objectives. The County, like other state and local governments, uses fund accounting to ensure and demonstrate compliance with finance-related requirements.

The fund financial statements focus on individual parts of the County government, reporting the County's operations in more detail than the government-wide statements. All of the funds of the County can be divided into three categories: governmental funds, proprietary funds and fiduciary funds. It is important to note that these fund categories use different accounting approaches and should be interpreted differently.

- ◆ **Governmental Funds** – Most of the basic services provided by the County are financed through governmental funds. Governmental funds are used to account for essentially the same functions reported as governmental activities in the government-wide financial statements. However, unlike the government-wide statements, the governmental fund financial statements focus on short-term financing requirements. This approach is known as using the flow of current financial resources measurement focus and the modified accrual basis of accounting. These statements provide a detailed short-term view of the County's finances that assists in determining whether there will be adequate financial resources available to meet the County's current needs.

The County maintains four governmental fund types: General Fund, Special Revenue Funds, Debt Service Fund, and the Capital Projects Funds. Information is presented separately in the governmental fund balance sheet and in the governmental fund statement of revenues, expenditures and changes in fund balances for the General Fund, American Rescue Plan Act Fund, SPLOST 2020 Fund, SPLOST 2024 Fund, and the Special Fire District Fund, all of which are considered to be major funds. Data from the other governmental funds are combined into a single, aggregated presentation. The basic governmental fund financial statements are presented on pages 21 through 29 of this report.

Individual fund information for non-major governmental funds is found in combining statements in a later section of this report.

- ◆ **Proprietary Funds** – These funds are used to account for activities that operate similar to those commercial enterprises found in the private sector. Because these funds charge fees for services provided to outside customers including local governments, they are known as enterprise funds. Proprietary funds use the accrual basis of accounting, thus there is no reconciliation needed between the government-wide financial statements for business-type activities and the proprietary fund financial statements.

The Whitfield County Transit System is the only proprietary fund operated by the County. Services provided by the two joint ventures to customers include the Dalton-Whitfield Solid Waste Management and the Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center. Internal service funds are an accounting device used to account for services provided and billed on an internal basis. The County utilizes internal service funds for workers' compensation and health insurance. The internal service funds are reported as governmental activities on the basic proprietary fund financial statements which can be found on pages 31 through 33.

- ◆ **Fiduciary Funds** – These funds are used to account for assets held by the County as an agent for individuals, private organizations, other governments and other County departments. The county is responsible for ensuring that the assets reported in these funds are used only for their intended purposes and only by those to whom the assets belong. These funds are not reflected in the government-wide financial statements because the resources are not available to support the County's operations or programs. The accounting used for fiduciary funds is much like that used for proprietary funds. Whitfield County maintains six fiduciary custodial funds which include the Clerk of Superior Court, Probate Court, Magistrate Court, Sheriff, Juvenile Court and Tax Commissioner. The statement of fiduciary assets and liabilities for these custodial funds can be found on page 34. A combining statement of changes in assets and liabilities for these custodial funds can be found in a later section of this report.

Budgetary Comparisons

Whitfield County adopts an annual appropriated budget for all governmental funds except the capital projects funds, which have an adopted project length budget. Although not required, the County also adopts an annual appropriated budget for the Whitfield Transit System which is a non-major enterprise fund. A budgetary comparison schedule has been provided for the General Fund and can be found on pages 27 through 30. Budget to actual comparisons for other funds are provided in individual schedules elsewhere in this report.

Notes to the Financial Statements

The notes provide additional information that is essential to a full understanding of the data provided in the government-wide and fund financial statements. The notes to the financial statements can be found on pages 36 through 84 of this report.

Other Supplementary Information

In addition to the basic financial statements and accompanying notes, this report also presents certain required supplementary information concerning the County's progress in funding its obligation to provide pension and OPEB benefits to its employees. Required supplementary information can be found on pages 85 through 93 of this report.

GOVERNMENT-WIDE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

As noted earlier, net position may serve over time as a useful indicator of a government's financial position. The County's combined net position (governmental and business-type activities) totaled \$263.0 million as of December 31, 2025.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA STATEMENT OF NET POSITION						
	Governmental Activities		Business Activities		Total	
	2025	2024	2025	2024	2025	2024
Assets:						
Current assets	\$ 59,076,017	\$ 65,714,952	\$ 367,452	\$ 404,301	\$ 59,443,469	\$ 66,119,253
Other assets	3,585,934	1,509,520	15,269,661	15,457,383	18,855,595	16,966,903
Capital assets	222,803,609	216,659,034	359,118	62,634	223,162,727	216,721,668
Total assets	285,465,560	283,883,506	15,996,231	15,924,318	301,461,791	299,807,824
Deferred Outflows of Resources	5,038,690	8,612,054	-	-	5,038,690	8,612,054
Liabilities:						
Current liabilities	12,107,692	11,563,809	45,634	41,802	12,153,326	11,605,611
Non-current liabilities	28,856,637	27,031,482	9,392	9,594	28,866,029	27,041,076
Total liabilities	40,964,329	38,595,291	55,026	51,396	41,019,355	38,646,687
Deferred Inflows of Resources	2,464,600	2,599,442	-	-	2,464,600	2,599,442
Net position:						
Invested in capital assets	218,268,229	214,890,988	359,118	62,634	218,627,347	214,953,622
Restricted	20,104,816	15,631,120	-	-	20,104,816	15,631,120
Unrestricted	8,702,276	20,778,719	15,582,087	15,810,288	24,284,363	36,589,007
Total net position	\$ 247,075,321	\$ 251,300,827	\$ 15,941,205	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 263,016,526	\$ 267,173,749

A large portion of the County's net position reflects its investment in capital assets such as land, buildings, equipment and infrastructure less any related debt used to acquire those assets that is still outstanding. Net investment in capital assets increased by \$3.7 million (1.7%) in 2025.

The County uses these capital assets to provide services to its citizens; therefore, these assets are not available for future spending. Although the County's investment in its capital assets is reported net of related debt, it should be noted that the resources needed to repay this debt must be provided from other sources since the capital assets themselves cannot be used to liquidate these liabilities.

Changes in Net Position

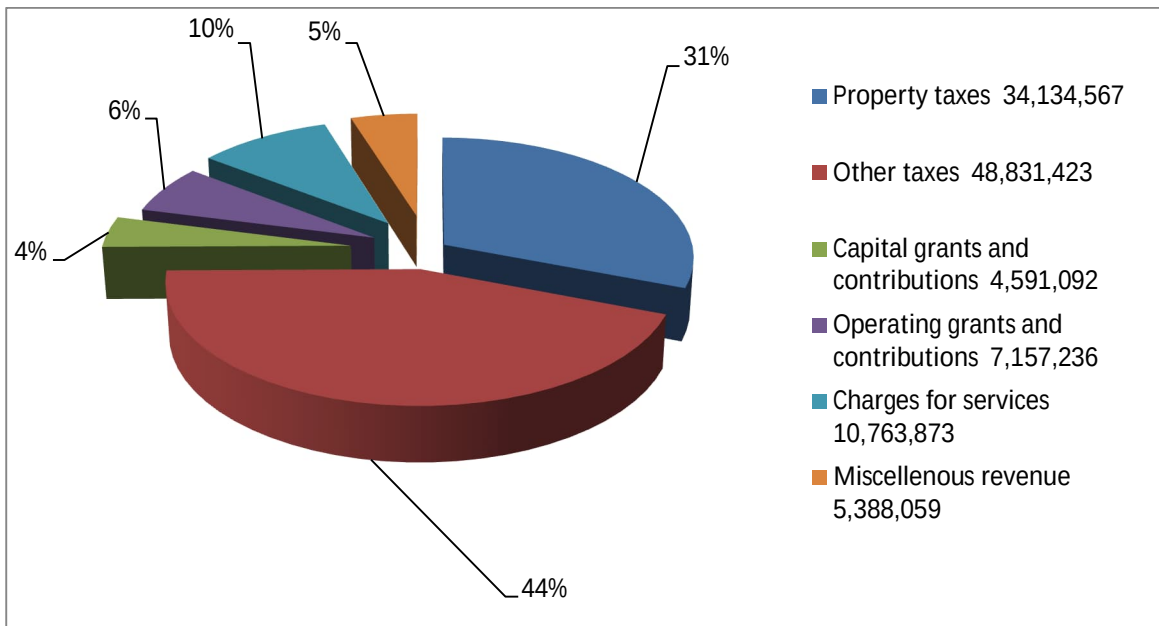
Governmental and business-type activities decreased the County's net position by \$3.9 million in 2025. The following table indicates the changes in net position for governmental and business-type activities in 2025 and 2024.

	Governmental Activities		Business Activities		Total	
	2025	2024	2025	2024	2025	2024
Revenues:						
Program:						
Charges for services	\$ 10,763,873	\$ 12,578,115	\$ 372,326	\$ 262,551	\$ 11,136,199	\$ 12,840,666
Operating grants	7,157,236	8,079,097	776,174	563,715	7,933,410	8,642,812
Capital grants	4,591,092	3,334,542	-	-	4,591,092	3,334,542
General:						
Property taxes	34,134,567	32,119,003	-	-	34,134,567	32,119,003
Sales taxes	41,303,690	40,550,126	-	-	41,303,690	40,550,126
Insurance premium taxes	6,315,139	5,632,927	-	-	6,315,139	5,632,927
Alcoholic beverage taxes	388,230	400,551	-	-	388,230	400,551
Hotel/Motel taxes	85,339	178,231	-	-	85,339	178,231
Miscellaneous taxes	739,025	790,075	-	-	739,025	790,075
Miscellaneous	2,559,363	2,142,634	26	-	2,559,389	2,142,634
Gain on disp. of capital assets	177,704	165,723	-	-	177,704	165,723
Investment earnings	2,650,992	1,408,079	1,148,650	-	3,799,642	1,408,079
Total revenues	110,866,250	107,379,103	2,297,176	826,266	113,163,426	108,205,369
Program Expenses:						
General government	16,133,948	15,116,378	-	-	16,133,948	15,116,378
Judicial	10,290,071	9,774,672	-	-	10,290,071	9,774,672
Public safety	51,147,139	45,281,174	-	-	51,147,139	45,281,174
Public works	28,260,374	28,375,351	-	-	28,260,374	28,375,351
Health and welfare	1,416,140	1,270,711	-	-	1,416,140	1,270,711
Culture and recreation	4,389,793	3,960,102	-	-	4,389,793	3,960,102
Housing and development	4,318,289	4,096,847	-	-	4,318,289	4,096,847
Interest on long-term debt	91,926	90,957	-	-	91,926	90,957
Other programs	-	-	978,893	1,943,130	978,893	1,943,130
Total expenses	116,047,680	107,966,192	978,893	1,943,130	117,026,573	109,909,322
Excess (deficiency)	(5,181,430)	(587,089)	1,318,283	(1,116,864)	(3,863,147)	(1,703,953)
Transfers	1,250,000	-	(1,250,000)	-	-	-
Change in net position	(3,931,430)	(587,089)	68,283	(1,116,864)	(3,863,147)	(1,703,953)
Net position -						
beginning of year (original)	251,300,827	252,141,129	15,872,922	16,917,999	267,173,749	269,059,128
Restatements	(294,076)	(253,213)	-	71,787	(294,076)	(181,426)
Net position -						
beginning of year (restated)	251,006,751	251,887,916	15,872,922	16,989,786	266,879,673	268,877,702
Net position -						
end of year	\$ 247,075,321	\$ 251,300,827	\$ 15,941,205	\$ 15,872,922	\$ 263,016,526	\$ 267,173,749

Governmental Activities

The following chart depicts revenues of the governmental activities for the year ended December 31, 2025.

Revenues by Source – Governmental Activities

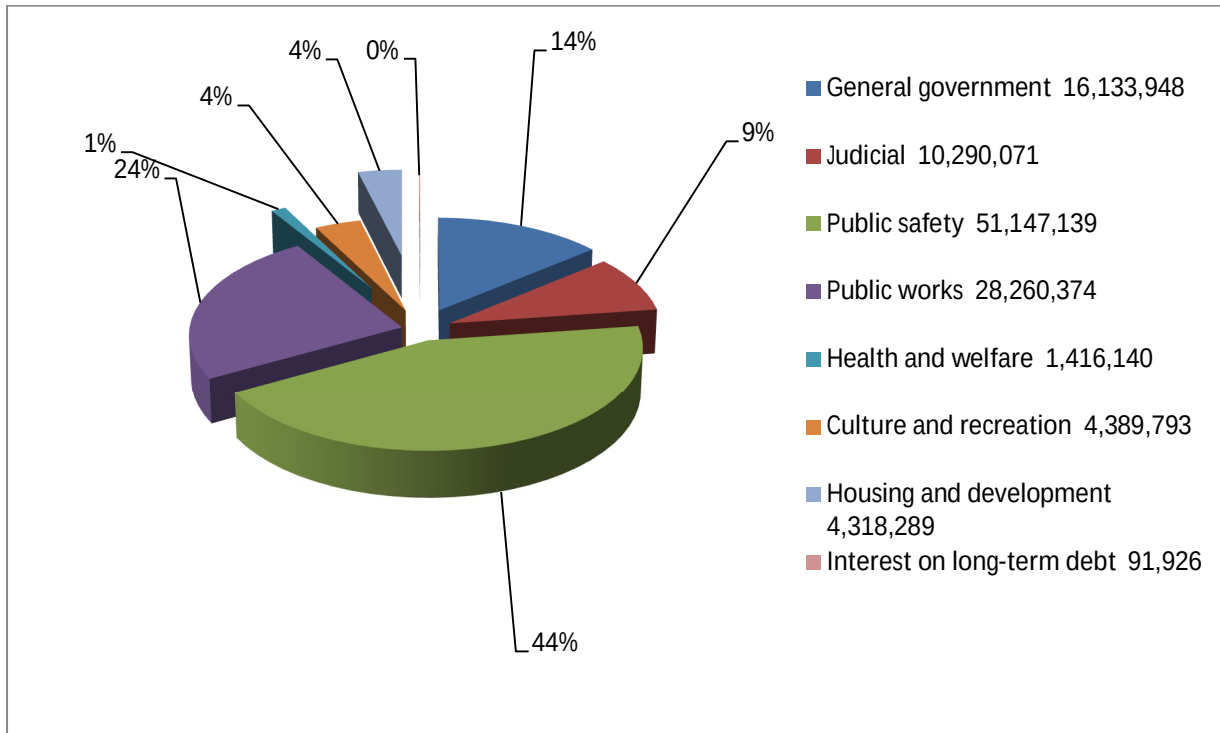


As indicated by the revenue diagram above, property taxes and other taxes were the largest sources for governmental activities. Other taxes include sales tax, insurance premium tax, hotel-motel tax and alcohol beverage tax. The two largest portions of the County's program revenue were shared by Charges for Services and Operating Grants and Contributions, accounting for 9.7% and 6.5% respectively, of total program revenues each. Charges for Services include licenses and permits, fines and forfeitures related to judicial activity, fees for real estate transfers, fees associated with the collection of property taxes and fees charged through various County governmental departments. Operating Grants and Contributions revenues were largely related to American Rescue Plan Act grant revenue for general government and public safety operations.

The County's governmental activities total revenue increased 3.2%, or \$3.5 million, in 2025. The largest contributing factor to this change was property tax revenue increases related to the timing of the temporary 2024 tax digest compared to the final certified 2024 tax digest as well as increased assessed property values on the 2025 tax digest.

The following chart depicts expenses of the governmental activities for the year ended December 31, 2025.

Expenses by Function – Governmental Activities



As indicated by the expense diagram, the largest uses of County resources were for Public Works and Public Safety services such as Sheriff's Department Enforcement and Corrections divisions, Fire, Coroner, Animal Control and Emergency Management.

The County's governmental activities total expenses increased 7.5%, or \$8.1 million during the year ended December 31, 2025. The majority of the increase is related to wage increases across all County departments in the current year as well as other market factors on costs such as supply chain concerns and inflation.

The following table presents the cost of each of the County's programs, including the net costs (i.e., total cost less revenues generated by the activities). The net costs illustrate the financial burden placed on the County's taxpayers by each of these functions.

Governmental Activities		
Governmental activities		
	Total cost of services	Net cost of services
General government	\$ 16,133,948	\$ 6,904,604
Judicial	10,290,071	8,370,894
Public safety	51,147,139	47,721,207
Public works	28,260,374	22,383,840
Health and welfare	1,416,140	1,231,040
Culture and recreation	4,389,793	2,516,288
Housing and development	4,318,289	4,315,680
Interest	91,926	91,926
Total	<u>\$ 116,047,680</u>	<u>\$ 93,535,479</u>

Business-type Activities

The County's business-type activities total revenues increased \$1.5 million, while expenses decreased \$0.3 million for 2025; accordingly, net position for business-type activities increased 0.4%. The majority of the increase was related to the net gain on the investments in joint ventures in the current year.

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS OF THE GOVERNMENT'S FUNDS

Governmental Funds

Whitfield County uses fund accounting to ensure and demonstrate compliance with finance-related legal requirements. All of the funds of Whitfield County can be divided into three categories: governmental funds, proprietary funds, and fiduciary funds.

The focus of the County's governmental funds is to provide information on short-term inflows, outflows and balances of spendable resources. Such information is useful in assessing the County's financial requirements. In particular, the unassigned fund balance may serve as a useful measure of a government's net resources available for spending at the end of the fiscal year.

The County ended 2025 with strong fund balances in its governmental funds. The combined balance of all governmental funds was \$42.2 million. Of this total, \$19.2 million or 45.4% represented unassigned fund balance, which is available for spending in the coming year. The remainder of fund balance was non-spendable, restricted, committed, or assigned, to indicate that it was not available for new spending because it had already been designated: (1) to liquidate contracts, purchase orders and inventories of the prior period, (2) to pay debt service and (3) for a variety of other restricted purposes.

Major Governmental Funds

General Fund:

The General Fund is the County's primary operating fund and is used to account for all governmental financial resources not restricted by state or federal laws, local ordinances, or other externally imposed requirements. At the end of the current year, unassigned fund balance of the General Fund was \$19.2 million, and the total fund balance was \$23.1 million. As a measure of the General Fund's liquidity, it may be useful to compare both unassigned fund balance and total fund balance to total fund expenditures. Unassigned fund balance represents 27.0% of total General Fund operating expenditures and total fund balance represents 32.6% of the same amount.

The fund balance of the General Fund decreased \$7.2 million in 2025 for a total of \$23.1 million. The Board of Commissioners made a collaborative effort to focus on maintaining the County's excellent financial position. Revenues increased \$2.0 million (3.6%) while operating expenditures increased \$10.3 million (15.8%). Taxes increased mostly due to increased property tax collections due to the delayed billing of the 2024 certified digest. Various departmental budget increases related to expected price increases per the consumer price index (CPI), coupled with salary and benefits increases, contributed to the operating expenditures increase. Debt service increased significantly to service the \$6.0 million tax anticipation note issued in 2025 to protect cash flow concerns related to the delayed tax digests.

Special Revenue Funds:

- ◆ The Special Fire District Fund was established in 2013 to account for the funding and expenditures incurred in conjunction with the establishment of a special tax district used to provide adequate and equitable funding of fire protection services to all areas of Whitfield County outside the municipal limits of the City of Dalton. Revenues are derived primarily from property and insurance premium taxes. At the end of 2025, the fund balance was \$159 thousand, reflecting a \$257 thousand fund balance increase.
- ◆ The American Rescue Plan Act Fund incurred \$3.4 million of eligible expenditures and recognized \$3.5 million in revenues from the grant funding. The County has \$264 thousand of unearned grant funds remaining to expend in this fund.

Capital Projects Funds:

- ◆ Capital Projects SPLOST 2020 Fund is used to account for the acquisition and construction of major capital assets. Revenues are derived from special purpose local option sales taxes. Collections for these funds are restricted for construction and capital outlay. Collections for the 2020 SPLOST began in October 2020, and ended in September 2024. Projects related to the 2020 SPLOST, as well as bond debt service, are funded as taxes are collected and include road, street and bridge projects, sewer extensions, and library capital improvements. At the end of 2025, the 2020 SPLOST fund balance was \$4.0 million.

- ◆ Capital Projects SPLOST 2024 Fund is used to account for the acquisition and construction of major capital assets. Revenues are derived from special purpose local option sales taxes. Collections for these funds are restricted for construction and capital outlay. Collections for the 2024 SPLOST began in October 2024, and will end in September 2028. Projects related to the 2024 SPLOST are funded as taxes are collected and include road, street and bridge projects, sewer extensions, fire station renovations, and park capital improvements. At the end of 2025, the 2024 SPLOST fund balance was \$6.8 million.

Proprietary Funds

The proprietary funds share the same focus as the government-wide statements, reporting both short-term and long-term information about financial status. This provides a perspective similar to that found in the private sector with its basis in accrual accounting and elimination or reclassification of activities between funds.

GENERAL FUND BUDGETARY HIGHLIGHTS

Whitfield County operated under an annual balanced budget (budgeted revenues equal or exceed budgeted expenditures), which is adopted by resolution and administered in accordance with State law. The legal level of control (the level at which expenditures may not legally exceed appropriations) for each legally adopted annual operating budget is at the fund/department level. Over the course of the year, the General fund was amended by the Board of Commissioners.

Property tax revenues were below budget for the current year due primarily to delays in the County's issuance of the final certified tax digest. Because the County's property tax levy and related budget estimates are dependent on information provided by the Tax Assessor and Tax Commissioner, these delays required the County to rely on preliminary digest information, which resulted in conservative budgeted revenues. Actual collections during the year reflect the timing and availability of finalized digest information rather than a decline in the underlying tax base. Management does not expect this variance to continue in future tax years.

Intergovernmental revenues were below budget for the current year due primarily to a change the classification of certain revenues associated with the Joint Development Authority (JDA) project. In prior periods, these amounts were reported directly in the General Fund as intergovernmental revenues. During the current year, the County more appropriately reported these resources within the JDA Project Capital Projects Fund and recognized transfers to the General Fund as needed. Because the budget was developed based on the prior year presentation, intergovernmental revenues in the General Fund were overestimated relative to actual results.

The most significant expenditure amendments are summarized as follows:

General Government

- ◆ General government had an overall increase of \$884 thousand. Salary and benefit increases, leased office space, and inflationary effects contributed to the increase.

Judicial

- ♦ Judicial budgets increased \$798 thousand due to salary and benefits increases and inflationary effects of the cost of supplies and court costs.

Public Safety

- ♦ Public safety had an overall increase of \$3.3 million mainly due to the financed purchase of emergency radios, additional school resource officers, selective pay increases, greater fuel costs, higher inmate medical costs and the need to budget salary and benefits to actual employment levels.

Public Works

- ♦ Public works had an overall decrease of \$266 thousand mainly due to the reappropriation of SPLOST funding on previously planned General Fund projects.

Debt Service

- ♦ Debt Service had an overall increase of \$6.3 million mainly due to the unplanned issuance of the \$6.0 million tax anticipation note in 2025 and the subsequent servicing of the note.

CAPITAL ASSETS AND DEBT ADMINISTRATION

Capital Assets

The County's investment in capital assets for its governmental and business-type activities as of December 31, 2025 amounts to \$218.6million (net of accumulated depreciation/amortization and related debt). This investment in capital assets includes land, buildings, improvements, equipment, infrastructure and construction in progress. Infrastructure assets are items that are normally immovable and of value only to the County, such as roads, bridges, streets and sidewalks, drainage systems and other similar items.

Whitfield County's Capital Assets (Net of Depreciation and Amortization)

	Governmental Activities		Business Activities		Total Primary Government	
	2025	2024	2025	2024	2025	2024
Land	\$ 14,230,895	\$ 14,230,895	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 14,230,895	\$ 14,230,895
Construction in progress	8,134,357	6,226,997	-	-	8,134,357	6,226,997
Buildings and land improvements	51,005,505	52,209,548	-	-	51,005,505	52,209,548
Equipment and fixtures	13,384,217	10,381,864	343,393	17,575	13,727,610	10,399,439
Vehicles	8,031,152	4,396,350	15,725	45,059	8,046,877	4,441,409
Right -to-Use Subscription Asset	2,473,210	26,176	-	-	2,473,210	26,176
Infrastructure	125,544,273	129,187,204	-	-	125,544,273	129,187,204
Total	<u>\$ 222,803,609</u>	<u>\$ 216,659,034</u>	<u>\$ 359,118</u>	<u>\$ 62,634</u>	<u>\$ 223,162,727</u>	<u>\$ 216,721,668</u>

The County's total increase in capital assets for the current fiscal year was 3.0%.

The majority of the increase in the Governmental Activities was related to the acquisition of right-to-use subscription assets related to tasers and body cameras as well as the acquisition of emergency radios from Motorola Solutions. See Note 8 for more detailed information on capital asset activity.

Long-term Debt

As of December 31, 2025, Whitfield County's revenue bonds, notes payable, and subscriptions payable totaled \$4.2 million. This is an increase of \$3.3 million from the prior year. The increase is related to the issuance of subscriptions payable for taser and body camera software and the issuance of notes payable for emergency radios. See Notes 10 and 11 for additional information on Whitfield County's long-term debt.

	Governmental Activities	
	2025	2024
Notes payable	\$ 3,039,483	\$ 305,187
Subscription payable	1,152,298	-
Revenue bonds	-	556,000
Total	<u>\$ 4,191,781</u>	<u>\$ 861,187</u>

ECONOMIC FACTORS AND NEXT YEAR'S BUDGET

As of December 2025, Whitfield County's unemployment rate was 4.2% which is the same as the prior year. The local and regional economies have struggled to fill positions as the industry and service sectors seek to fulfill demand since the exit of the pandemic era began. Under normal economic circumstances, the Board of Commissioners, along with the Joint Development Authority and municipalities, recognizes the need for a more diversified local economy and the need to recruit new businesses to the area. The Dalton-Whitfield County Joint Development Authority's economic development mission is to facilitate the long-term, positive economic growth of the community by attracting jobs, diverse investments, and growing the tax base. In 2025, these efforts led to meaningful economic activity through both new investment and the restructuring of existing agreements. These projects represent a mix of real estate, industrial equipment, and technology infrastructure investment, with several incentive schedules beginning in 2026.

The County's assessed net taxable digest in 2025 increased to \$4.59 billion. Total exemptions on the gross digest were \$1.68 billion. The 2025 millage rate was set at 4.6 mills. The Whitfield County Board of Commissioners created special tax districts to include all areas of Whitfield County outside the municipal limits of the City of Dalton for the purpose of providing adequate and equitable funding of certain jointly funded services between Whitfield County and the City of Dalton for the benefit of all such areas. For 2025, the millage rate was 2.755 for the Fire district and .2860 for the Solid Waste authority.

The County entered into LOST negotiations as required by state law with the City of Dalton and the other cities located within the county's borders in 2022. As a result of these negotiations the County's percentage of LOST collections will remain unchanged, which constitutes a 22.8% reduction since the beginning of the prior agreement in 2012. Understandably, County leadership has been challenged to continuously provide the same level of services which have come to be expected by the citizenry with this sustained downward trend of reduced revenue. Sales tax collections were \$15.6 million in 2025 which is a 1.7% increase from 2024. TAVT collections began in the County in March 2013. Actual TAVT collections for 2025 were \$5.7 million which was an increase of 1.5% over 2024.

Voters passed a 1 penny sales tax in May of 2024 which raised the sales tax rate from 6% to 7% effective October 1, 2024. This one penny SPLOST is expected to raise approximately \$80 million dollars and will be used to fund public safety equipment enhancements for local law enforcement, fire, road paving and improvements, bridge and culvert repair, construction of a new community center, and other park improvements.

Other factors considered when preparing the 2026 budget include:

- ◆ A flat millage rate for 2026 for M&O and the special tax districts was assumed; however, economic factors may dictate a higher rate.
- ◆ OPEB costs will be funded on the pay-as-you-go basis.
- ◆ No defined benefit pension contributions have been budgeted for in 2026. However, it is the policy of the Board to keep the plan at a 100% funded level.
- ◆ Based upon estimates from the insurance broker and the decision of the BOC, a flat rate of \$15,164 was applied to each full-time employee in allocating health insurance expense to departments.
- ◆ Extremely limited capital requests were considered in the 2026 general fund budget, as other large capital needs are expected to be acquired via the 2020 SPLOST and 2024 SPLOST.
- ◆ The County continues to evaluate the level of services desired by citizens and how to provide those services as economically as possible. Based on demographic considerations, demands for all types of public safety, courts, and general services are expected to continue at 2025 levels.
- ◆ The 2026 budget does not include pay raises full-time County employees.
- ◆ Departmental operating budgets will be held to prior year levels except where sufficient justification is provided.
- ◆ Due to the 2020 SPLOST and 2024 SPLOST, which includes paving and various other road projects, paving was not included in the 2026 general fund budget.

In 2025, the County secured a tax anticipation note (TAN) to assist with cash management until tax revenues were received. Cash flow projections are constantly updated through the year. Should forecasts indicate the need for short-term borrowing, the County has procedures for quickly obtaining such funding.

REQUEST FOR INFORMATION

This financial report is designed to provide a general overview of Whitfield County finances, comply with finance-related laws and regulations, and demonstrate the County's commitment to public accountability. If you have questions about this report or would like to request additional information, contact:

Whitfield County Finance Department
201 S. Hamilton Street, Fourth Floor
Dalton, Georgia 30720
Telephone: 706-275-7500
Website: www.whitfieldcountyga.com

BASIC FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
December 31, 2025

	Primary Government			Component Unit
	Governmental Activities	Business-type Activities	Total	Whitfield County Health Department
ASSETS				
Current assets				
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 26,410,555	\$ 85,417	\$ 26,495,972	\$ 6,021,112
Receivables (net)				
Accounts	2,574,946	110,468	2,685,414	116,693
Intergovernmental	2,951,213	171,567	3,122,780	428,324
Taxes	26,559,561	0	26,559,561	0
Inventories	0	0	0	769
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	31,412	0	31,412	0
Prepaid items	548,330	0	548,330	365
Total current assets	59,076,017	367,452	59,443,469	6,567,263
Noncurrent assets				
Capital assets				
Non-depreciable capital assets	22,365,252	0	22,365,252	0
Depreciable/amortizable capital assets (net)	200,438,357	359,118	200,797,475	100,795
Investment in joint venture	3,585,934	15,269,661	18,855,595	0
Proportionate share of OPEB asset	0	0	0	477,951
Total noncurrent assets	226,389,543	15,628,779	242,018,322	578,746
Total assets	285,465,560	15,996,231	301,461,791	7,146,009
DEFERRED OUTFLOWS OF RESOURCES				
Deferred outflows of resources - pension	1,783,927	0	1,783,927	661,319
Deferred outflows of resources - OPEB	3,254,763	0	3,254,763	188,677
Total deferred outflows of resources	5,038,690	0	5,038,690	849,996
LIABILITIES				
Current liabilities				
Payables:				
Accounts	2,848,306	1,004	2,849,310	49,358
Retainages	13,937	0	13,937	0
Intergovernmental	1,601,151	0	1,601,151	0
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	1,349,602	6,855	1,356,457	0
Compensated absences	1,942,533	21,912	1,964,445	239,218
Unearned revenue	343,054	15,863	358,917	0
Claims payable	633,488	0	633,488	0
Total OPEB liability	258,763	0	258,763	0
Subscriptions payable	282,253	0	282,253	0
Notes payable	2,834,605	0	2,834,605	0
Total current liabilities	12,107,692	45,634	12,153,326	288,576

See accompanying notes to the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
December 31, 2025

	Primary Government			Component Unit
	Governmental Activities	Business-type Activities	Total	Whitfield County Health Department
Noncurrent liabilities				
Net pension liability	\$ 15,670,563	\$ 0	\$ 15,670,563	\$ 0
Total OPEB liability	11,278,637	0	11,278,637	0
Proportionate share of net pension liability	0	0	0	2,400,842
Compensated absences	832,514	9,392	841,906	159,478
Subscriptions payable	870,045	0	870,045	0
Notes payable	204,878	0	204,878	0
Total noncurrent liabilities	28,856,637	9,392	28,866,029	2,560,320
Total liabilities	40,964,329	55,026	41,019,355	2,848,896
DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES				
Deferred inflows of resources - pension	0	0	0	483,126
Deferred inflows of resources - OPEB	2,464,600	0	2,464,600	307,080
Total deferred inflows of resources	2,464,600	0	2,464,600	790,206
NET POSITION				
Net investment in capital assets	218,268,229	359,118	218,627,347	100,795
Restricted for:				
Judicial	2,118,481	0	2,118,481	0
Public Safety	4,366,002	0	4,366,002	0
Housing and Development	81,456	0	81,456	0
Grant Specifications	346,781	0	346,781	0
Capital Outlay	13,192,096	0	13,192,096	0
Program income	0	0	0	145,436
OPEB related items	0	0	0	477,951
Unrestricted	8,702,276	15,582,087	24,284,363	3,632,721
Total net position	\$ 247,075,321	\$ 15,941,205	\$ 263,016,526	\$ 4,356,903

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
BALANCE SHEET
GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
December 31, 2025

	General	Special Fire District	American Rescue Plan Act
ASSETS			
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 3,498,725	\$ 1,034,381	\$ 467,603
Receivables (net)			
Accounts	50,643	0	0
Intergovernmental	821,573	119,603	690,726
Taxes	17,453,125	6,056,830	0
Due from other funds	6,579,585	0	0
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	0	0	0
Prepaid items	548,330	0	0
Total assets	\$ 28,951,981	\$ 7,210,814	\$ 1,158,329
LIABILITIES			
Accounts payable	\$ 1,323,412	\$ 84,884	\$ 328,253
Retainage payable	0	0	0
Intergovernmental payables	439	0	0
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	1,163,077	127,003	14,269
Due to other funds	0	5,258,828	204,272
Unearned revenue	78,300	0	264,754
Total liabilities	2,565,228	5,470,715	811,548
DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES			
Unavailable revenue:			
Property taxes	3,244,325	1,580,914	0
Fines and forfeitures	0	0	0
Total deferred inflows of resources	3,244,325	1,580,914	0
FUND BALANCES			
Nonspendable prepaid items	548,330	0	0
Restricted			
Judicial	0	0	0
Public safety	0	159,185	0
Housing and development	0	0	0
Grant specifications	0	0	346,781
Capital outlay	1,441,087	0	0
Committed			
Capital outlay	0	0	0
Assigned			
Public works	0	0	0
Culture and recreation	0	0	0
Housing and development	1,987,471	0	0
Unassigned	19,165,540	0	0
Total fund balances	23,142,428	159,185	346,781
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources, and fund balances	\$ 28,951,981	\$ 7,210,814	\$ 1,158,329

2020 SPLOST	2024 SPLOST	Nonmajor Governmental Funds	Totals
\$ 4,619,355	\$ 6,276,026	\$ 7,613,917	\$ 23,510,007
0	0	2,013,988	2,064,631
0	0	1,319,311	2,951,213
0	2,417,246	632,360	26,559,561
0	0	0	6,579,585
0	0	31,412	31,412
0	0	0	548,330
<u>\$ 4,619,355</u>	<u>\$ 8,693,272</u>	<u>\$ 11,610,988</u>	<u>\$ 62,244,739</u>
\$ 298,192	\$ 304,964	\$ 87,169	\$ 2,426,874
13,937	0	0	13,937
0	1,600,712	0	1,601,151
0	0	45,253	1,349,602
302,490	0	813,995	6,579,585
0	0	0	343,054
<u>614,619</u>	<u>1,905,676</u>	<u>946,417</u>	<u>12,314,203</u>
0	0	1,224,548	6,049,787
0	0	1,656,517	1,656,517
0	0	2,881,065	7,706,304
0	0	0	548,330
0	0	2,118,481	2,118,481
0	0	969,386	1,128,571
0	0	81,456	81,456
0	0	0	346,781
4,004,736	6,787,596	615,078	12,848,497
0	0	3,349,272	3,349,272
0	0	431,186	431,186
0	0	218,647	218,647
0	0	0	1,987,471
0	0	0	19,165,540
<u>4,004,736</u>	<u>6,787,596</u>	<u>7,783,506</u>	<u>42,224,232</u>
<u>\$ 4,619,355</u>	<u>\$ 8,693,272</u>	<u>\$ 11,610,988</u>	<u>\$ 62,244,739</u>

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RECONCILIATION OF THE BALANCE SHEET OF
GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS TO THE
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
December 31, 2025

Total fund balances - total governmental funds **\$ 42,224,232**

Amounts reported for governmental activities in the statement of net position are different because:

Some assets are not financial resources and therefore are not reported in the funds. These are:

Capital assets, net of accumulated depreciation/amortization	\$ 222,803,609	
Investment in joint venture	<u>3,585,934</u>	226,389,543

Revenues in the statement of activities that do not provide current financial resources are reported as deferred inflows of resources in the funds. These are:

Property taxes	\$ 6,049,787	
Fines and forfeitures	<u>1,656,517</u>	7,706,304

Deferred outflows and inflows of resources are applicable to future periods and, therefore, are not reported in the funds. These are:

Deferred outflows of resources:		
Pension	\$ 1,783,927	
OPEB	3,254,763	
Deferred inflows of resources:		
OPEB	<u>(2,464,600)</u>	2,574,090

Internal service funds are used by management to charge the costs of certain activities, such as risk management and employee benefits to individual funds. Assets and liabilities of the internal service funds are included in governmental activities in the statement of net position.

Internal service funds net position	2,355,943
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Some liabilities are not due and payable in the current period and therefore are not reported in the funds. These are:

Net pension liability	\$ (15,670,563)	
OPEB liability	(11,537,400)	
Compensated absences	(2,775,047)	
Subscriptions payable	(1,152,298)	
Notes payable	<u>(3,039,483)</u>	<u>(34,174,791)</u>

Net position of governmental activities	<u><u>\$ 247,075,321</u></u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF REVENUES,
EXPENDITURES, AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	General	Special Fire District	American Rescue Plan Act
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 42,935,310	\$ 13,856,900	\$ 0
Licenses and permits	1,058,403	600	0
Fines, fees and forfeitures	902,287	0	0
Charges for services	4,055,861	0	0
Intergovernmental	5,987,301	181,455	3,385,168
Interest	491,420	0	73,405
Contributions	160,472	2,757	0
Other	2,268,597	19,020	0
Total revenues	57,859,651	14,060,732	3,458,573
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
General Government	12,727,748	0	54,806
Judicial	8,794,662	0	84,138
Public Safety	28,039,228	13,847,105	466,254
Public Works	8,406,745	0	932,020
Health and Welfare	997,369	0	0
Culture and Recreation	2,986,167	0	1,373,543
Housing and Development	3,331,260	0	479,880
Capital outlay	0	0	0
Debt service	6,362,396	0	0
Intergovernmental	0	0	0
Total expenditures	71,645,575	13,847,105	3,390,641
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(13,785,924)	213,627	67,932
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in	2,413,339	0	83,897
Transfers out	(3,395,556)	0	(71,949)
Issuance of short-term debt	6,000,000	0	0
Issuance of long-term debt	1,432,899	0	0
Sale of capital assets	88,386	43,343	0
Total other financing sources (uses)	6,539,068	43,343	11,948
Net change in fund balance	(7,246,856)	256,970	79,880
Fund balances, January 1, as previously reported	30,022,486	(97,785)	266,901
Error correction	366,798	0	0
Fund balances, January 1, as restated	30,389,284	(97,785)	266,901
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 23,142,428	\$ 159,185	\$ 346,781

2020 SPLOST	2024 SPLOST	Nonmajor Governmental Funds	Totals
\$ 0	\$ 25,783,439	\$ 872,805	\$ 83,448,454
0	0	0	1,059,003
0	0	563,697	1,465,984
0	0	2,206,008	6,261,869
0	0	1,971,605	11,525,529
120,711	73,807	45,862	805,205
0	0	7,130	170,359
0	128,031	143,715	2,559,363
120,711	25,985,277	5,810,822	107,295,766
0	0	0	12,782,554
0	0	869,188	9,747,988
0	0	3,699,353	46,051,940
0	0	541,458	9,880,223
0	0	243,497	1,240,866
0	0	0	4,359,710
0	0	191,488	4,002,628
3,753,027	13,350,317	3,325,608	20,428,952
0	0	616,110	6,978,506
0	8,982,950	0	8,982,950
3,753,027	22,333,267	9,486,702	124,456,317
(3,632,316)	3,652,010	(3,675,880)	(17,160,551)
0	0	3,338,217	5,835,453
0	0	(1,117,948)	(4,585,453)
0	0	0	6,000,000
0	2,784,275	0	4,217,174
0	0	45,975	177,704
0	2,784,275	2,266,244	11,644,878
(3,632,316)	6,436,285	(1,409,636)	(5,515,673)
7,637,052	351,311	9,193,142	47,373,107
0	0	0	366,798
7,637,052	351,311	9,193,142	47,739,905
\$ 4,004,736	\$ 6,787,596	\$ 7,783,506	\$ 42,224,232

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RECONCILIATION OF THE STATEMENT OF
REVENUES, EXPENDITURES, AND CHANGES IN
FUND BALANCES OF GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
TO THE STATEMENT OF ACTIVITIES
For the year ended December 31, 2025

Net change in fund balances - total governmental funds **\$ (5,515,673)**

Amounts reported for governmental activities in the statement of activities are different because:

Governmental funds report capital outlays as expenditures. However, in the statement of activities, the cost of those assets is allocated over their estimated useful lives and reported as depreciation/amortization expense.

Capital outlays	\$ 17,799,873	
Depreciation/amortization	<u>(11,567,563)</u>	6,232,310

In the statement of activities, the gain/loss on the disposal of assets is reported, whereas in the governmental funds, the proceeds from the sale of capital assets increases financial resources.

Cost of assets disposed	\$ (1,271,118)	
Related accumulated depreciation	<u>1,183,383</u>	(87,735)

Governmental funds report pension contributions as expenditures. However, in the statement of activities, the cost of pension benefits earned net of employee contributions is reported as pension expense.

Cost of benefits earned net of employee contributions		(3,814,541)
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Governmental funds report OPEB contributions as expenditures. However, in the statement of activities, the cost of OPEB benefits earned net of employee contributions is reported as OPEB expense.

OPEB contributions	\$ 258,763	
Cost of benefits earned net of employee contributions	<u>(830,191)</u>	(571,428)

The proceeds of debt issuance, net of premiums, discounts and issuance costs provide current financial resources to governmental funds, but issuing debt increases long-term liabilities in the statement of net position. Repayment of debt principal is an expenditure in the governmental funds, but the repayment reduces long-term liabilities in the statement of net position. In addition, interest on long-term debt is not recognized in the governmental funds until due, but is recognized in the statement of activities as it accrues.

Issuance of short-term debt	(6,000,000)	
Issuance of long-term debt	(4,217,174)	
Debt principal payments - short-term	6,000,000	
Debt principal payments - long-term	<u>886,580</u>	(3,330,594)

Revenues in the statement of activities that do not provide current financial resources are not reported as revenues in the funds.

Unavailable revenue:		
Property taxes	\$ 1,222,052	
Fines and forfeitures	<u>7,786</u>	1,229,838

The change in the value of the government's investment in a joint venture is not recognized in the governmental funds because it does not involve current financial resources. However, in the statement of activities, the change in the value of the County's share of the net position of the joint venture is included as a net increase (decrease) in net position.

Change in investment in joint venture:		2,076,414
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Internal service funds are used by management to charge the costs of certain activities, such as risk management and employee benefits to individual funds. Assets and liabilities of the internal service funds are included in governmental activities in the statement of net position.

Change in net position of internal service funds:		86,531
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Some expenses reported in the statement of activities do not require the use of current financial resources and are not reported as expenditures in governmental funds.

Compensated absences		<u>(236,552)</u>
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Change in net position of governmental activities		<u><u>\$ (3,931,430)</u></u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
GENERAL FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Budget		Actual	Variance with Final Budget
	Original	Final		
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 47,751,000	\$ 47,296,961	\$ 42,935,310	\$ (4,361,651)
Licenses and permits	959,300	1,065,559	1,058,403	(7,156)
Fines, fees and forfeitures	1,002,000	891,577	902,287	10,710
Charges for services	4,453,850	3,973,450	4,055,861	82,411
Intergovernmental	3,108,356	7,209,105	5,987,301	(1,221,804)
Interest	1,000,000	491,420	491,420	0
Contributions	10,000	12,000	160,472	148,472
Other	1,832,660	2,234,024	2,268,597	34,573
Total revenues	60,117,166	63,174,096	57,859,651	(5,314,445)
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
General Government				
Administration	949,583	1,470,895	1,470,895	0
Board of Elections	621,154	631,762	574,181	57,581
Finance	745,313	989,745	986,452	3,293
Information Technology	1,260,287	1,295,163	1,295,163	0
Human Resources	570,414	628,901	547,675	81,226
Tax Commissioner	2,167,218	2,239,031	2,131,540	107,491
Tax Assessor	2,259,047	2,106,545	1,972,780	133,765
Board of Equalization	25,120	82,691	82,691	0
Building and Grounds	2,387,809	2,375,685	2,335,614	40,071
Public Information	131,401	174,422	174,422	0
Attorney Fees	180,000	180,000	165,461	14,539
Liability Insurance	839,244	846,007	846,007	0
Audit Fees	88,000	88,000	78,022	9,978
Other	68,344	68,344	66,845	1,499
Judicial				
Judicial Administration	792,910	805,640	765,199	40,441
Judge Morris' Office	56,345	76,769	76,769	0
Judge Boyett's Office	56,345	72,332	72,332	0
Judge Willbank's Office	56,345	57,159	57,159	0
Judge Minter's Office	57,845	75,811	75,811	0
Clerk of Superior Court	1,183,120	1,227,691	1,227,691	0
District Attorney	1,385,925	1,753,833	1,753,833	0
Magistrate Court	1,286,621	1,316,324	1,304,992	11,332
Probate Court	753,044	770,017	723,731	46,286
Juvenile Court	1,277,730	1,383,374	1,334,565	48,809
Public Defender	1,237,782	1,402,580	1,402,580	0
Public Safety				
Sheriff's Department	10,817,847	13,275,084	13,273,476	1,608
Correctional Center	12,721,625	13,562,035	13,562,035	0
Coroner	141,676	141,676	136,147	5,529
Animal Control	399,912	410,520	407,704	2,816
Emergency Management	413,402	417,645	409,866	7,779
Emergency Medical Services	250,000	250,000	250,000	0
Public Works				
Public Works	8,672,800	8,406,745	8,406,745	0
Health and Welfare				
Physical and Mental Health	255,000	255,000	255,000	0
Family Support Council	69,800	69,800	69,800	0
Family and Children Services	80,000	80,000	80,000	0
Department of Veterans Service	984	984	600	384
Pauper Fund	17,000	17,000	14,250	2,750
Senior Center	612,319	622,927	577,719	45,208
Culture and Recreation				
Parks and Recreation	2,350,982	2,397,658	2,352,167	45,491
Library	634,000	634,000	634,000	0

See accompanying notes to the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
GENERAL FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Budget		Actual	Variance with Final Budget
	Original	Final		
EXPENDITURES (continued)				
Current				
Housing and Development				
County Extension Service	\$ 187,624	\$ 187,624	\$ 164,331	\$ 23,293
Inspections and Enforcement	603,607	633,645	603,635	30,010
County Planner	48,000	48,000	48,000	0
Metropolitan Planning Organization	550,239	552,361	490,679	61,682
County Engineer	813,554	828,405	782,462	45,943
Timber Protection	7,875	7,875	7,656	219
Community Development	232,709	236,952	226,275	10,677
Intergovernmental payments	960,095	1,027,648	1,008,222	19,426
Debt service				
Principal - short-term	0	6,000,000	6,000,000	0
Principal - long-term	48,000	281,000	280,601	399
Interest	2,000	67,250	67,095	155
Issue costs	0	14,700	14,700	0
Total expenditures	61,327,996	72,545,255	71,645,575	899,680
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	(1,210,830)	(9,371,159)	(13,785,924)	(4,414,765)
Other financing sources (uses)				
Transfers in	1,654,000	1,392,388	2,413,339	1,020,951
Transfers out	(1,637,093)	(3,395,556)	(3,395,556)	0
Issuance of short-term debt	0	6,000,000	6,000,000	0
Issuance of long-term debt	150,000	1,432,899	1,432,899	0
Sale of capital assets	300,000	70,485	88,386	17,901
Total other financing sources (uses)	466,907	5,500,216	6,539,068	1,038,852
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(743,923)	(3,870,943)	(7,246,856)	(3,375,913)
Fund balances, January 1, as previously reported	743,923	3,870,943	30,022,486	26,151,543
Error correction	0	0	366,798	366,798
Fund balances, January 1, as restated	743,923	3,870,943	30,389,284	26,518,341
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 23,142,428	\$ 23,142,428

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SPECIAL FIRE DISTRICT SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Budget		Actual	Variance with Final Budget
	Original	Final		
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 13,080,000	\$ 13,595,140	\$ 13,856,900	\$ 261,760
Licenses and permits	0	0	600	600
Intergovernmental	0	0	181,455	181,455
Contributions	0	0	2,757	2,757
Other	240,000	240,000	19,020	(220,980)
Total revenues	13,320,000	13,835,140	14,060,732	225,592
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
Public Safety	14,101,263	13,847,105	13,847,105	0
Total expenditures	14,101,263	13,847,105	13,847,105	0
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	(781,263)	(11,965)	213,627	225,592
Other financing sources (uses)				
Sale of capital assets	0	12,600	43,343	30,743
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(781,263)	635	256,970	256,335
Fund balances, January 1	781,263	(635)	(97,785)	(97,150)
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 159,185	\$ 159,185

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
AMERICAN RESCUE PLAN ACT SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Budget			Variance with
	Original	Final	Actual	Final Budget
REVENUES				
Intergovernmental	\$ 5,590,628	\$ 3,307,520	\$ 3,385,168	\$ 77,648
Interest	150,000	73,405	73,405	0
Total revenues	5,740,628	3,380,925	3,458,573	77,648
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
General Government	0	54,806	54,806	0
Judicial	106,926	84,138	84,138	0
Public Safety	300,000	466,254	466,254	0
Public Works	2,254,979	932,020	932,020	0
Culture and Recreation	2,928,723	1,373,543	1,373,543	0
Housing and Development	0	479,880	479,880	0
Total expenditures	5,590,628	3,390,641	3,390,641	0
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	150,000	(9,716)	67,932	77,648
Other financing sources (uses)				
Transfers in	0	83,897	83,897	0
Transfers out	(150,000)	(71,949)	(71,949)	0
Total other financing sources (uses)	(150,000)	11,948	11,948	0
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	0	2,232	79,880	77,648
Fund balances, January 1	0	(2,232)	266,901	269,133
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 346,781	\$ 346,781

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
PROPRIETARY FUNDS
December 31, 2025

	Business-Type Activities				Governmental Activities
	Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	Whitfield Transit System	Totals	Internal Service Funds
ASSETS					
Current assets					
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 85,417	\$ 85,417	\$ 2,900,548
Receivables (net)					
Accounts	0	0	110,468	110,468	510,315
Intergovernmental	0	0	171,567	171,567	0
Total current assets	0	0	367,452	367,452	3,410,863
Noncurrent assets					
Depreciable capital assets (net)	0	0	359,118	359,118	0
Investment in joint venture	12,270,304	2,999,357	0	15,269,661	0
Total noncurrent assets	12,270,304	2,999,357	359,118	15,628,779	0
Total assets	12,270,304	2,999,357	726,570	15,996,231	3,410,863
LIABILITIES					
Current liabilities					
Accounts payable	0	0	1,004	1,004	421,432
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	0	0	6,855	6,855	0
Compensated absences	0	0	21,912	21,912	0
Unearned revenue	0	0	15,863	15,863	0
Claims reserve	0	0	0	0	633,488
Total current liabilities	0	0	45,634	45,634	1,054,920
Noncurrent liabilities					
Compensated absences	0	0	9,392	9,392	0
Total noncurrent liabilities	0	0	9,392	9,392	0
Total liabilities	0	0	55,026	55,026	1,054,920
NET POSITION					
Net investment in capital assets	0	0	359,118	359,118	0
Unrestricted	12,270,304	2,999,357	312,426	15,582,087	2,355,943
Total net position	\$ 12,270,304	\$ 2,999,357	\$ 671,544	\$ 15,941,205	\$ 2,355,943

See accompanying notes to the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENSES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND NET POSITION
PROPRIETARY FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Business-Type Activities				Governmental Activities
	Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	Whitfield Transit System	Totals	Internal Service Funds
OPERATING REVENUES					
Charges for sales and services	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 372,326	\$ 372,326	\$ 12,327,732
Other	0	0	26	26	65,000
Total operating revenues	0	0	372,352	372,352	12,392,732
OPERATING EXPENSES					
Costs of sales and services	0	0	788,619	788,619	0
Personal services	0	0	36,714	36,714	0
Depreciation	0	0	67,188	67,188	0
Premiums and administrative fees	0	0	0	0	3,001,200
Claims paid	0	0	0	0	9,305,001
Total operating expenses	0	0	892,521	892,521	12,306,201
Operating income (loss)	0	0	(520,169)	(520,169)	86,531
Non-operating revenues (expenses)					
Intergovernmental	0	0	776,174	776,174	0
Gain (loss) on joint venture	1,148,650	(86,372)	0	1,062,278	0
Total non-operating revenues (expenses)	1,148,650	(86,372)	776,174	1,838,452	0
Net income (loss before transfers)	1,148,650	(86,372)	256,005	1,318,283	86,531
Transfers in (out)					
Transfers out	(1,250,000)	0	0	(1,250,000)	0
Change in net position	(101,350)	(86,372)	256,005	68,283	86,531
Net position, January 1	12,371,654	3,085,729	415,539	15,872,922	2,269,412
Net position, December 31	\$ 12,270,304	\$ 2,999,357	\$ 671,544	\$ 15,941,205	\$ 2,355,943

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
PROPRIETARY FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Business-Type Activities				Governmental Activities
	Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	Whitfield Transit System	Totals	Internal Service Funds
Cash flows from operating activities:					
Receipts from customers and users	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 317,075	\$ 317,075	\$ 11,991,562
Payments to suppliers	0	0	(789,155)	(789,155)	(12,123,864)
Payments to employees	0	0	(36,022)	(36,022)	0
Other receipts	0	0	26	26	65,000
Net cash provided (used) by operating activities	0	0	(508,076)	(508,076)	(67,302)
Cash flows from non-capital financing activities:					
Intergovernmental receipts	0	0	797,437	797,437	0
Payments to other funds	(1,250,000)	0	0	(1,250,000)	0
Net cash provided (used) by non-capital financing activities	(1,250,000)	0	797,437	(452,563)	0
Cash flows from capital financing activities:					
Purchases of capital assets	0	0	(363,672)	(363,672)	0
Cash flows from investing activities:					
Receipts from joint venture	1,250,000	0	0	1,250,000	0
Net increase (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	0	0	(74,311)	(74,311)	(67,302)
Cash and cash equivalents, January 1	0	0	159,728	159,728	2,967,850
Cash and cash equivalents, December 31	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 85,417	\$ 85,417	\$ 2,900,548
Reconciliation of operating income (loss) to net cash provided (used) by operating activities:					
Operating income (loss)	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ (520,169)	\$ (520,169)	\$ 86,531
Adjustments to reconcile operating income (loss) to net cash provided (used) by operating activities:					
Depreciation expense	0	0	67,188	67,188	0
(Increase) decrease in accounts receivable	0	0	(58,725)	(58,725)	(336,170)
Increase (decrease) in accounts payable	0	0	(536)	(536)	68,686
Increase (decrease) in accrued payroll liabilities	0	0	692	692	0
Increase (decrease) in unearned revenue	0	0	3,474	3,474	0
Increase (decrease) in claims reserve	0	0	0	0	113,651
Total adjustments	0	0	12,093	12,093	(153,833)
Net cash provided (used) by operating activities	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ (508,076)	\$ (508,076)	\$ (67,302)

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FIDUCIARY FUNDS
STATEMENT OF FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
December 31, 2025

	Custodial Funds
ASSETS	
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 14,727,326
Taxes receivable	<u>76,706,052</u>
Total assets	<u>91,433,378</u>
LIABILITIES	
Due to others	<u>90,268,404</u>
NET POSITION	
Restricted for individuals, organizations, and other governments	<u><u>\$ 1,164,974</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FIDUCIARY FUNDS
STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Custodial Funds
ADDITIONS	
Taxes collected for other agencies	\$ 133,655,780
Court fees collected for other agencies	3,310,754
Court individual cases	3,060,365
Sheriff fees collected	399,102
Sheriff inmate account deposits	1,235,637
Total additions	141,661,638
DEDUCTIONS	
Taxes distributed to other agencies	133,671,786
Court fees distributed to other agencies	3,302,253
Payments to others	3,041,617
Sheriff fees distributed to other agencies	341,666
Payments from inmates to others	1,219,673
Total deductions	141,576,995
Change in net position	84,643
Net position - beginning	1,080,331
Net position - ending	\$ 1,164,974

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

1. Description of Government Unit

Whitfield County, Georgia (the County) was incorporated in 1851 under the provisions of the Constitution of the State of Georgia. The County operates under a Board-Administrator form of government. The County is governed by a board of five commissioners elected by the voters of the County.

The County provides a full range of governmental services, including public safety, public works, health and welfare services, recreational programs, housing and development, solid waste management services, and transit services.

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies

A. Description of Government-wide Financial Statements

The government-wide financial statements (i.e., the statement of net position and the statement of activities) report information on all of the nonfiduciary activities of the primary government and its component units. All fiduciary activities are reported only in the fund financial statements. Governmental activities, which normally are supported by taxes, intergovernmental revenues, and other nonexchange transactions, are reported separately from business-type activities, which rely to a significant extent on fees and charges to external customers for support. Likewise, the primary government is reported separately from certain legally separate component units for which the primary government is financially accountable.

B. Reporting Entity

The reporting entity is comprised of the primary government, component units, and other organizations that are included to ensure that the financial statements are not misleading. The primary government of the County consists of all funds, departments, boards, and agencies that are not legally separate from the County.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

B. Reporting Entity, continued

Component units are legally separate organizations for which the County is financially accountable. The County is financially accountable for an organization if the County appoints a voting majority of the organization's governing board and (1) the County is able to significantly influence the programs or services performed or provided by the organizations; (2) the County is legally entitled to or can otherwise access the organization's resources; (3) the County is legally obligated or has otherwise assumed the responsibility to finance the deficits of, or provide financial support to, the organization; or (4) the County is obligated for the debt of the organization. Component units also may include organizations that are fiscally dependent on the County in that the County approves the budget, levies their taxes, or issues their debt.

The component unit column included on the government-wide financial statements reports the financial data of the County's discretely presented component unit separately to emphasize that it is legally separate from the County.

Whitfield County Health Department (Board of Health) – The Board of Health provides health care services and health education to residents of Whitfield County. The Board of Health receives financial support from Whitfield County, Georgia, the State of Georgia, and the Federal Government. The County Commission appoints a majority of the Board of Directors and approves the budget of the Board of Health. The Board of Health issued separately audited financial statements with a fiscal year ending June 30. Copies of these financial statements may be obtained from their administrative office at Whitfield County Health Department, 1710 Whitehouse Court, Dalton, GA 30720.

Certain county officials collect and disburse taxes, fees, fines, and other trust and agency receipts. Separate records of accountability are maintained for such receipts. For purposes of this report, these records are included as a part of custodial funds with remittances to the General Fund from these officials recorded as revenue. Operating costs for these officials are included as a part of the County's General Fund. These units include:

Tax Commissioner
Sheriff

Probate Court
Magistrate Court

Clerk of Superior Court
Juvenile Court

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

C. Basis of Presentation – Government-wide Financial Statements

While separate government-wide and fund financial statements are presented, they are interrelated. The governmental activities column incorporates data from governmental funds, while business-type activities incorporate data from the government's enterprise funds. Separate financial statements are provided for governmental funds, proprietary funds, and fiduciary funds, even though the latter are excluded from the government-wide financial statements.

As a general rule, the effect of interfund activity has been eliminated from the government-wide financial statements.

D. Basis of Presentation – Fund Financial Statements

The fund financial statements provide information about the government's funds, including its fiduciary funds and blended component units. Separate statements for each fund category—governmental, proprietary, and fiduciary—are presented. The emphasis of fund financial statements is on major governmental and enterprise funds, each displayed in a separate column. All remaining governmental and enterprise funds are aggregated and reported as nonmajor funds. Major individual governmental and enterprise funds are reported as separate columns in the fund financial statements.

The County reports the following major governmental funds:

General Fund – The General Fund accounts for all financial resources except those required to be accounted for in another fund. The general fund balance is available to the County for any purpose, provided it is expended or transferred according to the general laws of Georgia.

Special Fire District Fund – Accounts for the revenues of a specific property tax levy for all areas outside of the City of Dalton for funding the fire departments located in Whitfield County.

American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund – Accounts for the revenues and expenditures of the American Rescue Plan Act Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Fund.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

D. Basis of Presentation – Fund Financial Statements, continued

SPLOST 2020 Capital Projects Fund – Accounts for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2020 for the purpose of financing long-term capital projects.

SPLOST 2024 Capital Projects Fund – Accounts for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2024 for the purpose of financing long-term capital projects.

The County reports the following major proprietary funds:

Dalton/Whitfield Solid Waste Management Fund – Accounts for the activities of the County's 50% equity interest in the joint venture with the City of Dalton.

Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center – Accounts for the activities of the County's 50% equity interest in the joint venture with the City of Dalton.

Whitfield Transit System – This fund is used to account for the operating income, intergovernmental grants, and changes in net position for County's transit system.

Additionally, the government reports the following fund types:

Governmental Funds

Special Revenue Funds – Accounts for the proceeds of specific revenue sources that are legally or donor restricted to be expended for specified purposes.

Debt Service Funds – Accounts for the accumulation of resources and payment of general government long-term debt principal and interest from governmental resources.

Capital Projects Funds – Accounts for financial resources to be used for the acquisition or construction of specifically planned projects (other than those financed by proprietary funds).

Internal Service Funds – Accounts for the accumulation of resources to be used for health and workers' compensation insurance costs, as the County is partially self-insured.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

D. Basis of Presentation – Fund Financial Statements, continued

Fiduciary Fund Types

Custodial Funds – Custodial Funds are fiduciary in nature and are accounted for using the accrual basis of accounting. These funds are used to account for assets that are held for others.

During the course of operations the government has activity between funds for various purposes. Any residual balances outstanding at year end are reported as due from/to other funds and advances to/from other funds. While these balances are reported in fund financial statements, certain eliminations are made in the preparation of the government-wide financial statements. Balances between the funds included in governmental activities (i.e., the governmental funds) are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as internal balances in the governmental activities column. Similarly, balances between the funds included in business-type activities (i.e., the enterprise funds) are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as internal balances in the business-type activities column.

Further, certain activity occurs during the year involving transfers of resources between funds. In fund financial statements these amounts are reported at gross amounts as transfers in/out. While reported in fund financial statements, certain eliminations are made in the preparation of the government-wide financial statements. Transfers between the funds included in governmental activities are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as transfers in the governmental activities column. Similarly, balances between the funds included in business-type activities are eliminated so that only the net amount is included as transfers in the business-type activities column.

The accounting and financial reporting treatment is determined by the applicable measurement focus and basis of accounting. Measurement focus indicates the type of resources being measured such as current financial resources or economic resources. The basis of accounting indicates the timing of transactions or events for recognition in the financial statements.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

E. Measurement Focus and Basis of Accounting

The government-wide financial statements are reported using the economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting. Revenues are recorded when earned and expenses are recorded when a liability is incurred, regardless of the timing of related cash flows. Property taxes are recognized as revenues in the year for which they are levied. Grants and similar items are recognized as revenue as soon as all eligibility requirements imposed by the provider have been met.

The governmental fund financial statements are reported using the current financial resources measurement focus and the modified accrual basis of accounting. Revenues are recognized as soon as they are both measurable and available. Revenues are considered to be available when they are collectible within the current period or soon enough thereafter to pay liabilities of the current period. For this purpose, the government considers revenues to be available if they are collected within 60 days of the end of the current fiscal period.

Expenditures generally are recorded when a liability is incurred, as under accrual basis of accounting. However, debt service expenditures, as well as expenditures related to compensated absences, and claims and judgments are recorded only when payment is due. General capital asset acquisitions are reported as expenditures in governmental funds. Issuance of long-term debt and acquisitions under leases are reported as other financing sources.

Property taxes, sales taxes, franchise taxes, licenses, and interest associated with the current fiscal period are all considered to be susceptible to accrual and so have been recognized as revenues of the current fiscal period. Entitlements are recorded as revenues when all eligibility requirements are met, including any time requirements, and the amount is received during the period or within the availability period for this revenue source (within 60 days of year-end). Expenditure-driven grants are recognized as revenue when the qualifying expenditures have been incurred and all other eligibility requirements have been met, and the amount is received during the period or within the availability period for this revenue source (within 60 days of year-end). All other revenue items are considered to be measurable and available only when cash is received by the government.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

E. Measurement Focus and Basis of Accounting, continued

The proprietary funds are reported using the economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting.

The fiduciary funds are reported using the economic resources measurement focus and the accrual basis of accounting.

F. Revenues and Expenditures/Expenses

Program revenues include: 1) charges to customers or applicants who purchase, use, or directly benefit from goods, services, or privileges provided by a given function or segment, and 2) grants and contributions that are restricted to meeting the operational or capital requirements of a particular function or segment. All taxes, including those dedicated for specific purposes, and other internally dedicated resources are reported as general revenues rather than as program revenues.

Proprietary funds distinguish operating revenues and expenses from non-operating items. Operating revenues and expenses generally result from providing services and producing and delivering goods in connection with a proprietary fund's principal ongoing operations. The principal operating revenues of the enterprise funds are charges to customers for sales and services. Operating expenses for enterprise funds include the cost of sales and services, administrative expenses, and depreciation on capital assets. All revenues and expenses not meeting this definition are reported as non-operating revenues and expenses.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

G. Budgetary Information

The county adopts an annual operating budget for all governmental funds except the capital projects funds, which have an adopted project length budget. The budget resolution reflects the total of each department's appropriation in each fund.

The legal level of control (the level at which expenditures may not legally exceed appropriations for each adopted annual operating budget) is the department level within the General Fund and at the functional level for each of the remaining individual funds. Any change in total to a fund or departmental appropriation within the General Fund requires approval of the Board of Commissioners. During the year, the Board of Commissioners approved budget revisions. All unexpended annual appropriations lapse at the end of the fiscal year.

H. Cash and Investments

Cash and cash equivalents include amounts in demand deposits as well as short-term investments with a maturity date within three months of the date acquired by the County.

The statutes of the State of Georgia authorize the County to invest in the following types of investments:

- Obligations of the U. S. Government
- State of Georgia obligations and other States
- Obligations of any corporation of the government
- Repurchase agreements
- Prime banker's acceptances
- Certificates of deposit or time deposit of any national state bank or savings and loan which have deposits insured by the FDIC or FSLIC;
- The State of Georgia local government investment pool (Georgia Fund 1)

Cash and cash equivalents, as reported in the statement of cash flows, includes amounts in demand deposits, amounts with fiscal agents, and investments with an original maturity at three months or less.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

H. Cash and Investments, continued

Any investment or deposit in excess of the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC) insured amount must be secured by either (a) security pledges of 110% of an equivalent amount of State or U.S. obligations, or (b) the financial institute participating in the Georgia Secure Deposit Program, administered by the Office of State Treasurer.

Georgia Fund 1, created by OCGA 36-83-8, is a stable asset value investment pool that follows Fitch's criteria for AAAf/S1 rated money market funds and is regulated by the Georgia Office of the State Treasurer. The pool is not registered with the SEC as an investment company. The pool's primary objectives are safety of capital, investment income, liquidity and diversification while maintaining principal (\$1.00 per share value). The asset value is calculated weekly to ensure stability. The pool distributes earnings (net of management fees) on a monthly basis and determines participant's shares sold and redeemed based on \$1.00 per share. The pool also adjusts the value of its investments to net asset value as of year-end and the County's investment in the Georgia Fund 1 is reported at net asset value. The County considers amounts held in Georgia Fund 1 as cash equivalents for financial statement presentation.

The County's nonparticipating interest-earning investment contracts are recorded at cost. The remaining investments are recorded at fair value. Increases or decreases in fair value during the year are recognized as a component of interest income.

I. Intergovernmental Receivables

Receivables from state, federal, and local governments are recorded as revenue for the period of the allocation or as earned based on expenditures made for which reimbursement is due.

J. Receivables

All trade and property tax receivables are reported net of an allowance for uncollectible accounts. Unbilled charges are accrued as receivables and revenue at the end of the current year.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

K. Prepaid Items

Payments made to vendors that benefit future reporting periods are recorded as prepaid items. Prepaid items in the governmental funds are accounted for using the consumption method.

L. Capital Assets

Capital assets, which include property, plant, equipment, intangible, and infrastructure assets (e.g. roads, bridges, sidewalks, culverts and similar items), are reported in the applicable governmental or business type activities columns in the government-wide financial statements. Capital assets are defined by the County as assets with an initial, individual cost of \$10,000 and an estimated useful life of two years or more. Such assets are recorded at historical cost or estimated historical cost if purchased or constructed. Donated capital assets are recorded at acquisition value.

Depreciation and amortization is computed using the straight-line method over the estimated useful lives of the respective assets ranging as follows:

	<u>in Years</u>
Land	N/A
Buildings	7-40
Equipment and fixtures	3-20
Vehicles	5-10
Infrastructure	40
Intangible right-to-use	
Software	2-3

The costs of normal maintenance and repairs that do not add value or materially extend the life of the asset are charged to operations as incurred. Costs of major additions and improvements are capitalized.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

M. Deferred Outflows/Inflows of Resources

In addition to assets, the statement of financial position will sometimes report a separate section for deferred outflows of resources. This separate financial statement element, deferred outflows of resources, represents a consumption of net assets that applies to a future period(s) and so will not be recognized as an outflow of resources (expense/ expenditure) until then. The County reports deferred outflows of resources for their defined benefit pension and other postemployment benefit plans.

In addition to liabilities, the statement of financial position will sometimes report a separate section for deferred inflows of resources. This separate financial statement element, deferred inflows of resources, represents an acquisition of net assets that applies to a future period(s) and so will not be recognized as an inflow of resources (revenue) until that time. The County has only one type of item, which arises only under a modified accrual basis of accounting that qualifies for reporting in this category. Accordingly, the item, unavailable revenue, is reported only in the governmental funds balance sheet. The governmental funds report unavailable revenues from three sources: property taxes, and fines, fees, and forfeitures. These amounts are deferred and recognized as an inflow of resources in the period that the amounts become available. The County also reports deferred inflows of resources for defined benefit pension plan and other postemployment benefit plan.

N. Net Position Flow Assumption

Sometimes the County will fund outlays for a particular purpose from both restricted (e.g., restricted bond or grant proceeds) and unrestricted resources. In order to calculate the amounts to report as restricted – net position and unrestricted – net position in the government-wide and proprietary fund financial statements, a flow assumption must be made about the order in which the resources are considered to be applied. It is the County's policy to consider restricted – net position to have been depleted before unrestricted – net position is applied.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

O. Fund Balance Flow Assumption

Sometimes the County will fund outlays for a particular purpose from both restricted and unrestricted resources (the total of committed, assigned, and unassigned fund balance). In order to calculate the amounts to report as restricted, committed, assigned, and unassigned fund balance in the governmental fund financial statements a flow assumption must be made about the order in which the resources are considered to be applied. It is the County's policy to consider restricted fund balance to have been depleted before using any of the components of unrestricted fund balance. Further, when the components of unrestricted fund balance can be used for the same purpose, committed fund balance is depleted first, followed by assigned fund balance. Unassigned fund balance is applied last.

P. Restricted Assets and Restricted Net Position

Restricted Assets consist of sinking fund resources in the Capital Acquisition Capital Projects Fund are restricted to the payment of bond principal and interest requirements as they become due.

Restricted net position is equal to the excess of the restricted assets funded from operations over the liabilities to be paid with restricted assets which are due in one year or less.

Q. Fund Balances – Governmental Funds

In the fund financial statements, governmental funds report the following classifications of fund balance:

Nonspendable – includes amounts that cannot be spent because they are either not spendable in form or are legally or contractually required to be maintained intact. All amounts reported as nonspendable by the County are nonspendable in form. The County has not reported any amounts that are legally or contractually required to be maintained intact.

Restricted – includes amounts restricted by external sources (creditors, laws of other governments, etc.) or by constitutional provision or enabling legislation.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

Q. Fund Balances – Governmental Funds, continued

Committed – includes amounts that can only be used for specific purposes. Committed fund balance is reported pursuant to resolutions passed by the Board of Commissioners, the County's highest level of decision making authority, which include the language "committed for the purpose of". Commitments may be modified or rescinded only through adoption of a subsequent resolution, which shall refer to the original resolution by its number.

Assigned - consists of amounts that are intended to be used by the County for a specific purpose, but do not meet the definition of restricted or committed fund balance. Intent can only be expressed by the Commission. Assigned Fund Balance differs from Committed Fund Balance in that assignments do not require a resolution. Through resolution, the Commission has authorized the Chief Financial Officer to assign fund balances.

Unassigned – includes amounts that do not fall into one of the above four categories. This classification represents fund balance that has not been assigned to other funds and that has not been restricted, committed, or assigned to specific purposes within the General Fund. The General Fund is the only fund that should report this category of fund balance.

R. Compensated Absences

Compensated absence benefits are accrued as a liability as the benefits are earned if the employees' rights to receive compensation are attributable to services already rendered and it is probable that the employer will compensate the employees for the benefits through paid time off or some other means. Employees are permitted to accumulate paid time off up to 20 days. The total compensated absence liability is reported on the government-wide financial statements. Proprietary funds report the total compensated liability in each individual fund at the fund reporting level. Governmental funds report the compensated absence liability at the fund reporting level only "when due." In accordance with GASB Statement No. 101, *Compensated Absences*, the sick leave and employee leave bank portion of the County's liability is accrued by estimated expected sick leave and employee leave bank time to be used by employees with current economic resources.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

S. Long-Term Obligations

In the government-wide financial statements, and proprietary fund types in the fund financial statements, long-term debt and other long-term obligations are reported as liabilities in the applicable governmental activities, business-type activities, or proprietary fund type statement of net position. Bond premiums and discounts, as well as prepaid bond insurance, are deferred and amortized over the life of the bonds using the straight-line method. Bonds payable are reported net of the applicable bond premium or discount. Prepaid bond insurance is reported as deferred charges and amortized over the term of the debt. Issuance costs are recognized during the current period.

In the fund financial statements, governmental fund types, bond premiums and discounts, as well as issuance costs, are recognized during the current period. The face amount of debt issued is reported as another financing source. Premiums received on debt issuances are reported as other financial sources while discounts on debt issuances are reported as other financing uses. Issuance costs, even if withheld from the actual net proceeds received, are reported as debt service expenditures.

T. Pensions and OPEB

For purposes of measuring the net pension liability, deferred outflows of resources and deferred inflows of resources related to pensions or OPEB, and pension or OPEB expense, information about the fiduciary net position of the Whitfield County Retirement Plan (the Plan) and additions to/deductions from the Plan's fiduciary net position have been determined on the same basis as they are reported by the Plan. For this purpose, benefit payments (including refunds of employee contributions) are recognized when due and payable in accordance with the benefit terms. Investments are reported at fair value.

U. Capital Contributions

Federal, state and local government assistance in the form of grants that are permanent in nature and restricted for the construction or acquisition of specific property and equipment is recorded as an asset and as non-operating revenue.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies (continued)

V. Use of Estimates in the Preparation of the Financial Statements

The preparation of financial statements in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles requires management to make estimates and assumptions that affect the reported amounts of assets and liabilities, disclosure of contingent assets and liabilities at the date of the financial statements and the reported amounts of revenues and expenses during the reporting period. Actual results could differ from those estimates.

3. Deposit and Investment Risk

Custodial Credit Risk – Deposits

Custodial credit risk is the risk that in the event of a financial institution failure, the County's deposits may not be returned. The County has no formal policy, but follows the State of Georgia requirement that all deposits be federally insured or fully collateralized.

Interest Rate Risk

Interest rate risk is the risk that changes in interest rates may adversely affect an investment's fair value. The County has no formal investment policy that limits investment maturities as a means of managing its exposure to fair value losses arising from increasing interest rates.

Credit Risk

State statutes authorize the government to invest in obligations of the United States Treasury and of its agencies and instrumentalities; bonds or certificates of indebtedness of this state and of its agencies and instrumentalities; certificates of deposits of banks insured by FDIC; prime bankers' acceptances; the State of Georgia Local Government Investment Pool; repurchase agreements; bonds, debentures, notes or other evidence of indebtedness of any solvent corporation subject to certain conditions.

Fair Value

The County categorizes its fair value measurements within the fair value hierarchy established by generally accepted accounting principles. The hierarchy is based on the valuation inputs used to measure the fair value of the asset. Level 1 inputs are quoted prices in active markets for identical assets; Level 2 inputs are significant other observable inputs; and Level 3 inputs are significant unobservable inputs.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

3. Deposit and Investment Risk (continued)

At the end of the current year, the County did not have any recurring fair value measurements. The Georgia Fund 1 is an investment pool which does not meet the criteria of GASB Statement No. 79 and is thus valued at fair value in accordance with GASB Statement No. 31. As a result, the County does not disclose the investment in the Georgia Fund 1 within the fair value hierarchy.

Concentration of Credit Risk

The County places no limit on the amount it may invest in any one issuer.

Foreign currency risk

The County has no investments denominated in a foreign currency.

The County participates in the State of Georgia Local Government Investment Pool (Georgia Fund 1). Assets in this pool are invested in the Georgia Fund 1, created by OCGA 36-83-8, which is a stable net asset investment pool that follows Fitch's criteria for AAAf/S1 rated money market funds. However, Georgia Fund 1 operates in a manner consistent with Rule 2a-7 of the Investment Company Act of 1940. The pool is not registered with the SEC as an investment company. The pool's primary objectives are safety of capital, investment income, liquidity and diversification while maintaining principal (\$1.00 per share value). Net asset value is calculated weekly to ensure stability. The pool distributes earnings (net of management fees) on a monthly basis and determines participant's shares sold and redeemed based on \$1.00 per share. Georgia Fund 1 is managed by the Georgia Office of the State Treasurer. The investment policies of Georgia Fund 1 are established by the Georgia State Depository Board.

The Georgia Fund 1 is rated AAAf/S1 by Fitch. The weighted average maturity at the end of the current year was 51 days. At the end of the current year, the County's balance in Georgia Fund 1 was \$3,803,632.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

4. Accounts Receivable

Net accounts receivable at the end of the current year consist of the following:

Primary Government:

Major Funds

General Fund	\$ 50,643
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Whitfield Transit System	110,468
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Nonmajor Funds

Opioid Settlement Payments Special Revenue Fund	1,656,517
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Emergency 911 Special Revenue Fund	357,359
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Accountability Courts Grant Program Special Revenue Fund	112
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Health Insurance Internal Service Fund	<u>510,315</u>
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Total primary government	<u><u>\$ 2,685,414</u></u>
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Component Unit

Whitfield County Health Department Component Unit	<u><u>\$ 116,693</u></u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

5. Intergovernmental Receivables

Intergovernmental receivables at the end of the current year consist of the following:

Major Funds	
General Fund	\$ 821,573
Special Fire District Special Revenue Fund	119,603
American Rescue Plan Act Special Revenue Fund	690,726
Whitfield Transit System Enterprise Fund	171,567
Nonmajor Funds	
Opioid Settlement Payments Special Revenue Fund	34,603
Local Victim Assistance Program Special Revenue Fund	3,734
Drug Abuse Treatment and Education Special Revenue Fund	5,974
Felony Domestic Violence Grant Special Revenue Fund	71,892
Accountability Courts Grant Program Special Revenue Fund	122,489
Solid Waste District Special Revenue Fund	12,416
Capital Acquisition Capital Projects Fund	5,000
JDA Project Capital Projects Fund	<u>1,063,203</u>
Total primary government	<u>\$ 3,122,780</u>
Component Unit	
Whitfield County Health Department Component Unit	<u>\$ 428,324</u>

6. Property Taxes

Property tax rates are set by the Board of Commissioners each year and are limited by statutory or constitutional provision. Property values are assessed as of January 1st each year. Property taxes for digest year 2025, based upon the assessments as of January 1, 2025, were levied on November 7, 2025, billed on November 20, 2025, and due on January 20, 2026. Tax liens may be issued 60 days after the due date.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

6. Property Taxes (continued)

Taxes receivable at the end of the current year consist of property taxes for seven years as follows:

<u>Year of Levy</u>	
2025	\$ 20,079,997
2024	2,631,191
2023	212,308
2022	56,820
2021	7,828
2020	4,912
2019 and older	9,564
	<u>23,002,620</u>
Less allowance for uncollectible	<u>(434,834)</u>
Total	<u><u>\$ 22,567,786</u></u>

\$3,879,144 of sales taxes, \$106,291 of franchise taxes, and \$6,340 of hotel/motel tax are also included in taxes receivable.

7. Interfund Receivables, Payables, and Transfers

A summary of interfund receivables and payables at the end of the current year is as follows:

<u>Receivable Fund</u>	<u>Payable Fund</u>	<u>Amount</u>
General	Special Fire District	\$ 5,258,828
	American Rescue Plan Act	204,272
	2020 SPLOST	302,490
	Nonmajor Governmental	813,995
		<u>\$ 6,579,585</u>

The balances reported as Due to/Due from represent loans between the borrower funds and the lender. These balances resulted from the time lag between the dates that transactions are recorded in the accounting system and payments between the funds are made. Any residual balances outstanding between the governmental activities and business-type activities are reported in the government-wide financial statements as "internal balances".

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

7. Interfund Receivables, Payables, and Transfers (continued)

A summary of interfund transfers for the current year is as follows:

<u>Transfer Out Fund</u>	<u>Transfer In Fund</u>	<u>Amount</u>
General	Nonmajor Governmental	\$ 3,311,659
	American Rescue Plan Act	83,897
American Rescue Plan Act	General	71,949
Nonmajor Governmental	General	1,091,390
	Nonmajor Governmental	26,558
Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management	General	<u>1,250,000</u>
		<u>\$ 5,835,453</u>

Interfund transfers are used to 1) move revenues from the fund that statute or budget requires collecting them to the fund that statute or budget requires to expend them, and 2) use unrestricted revenues collected to finance various programs accounted for in other funds in accordance with budgetary authorizations. Transfers from the General Fund primarily consist of annual contributions to the nonmajor special revenue funds to supplement operations and to nonmajor capital projects funds for capital improvements. Transfers from the nonmajor governmental funds primarily consist of PILOT revenues collected by the JDA Project Special Revenue Fund that accumulated in the General Fund to fund future economic development projects in the County. Transfers from the Dalton Whitfield Solid Waste Management Fund primarily consist of return of joint venture investment capital. Transfers are eliminated in the government-wide financial statements if the interfund transfer is within the governmental fund group or business-type fund group.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

8. Capital Assets

Capital asset activity for the primary government for the current year is as follows:

	Beginning Balance	Increases	Decreases	Ending Balance
Governmental activities				
Nondepreciable assets				
Land	\$ 14,230,895	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 14,230,895
Construction in progress	6,226,997	2,525,285	(617,925)	8,134,357
Total nondepreciable assets	20,457,892	2,525,285	(617,925)	22,365,252
Depreciable/amortizable assets				
Buildings	97,783,800	1,692,116	0	99,475,916
Vehicles	18,599,134	5,812,345	(508,681)	23,902,798
Equipment and fixtures	30,245,575	5,123,900	(704,688)	34,664,787
Infrastructure	808,624,675	531,253	0	809,155,928
Intangible assets				
Software	153,729	2,732,899	(57,749)	2,828,879
Total depreciable/amortizable assets	955,406,913	15,892,513	(1,271,118)	970,028,308
Less accumulated depreciation/amortization				
Buildings	(45,574,252)	(2,896,159)	0	(48,470,411)
Vehicles	(14,202,784)	(2,089,809)	420,947	(15,871,646)
Equipment and fixtures	(19,863,711)	(2,121,546)	704,687	(21,280,570)
Infrastructure	(679,437,471)	(4,174,184)	0	(683,611,655)
Intangible assets				
Software	(127,553)	(285,865)	57,749	(355,669)
Total accumulated depreciation/amortization	(759,205,771)	(11,567,563)	1,183,383	(769,589,951)
Total depreciable/amortizable assets, net	196,201,142	4,324,950	(87,735)	200,438,357
Governmental activities capital assets, net	<u>\$ 216,659,034</u>	<u>\$ 6,850,235</u>	<u>\$ (705,660)</u>	<u>\$ 222,803,609</u>
Business-type Activities				
Depreciable assets				
Vehicles	\$ 598,942	\$ 363,672	\$ 0	\$ 962,614
Equipment	37,000	0	0	37,000
Total depreciable assets	635,942	363,672	0	999,614
Less accumulated depreciation				
Vehicles	(553,883)	(65,338)	0	(619,221)
Equipment	(19,425)	(1,850)	0	(21,275)
Total accumulated depreciation/amortization	(573,308)	(67,188)	0	(640,496)
Business-type activities capital assets, net	<u>\$ 62,634</u>	<u>\$ 296,484</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 359,118</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

8. Capital Assets (continued)

Capital asset activity for the discretely presented component unit is as follows:

	<u>Beginning Balance</u>	<u>Increases</u>	<u>Decreases</u>	<u>Ending Balance</u>
Whitfield County Health Department				
Depreciable assets				
Equipment	\$ 463,465	\$ 0	\$ (34,733)	\$ 428,732
Furniture and fixtures	6,664	0	0	6,664
Leasehold improvements	275,466	0	0	275,466
Total depreciable assets	<u>745,595</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>(34,733)</u>	<u>710,862</u>
Less accumulated depreciation				
Equipment	(459,983)	(1,710)	34,733	(426,960)
Furniture and fixtures	(6,642)	0	0	(6,642)
Leasehold improvements	(161,323)	(15,142)	0	(176,465)
Total accumulated depreciation	<u>(627,948)</u>	<u>(16,852)</u>	<u>34,733</u>	<u>(610,067)</u>
Whitfield County Health Department capital assets, net	<u>\$ 117,647</u>	<u>\$ (16,852)</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 100,795</u>

Depreciation/amortization expense was charged to functions/programs as follows:

Primary Government

Governmental activities

General Government	\$ 1,654,044
Judicial	27,701
Public Safety	3,652,836
Public Works	5,186,906
Health and Welfare	7,557
Culture and Recreation	972,400
Housing and Development	66,119
Total depreciation/amortization expense for governmental activities	<u>\$ 11,567,563</u>

Business-type activities

Whitfield Transit System	<u>\$ 67,188</u>
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Component Unit

Whitfield County Health Department	<u>\$ 16,852</u>
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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

9. Short-Term Debt

On September 30, 2025, the County entered into a \$6,000,000 tax anticipation line of credit for cash flow purposes. The line of credit bore interest at a rate of 3.350% and was paid on December 31, 2025 from 2024 property tax revenues collected between September and December. Principal and interest amounts repaid were \$6,050,250. The borrowings were allocated to the General Fund. The short-term borrowings interest incurred and expensed for the current year was \$50,250. In connection with the tax anticipation note, the County incurred \$14,700 in issuance costs, which were expensed in the current year.

Short-term debt activity for the current year is as follows:

	<u>Beginning Balance</u>	<u>Additions</u>	<u>Deductions</u>	<u>Ending Balance</u>
Tax anticipation note	\$ <u>0</u>	\$ <u>6,000,000</u>	\$ <u>6,000,000</u>	\$ <u>0</u>

10. Long-Term Debt

Governmental Activities

Direct Placement Revenue Bonds

In June 2015, the County issued Series 2015 Taxable Refunding Revenue Bonds through the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority in the amount of \$4,885,000, due in annual installments of \$426,000 to \$556,000 through June 2025, with an interest rate of 2.990%. The proceeds from these bonds were used to repay the County's outstanding Series 2010B bonds of \$4,775,000, plus issuance costs. Pursuant to these bond issues, the County entered into an intergovernmental agreement with the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority whereby the County has an unconditional obligation to provide funds for the bond payments. The County will exercise its power of taxation to the extent necessary, to meet the debt service obligations. The obligation was paid in full during the current year.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

10. Long-Term Debt (continued)

Governmental Activities, continued

Notes from Direct Borrowings

In April 2018, The County entered into a direct borrowing agreement with the Georgia Environment Finance Authority (GEFA) in the amount of \$1,600,000 to fund a sewer expansion project requiring monthly installments of \$4,330 of principal and interest through December 2030; interest at 0.700% (\$255,208 outstanding). Upon an event of default, all outstanding principal and accrued interest may be declared immediately due and payable. Note payments and performance obligations are secured by taxes, fees, and charges collected by the County.

Finance Purchases

The County has entered into a financed purchase agreement with Motorola Solutions Credit Company LLC for the purchase of EMA radios. The amount of the agreement was \$2,784,275, all due within one year of the agreement (\$2,784,275 outstanding); interest at 0.000%. The agreement is collateralized by the equipment. Upon an event of default, all outstanding principal and accrued interest may be declared immediately due and payable or the County will be required to return the equipment.

The annual requirements to amortize notes from direct borrowings at the end of the current year are as follows:

Year Ending December 31,	Principal	Interest	Total
2026	\$ 2,834,605	\$ 1,625	\$ 2,836,230
2027	50,684	1,272	51,956
2028	51,040	916	51,956
2029	51,398	557	51,955
2030	51,756	196	51,952
Totals	<u>\$ 3,039,483</u>	<u>\$ 4,566</u>	<u>\$ 3,044,049</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

10. Long-Term Debt (continued)

Governmental Activities, continued

Subscriptions Payable

The County has entered into agreements to subscribe to certain software. The subscription agreements qualify under GASB Statement No. 96, *Subscription-Based Information Technology Arrangements*, and therefore, have been recorded at the present value of the future minimum subscription payments at inception. Subscriptions payables are comprised of the following individual subscriptions at the end of the current year:

- \$1,160,876 taser and body camera software due in annual installments ranging from \$243,609 to \$247,009 through July 2029, interest at 2.758% (\$933,368 outstanding).
- \$272,023 document management software due in annual installments ranging from \$53,838 to \$60,595 through November 2029, interest at 2.300% (\$218,930).

The future minimum principal and interest subscription payments together with the present value of the net minimum payments as of the end of the current year:

Year Ending December 31,	Principal	Interest	Total
2026	\$ 282,253	\$ 20,209	\$ 302,462
2027	280,614	23,511	304,125
2028	289,916	15,923	305,839
2029	299,515	8,088	307,603
Totals	<u>\$ 1,152,298</u>	<u>\$ 67,731</u>	<u>\$ 1,220,029</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

11. Long-Term Liabilities

Changes in Long - Term Liabilities

The following is a summary of changes in long-term liabilities of the County for the current year:

	<u>Balance</u>	<u>Additions</u>	<u>Deductions</u>	<u>Balance</u>	<u>One Year</u>
Governmental activities					
Bonds payable	\$ 556,000	\$ 0	\$ 556,000	\$ 0	\$ 0
Notes from direct borrowings	305,187	2,784,275	49,979	3,039,483	2,834,605
Subscriptions payable	0	1,432,899	280,601	1,152,298	282,253
Compensated absences	2,538,495	236,552	0	2,775,047	1,942,533
Total governmental activities	<u>\$ 3,399,682</u>	<u>\$ 4,453,726</u>	<u>\$ 886,580</u>	<u>\$ 6,966,828</u>	<u>\$ 5,059,391</u>
Business-type activities					
Compensated absences	<u>\$ 31,980</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 676</u>	<u>\$ 31,304</u>	<u>\$ 21,912</u>

The total interest incurred and charged to expense for the current year was \$91,926 for governmental activities.

Long-term liability activity for the discretely presented component unit for the respective fiscal year is as follows:

	<u>Beginning Balance</u>	<u>Additions</u>	<u>Deductions</u>	<u>Ending Balance</u>	<u>Due Within One Year</u>
Whitfield County Health Department					
Compensated absences	<u>\$ 338,132</u>	<u>\$ 60,564</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 398,696</u>	<u>\$ 239,218</u>

Beginning balances in the Whitfield County Health Department Component Unit were restated for the implementation of GASB 101, Compensated Absences, in the amount of \$188,747.

The additions and deductions noted for compensated absences reflect the net change for the period.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans

Defined Benefit Pension Plan

Plan Description. The County contributes to the Association of the County Commissioners of Georgia Restated Pension Plan for Whitfield County Employees (The Plan), a defined benefit pension plan, an agent multiple-employer public employee retirement system. The Plan issues a publicly available financial report that includes financial statements and required supplementary information for the Plan. That report may be obtained by writing to Government Employees Benefits Corporation of Georgia, 400 Galleria Parkway, Suite 1250, Atlanta, Georgia 30339. The Plan provides retirement, disability and death benefits to plan participants and beneficiaries. The Plan, through execution of an adoption agreement, is affiliated with the Association County Commissioners of Georgia Third Restated Defined Benefit Plan (The ACCG Plan), an agent multiple-employer pension plan administered by the Government Employee's Benefit Corporation (GEBCorp). The ACCG, in its role as Plan Sponsor, has the sole authority to amend the provisions of the ACCG Plan, as provided in Section 17.01 of the ACCG Plan document. The County has the authority by resolution to amend the adoption agreement, which defines the specific benefit provisions of the Plan, as provided in section 17.02 of the ACCG Plan document.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

All full-time County employees meeting the provisions as set out in the adoption agreement are eligible to participate in the Plan. Benefits vested at 100% after five years of service. Participants become eligible to retire at the earlier of: a) age 65 and 5 years of service or b) age 65 and 3 years of service if terminated prior to January 1, 2007. As of February 1, 2016, participation in the Plan was frozen to all newly hired or rehired employees.

At January 1, 2024, the date of the most recent actuarial valuation, participants consisted of the following:

Retirees, beneficiaries, and disablees currently receiving benefits	255
Terminated plan participants entitled to but not yet receiving benefits	310
Active employees participating in the plan	<u>283</u>
Total number of participants	<u><u>848</u></u>

Benefits Provided. Upon eligibility to retire, participants hired before January 1, 2003 are entitled to an annual benefit in the amount of 1.0% of average annual compensation up to \$6,600 plus 1.5% of average annual compensation up to \$6,600 plus \$36 multiplied by years of service and participants hired on or after January 1, 2003 are entitled to an annual benefit in the amount of 1.0% of average annual compensation multiplied by years of service. Compensation is averaged over a five year period prior to retirement or termination. The Plan also provides benefits in the event of death before retirement and early retirement subject to certain early retirement reduction factors.

Contributions. County employees are not required to contribute to the Plan. The County contributes the entire cost of the Plan, using the actuarial basis described in the annual valuation report. The County's actual contributions for the current year totaled \$0, or 0% of covered payroll. During the budget process, the Board of Commissioners voted to not contribute to the Plan in the current year. The Board of Commissioners provides for the benefits and funding policy through County ordinance and maintains the authority to change the policy. The administrative expenses set by contract between the ACCG and GEBCorp are in addition to the state-required annual funding requirement.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

The Georgia Constitution enables the governing authority of the County, the Board of Commissioners, to establish, and amend from time-to-time contribution rates for the County and its Plan participants.

Pension Liabilities, Pension Expense, Deferred Outflows of Resources, and Deferred Inflows of Resources Related to Pensions. At the end of the current year, the County reported a net pension liability of \$15,670,563. The net pension liability was measured as of December 31, 2024, and the total pension liability used to calculate the net pension liability was determined by an actuarial valuation as of January 1, 2024. For governmental activities, the net pension liability is liquidated by the General Fund. For the current year, the County recognized pension expense of \$3,814,542.

The components of the net pension liability for the County are as follows:

	Total Pension Liability	Plan Fiduciary Net Position	Net Pension Liability
	(a)	(b)	(a) - (b)
Balances at December 31, 2023	\$ 71,585,203	\$ 56,784,787	\$ 14,800,416
Changes for the year:			
Service Cost	729,889	0	729,889
Interest	4,905,453	0	4,905,453
Liability Experience (Gain)/Loss	724,608	0	724,608
Assumption Change	113,426	0	113,426
Net Investment Income	0	6,059,934	(6,059,934)
Benefit Payments	(3,014,601)	(3,014,601)	0
Administrative Expense	0	(103,386)	103,386
Other Changes	0	(353,319)	353,319
Net changes	3,458,775	2,588,628	870,147
Balance at December 31, 2024	\$ 75,043,978	\$ 59,373,415	\$ 15,670,563

Plan fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total pension liability	79.12%
Covered payroll	\$ 18,020,405
Employer's net pension liability as a percentage of covered payroll	86.96%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

At the end of the current year, the County reported deferred outflows of resources and deferred inflows of resources related to the plan from the following sources:

	Deferred Outflows of Resources	Deferred Inflows of Resources
Net difference between projected and actual earnings on pension plan investments	\$ 223,389	\$ 0
Differences between expected and actual experience	884,618	0
Changes of assumptions	675,920	0
Totals	<u><u>\$ 1,783,927</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

The amounts reported as deferred outflows and deferred inflows of resources will be recognized in pension expense as follows:

Year Ending December 31	
2026	\$ 1,815,698
2027	1,526,277
2028	(1,165,584)
2029	<u>(392,464)</u>
Totals	<u><u>\$ 1,783,927</u></u>

Actuarial Assumptions. The total pension liability in the January 1, 2024 actuarial valuation was determined using the following actuarial assumptions, applied to all periods included in the measurement:

Future salary increases	5.00% per year with an age based scale
Cost of living adjustments	N/A
Net investment rate of return	7.00%
Actuarial cost method	Entry Age Normal
Amortization method	Level percent of payroll
Remaining amortization period	19 years (closed periods)

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

Healthy mortality rates were based on the Pub-2010 Amount Weighted Mortality Table with a blend of 50% of the General Employees Table and 50% of the Public Safety Employees Table with Scale AA to 2024. Disabled rates were derived from the 2024 experience study.

The pension plan's target asset allocation as of December 31, 2024 is summarized in the following table:

	<u>Target Allocation</u>	<u>Range</u>
Fixed Income	30%	25%-35%
Large Cap	30%	25%-35%
Mid Cap	5%	2.5%-10%
Small Cap	5%	2.5%-10%
REIT	5%	2.5%-10%
International	15%	10%-20%
Multi Cap	5%	2.5%-10%
Global Allocation	5%	2.5%-10%

Discount Rate. The discount rate used to measure the total pension liability was 7.00 percent. The discount rate is determined using the estimated 50th percentile return based on UBS Capital Market Assumptions (6.71%) and five year performance in excess of benchmarks (1.00%). The projection of cash flows used to determine the discount rate assumed that contributions from employer will be made at contractually required rates, actuarially determined. Based on those assumptions, the Plan's fiduciary net position was projected to be available to make all projected future benefit payments of current active and inactive employees. Therefore, the long-term expected rate of return on Plan investments was applied to all periods of projected benefit payments to determine the total pension liability.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Benefit Pension Plan, continued

Sensitivity of the Net Pension Liability to Changes in the Discount Rate. The following presents what the net pension liability would be if it were calculated using a discount rate that is one percentage-point lower (6.00 percent) or one percentage-point higher (8.00 percent) than the current rate:

	Discount Rate	Net Pension Liability
1% decrease	6.00%	\$ 25,454,266
Current discount rate	7.00%	15,670,563
1% increase	8.00%	7,518,711

Plan Fiduciary Net Position. Detailed information about the Plan's fiduciary net position is available in the separately issued Association County Commissioners of Georgia GEBCorp financial report.

Defined Contribution Plans

The County approved the adoption of the ACCG 401(a) *Defined Contribution Plan for Whitfield County Employees*, effective February 1, 2016. All full-time employees hired after January 31, 2016 are required to participate in the plan. Employees may enter the plan on the first day of the first pay period beginning on or after the date the participant first meets the eligibility requirements. The plan can be amended by the County Commissioners. The County will match contributions on a graduated vesting schedule based on years of service as follows: 0-3 years (0%), 4-5 years (60%), and 5 years or more (100%). Employees are fully vested after five years of service. During the current year, plan members made contributions of \$540,075.

The County approved adoption of the ACCG 457(b) *Deferred Compensation Plan for Whitfield County Employees*, effective February 1, 2016. All full-time employees hired after January 31, 2016 are eligible for participation in the plan. Eligible employees may enter the plan on the first day of the first pay period beginning on or after the date the participant first meets the eligibility requirements. The plan can be amended by the County Commissioners. The County will match contributions equal to 50% of the first 4% of employee contributions, up to 2%. Effective 2025, the County will contribute an additional \$1,000 per month towards the County Administrator's plan. During the current year, plan members made contributions of \$778,042.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

12. Retirement Plans (continued)

Defined Contribution Plans, continued

The County made contributions to the plans of \$885,878. Covered payroll of the employees that participate in these plans is \$46,384,960. The County has no fiduciary relationship with the plans, and plan assets are not available to the County or its general creditors. The Plan assets are held in trust by the administrator for the exclusive benefit of the participants of the Plans. The Board of Commissioners provides for the funding policy through a County ordinance and maintains the authority to change the policy. Separate financial statements are not issued for the Plans.

Other County Plans

In addition to the plan above, various County employees are covered under the following plans: Georgia Firefighters' Pension Fund, Georgia State Employees' Retirement System (ERS), Georgia Judicial Retirement System (JRS), Magistrates' Retirement Fund of Georgia, Peace Officers' Annuity and Benefit Fund of Georgia, Probate Judges' Retirement Fund of Georgia, Sheriffs' Retirement Fund of Georgia, and Superior Court Clerks' Retirement Fund of Georgia. Further information regarding these plans can be obtained from the plans' annual reports. These plans are immaterial to the financial statements.

Whitfield County Health Department Retirement Plan

Eligible employees of the Whitfield County Health Department participate in the Georgia State Employees' Retirement System (ERS), a statewide multiple-employer public employee retirement system. During the fiscal year ended June 30, 2025, the Department contributed \$532,633. As of June 30, 2025, the Department reported a liability in the amount of \$2,400,842 for its proportionate share (0.053330%) of the net pension liability. As of June 30, 2025, the Department reported deferred outflows of resources related to pension of \$661,319 and deferred inflows of resources related to pension of \$483,126. The Department recognized pension expense (benefit) of (\$525,323) for the fiscal year ended June 30, 2025. Further information regarding the plan can be obtained from Department's annual audit report by contacting Whitfield County Health Department, 800 Professional Boulevard, Dalton, GA 30720.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions

County Plan

Plan Description. Whitfield County administers a single-employer defined benefit health care plan, "The Whitfield County Other Postemployment Benefits Plan." The OPEB financial statements are included in this report. No stand-alone financial report is issued.

At January 1, 2025, the date of the most recent actuarial valuation, membership consisted of the following:

Inactive members or beneficiaries currently receiving benefits	28
Inactive members entitled to but not yet receiving benefits	0
Active employees	<u>178</u>
Total membership	<u><u>206</u></u>

Benefits Provided. Coverage under the plan includes medical and prescription drug benefits for retirees and dependents. Employees hired prior to January 1, 2009 are eligible to retire and continue medical coverage after 10 years of service and a minimum age of 60 years for reduced pension benefit or after 25 years of service and a minimum age of 60 for unreduced pension benefit. Employees hired or rehired after January 1, 2009 are not eligible for participation in the plan. Retiree and spousal coverage is provided for the lifetime of the participant. Upon the death of an eligible retiree with a covered dependent, the surviving dependent may extend coverage.

Contributions. The County has not elected to advance fund the OPEB Plan, but rather maintains the OPEB Plan on a "pay-as-you-go" basis, in that claims are paid as they arise, rather than establishing an irrevocable trust to accumulate restricted funds. The Board of Commissioners authorizes participation in the OPEB and sets the contribution rates and benefits, and maintains the authority to change the policy.

The cost of coverage is paid in part by the employer and in part by the retiree. For the measurement period ended January 1, 2025, plan members receiving benefits contributed \$247,800 through their required contributions.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

OPEB Liabilities, OPEB Expense, Deferred Outflows of Resources, and Deferred Inflows of Resources Related to OPEB. At the end of the current year, the County reported a total OPEB liability of \$11,537,400. The total OPEB liability was measured as of January 1, 2025. During the current year, the County recognized OPEB expense (credit) of \$841,700.

The components of the total OPEB liability are as follows:

	Total OPEB Liability (a)	Plan Fiduciary Net Position (b)	Net OPEB Liability (a)-(b)
Balances at December 31, 2024	\$ 11,460,100	\$ 0	\$ 11,460,100
Changes for the year:			
Service cost	221,800	0	221,800
Interest	435,800	0	435,800
Differences between expected and actual experience	(531,800)	0	(531,800)
Contributions-employer	0	247,800	(247,800)
Changes of assumptions or other inputs	199,300	0	199,300
Benefit payments	(247,800)	(247,800)	0
Net changes	77,300	0	77,300
Balances at December 31, 2025	\$ 11,537,400	\$ 0	\$ 11,537,400
Plan fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total OPEB liability		0.00%	
Covered-employee payroll		\$ 12,533,200	
Plan net OPEB liability as a percentage of covered employee payroll		92.05%	

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

At the end of the current year, the County reported deferred outflows of resources and deferred inflows of resources related to the OPEB Plan from the following sources:

	Deferred Outflows of Resources	Deferred Inflows of Resources
Differences between expected and actual experience	\$ 2,137,200	\$ (1,400,700)
Changes of assumptions	858,800	(1,063,900)
Contributions subsequent to the measurement date	258,763	0
Totals	<u>\$ 3,254,763</u>	<u>\$ (2,464,600)</u>

The \$258,763 of deferred outflows of resources resulting from the County's contributions subsequent to the measurement date will be recognized as a reduction of the net OPEB liability in the subsequent year. Other amounts reported as deferred outflows and deferred inflows of resources will be recognized in OPEB expense as follows:

Year Ending December 31,	
2026	\$ 174,600
2027	194,400
2028	15,700
2029	(56,400)
2030 and after	203,100
Totals	<u>\$ 531,400</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

Actuarial Assumptions. The total OPEB liability in the January 1, 2025 actuarial valuation was determined using the following actuarial assumptions, applied to all periods included in the measurement:

Salary scale	2.50%
Actuarial cost method	Entry age normal
Discount rate	4.16%, 3.77% at prior measurement date
Healthcare cost trend rates	Pre-Medicare: 7.00% for 2025 decreasing to an ultimate rate of 5.00% by 2032
Mortality rates	Mortality rates were based on the PUB-2010 Amount-Weighted Mortality Table, projected using 2-dimensional mortality improvement scale MP-2021.
Amortization method	Closed level dollar for remaining unfunded liability
Remaining amortization period	Remaining amortization period varies for the bases, with a net effective amortization period of 15 years.

The demographic actuarial assumptions for retirement, disability incidence, withdrawal, and salary increases used in the January 1, 2025 actuarial valuation reflect the analysis of the County's census data along with decrement experience of similar populations throughout Georgia.

The remaining actuarial assumptions (e.g., initial per capita costs, health care cost trends, etc.) used in the January 1, 2025 actuarial valuation were based on a review of recent plan experience performed concurrently with the January 1, 2025 valuation.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

County Plan, continued

Development of Long-Term Rate. Since the County funds this plan on a pay-as-you-go basis, GASB requires the discount rate be based on a yield or index rate for 20-year, tax-exempt municipal bonds with an average rating of AA/Aa or higher (or equivalent quality on another rating scale). The Municipal Bond Index Rate selected by the County for this purpose is the Bond Buyer General Obligation 20-year Municipal Bond Index published at the last Thursday of December by The Bond Buyer (www.bondbuyer.com). The Municipal Bond Index Rate as of the measurement date was 4.16%.

Sensitivity of the Net OPEB Liability to Changes in the Discount Rate. The following presents what the net OPEB liability would be if it were calculated using a discount rate that is one percentage-point lower (3.16%) or one percentage-point higher (5.16%) than the current rate. Also, shown is the net OPEB liability as if it were calculated using healthcare cost trend rates that were one percentage point lower or one percentage point higher than the current healthcare trend rates:

<u>Discount Rate</u>		<u>Net OPEB Liability</u>
1% decrease	3.16%	\$ 12,458,200
Current discount rate	4.16%	11,537,400
1% increase	5.16%	10,685,500
<u>Healthcare Cost Trend Rates</u>		<u>Net OPEB Liability</u>
1% decrease	6.00%	\$ 10,422,400
Current trend rate	7.00%	11,537,400
1% increase	8.00%	12,816,600

OPEB Plan Fiduciary Net Position. Detailed information about the Plan's fiduciary net position is available in the separately issued GASB Statement No. 75 Report for The Whitfield County Other Postemployment Benefits Plan.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

13. Post-Employment Benefits Other Than Pensions (continued)

Whitfield County Health Department OPEB Plans

Eligible employees of the Whitfield County Health Department are provided OPEB through the State of Georgia OPEB Fund, a cost-sharing multiple-employer defined benefit post-employment healthcare plan and life insurance through the SEAD-OPEB Fund, a cost-sharing multiple-employer defined benefit post-employment benefit plan. During the fiscal year ended June 30, 2025, the Health Department contributed \$94,191. As of June 30, 2025, the Health Department reported a liability (asset) in the amount of (\$351,821) for its proportionate share (0.062684%) of the SEAD-OPEB net OPEB liability (asset). As of June 30, 2025, the Health Department reported a liability (asset) in the amount of (\$126,130) for its proportionate share (0.050037%) of the State OPEB net OPEB liability (asset). As of June 30, 2025 the Department reported deferred outflows of resources related to OPEB of \$188,677 and deferred inflows of resources related to OPEB of \$307,080. The Health Department recognized OPEB expense (benefit) of (\$111,742) for the fiscal year ended June 30, 2025. Further information regarding the plan can be obtained from Department's annual audit report by contacting Whitfield County Health Department, 800 Professional Boulevard, Dalton, GA 30720.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

14. Restricted, Committed, and Assigned Fund Balances

The following is a summary of restricted, committed, and assigned fund balances of the governmental funds at the end of the current year:

	<u>General</u>	<u>Special Fire District</u>	<u>American Rescue Plan Act</u>	<u>2020 SPLOST</u>	<u>2024 SPLOST</u>	<u>Nonmajor Governmental Funds</u>	<u>Total Governmental Funds</u>
Restricted for:							
Judicial							
Drug abuse treatment and education programs	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 537,358	\$ 537,358
Law library operations	0	0	0	0	0	113,970	113,970
Treatment programs for juvenile offenders	0	0	0	0	0	115,364	115,364
Judicial facilities, equipment, and operations	0	0	0	0	0	39,285	39,285
Felony domestic violence prevention and response	0	0	0	0	0	17,026	17,026
Operation of accountability courts	0	0	0	0	0	749,944	749,944
Alternative dispute resolution programs	0	0	0	0	0	545,534	545,534
Public Safety							
Fire services	0	159,185	0	0	0	0	159,185
Opioid remediation efforts	0	0	0	0	0	241,428	241,428
Emergency 911 system operations	0	0	0	0	0	555,150	555,150
Sheriff facilities and equipment	0	0	0	0	0	172,808	172,808
Housing and Development							
Neighborhood stabilization efforts	0	0	0	0	0	81,456	81,456
Grant specifications	0	0	346,781	0	0	0	346,781
Capital projects	1,441,087	0	0	4,004,736	6,787,596	615,078	12,848,497
	<u>\$ 1,441,087</u>	<u>\$ 159,185</u>	<u>\$ 346,781</u>	<u>\$ 4,004,736</u>	<u>\$ 6,787,596</u>	<u>\$ 3,784,401</u>	<u>\$ 16,523,786</u>
Committed for:							
Capital projects	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 3,349,272</u>	<u>\$ 3,349,272</u>
Assigned for:							
Public Works							
Solid waste management activities	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 431,186	\$ 431,186
Culture and Recreation							
Recreation management activities	0	0	0	0	0	218,647	218,647
Housing and Development							
Economic development activities	1,987,471	0	0	0	0	0	1,987,471
	<u>\$ 1,987,471</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 649,833</u>	<u>\$ 2,637,304</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

15. Net Investment in Capital Assets

The net investment in capital assets reported on the government-wide statement of net position is calculated as follows at the end of the current year:

	Governmental Activities	Business-Type Activities	Component Unit Whitfield County Health Department
Cost of capital assets, net	\$ 222,803,609	\$ 359,118	\$ 100,795
Capital-related accounts payable	(361,074)	0	0
Retainages payable	(13,937)	0	0
Subscriptions payable	(1,152,298)	0	0
Notes payable	(3,039,483)	0	0
Unspent bond proceeds	31,412	0	0
Net investment in capital assets	<u>\$ 218,268,229</u>	<u>\$ 359,118</u>	<u>\$ 100,795</u>

16. Tax Abatements

The Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority (a joint venture between the County and the City of Dalton) has entered into several agreements for abatement of property taxes. The JDA provides tax incentives, based upon certain criteria, to potential and existing entities for the purpose of furthering economic growth in the Dalton-Whitfield area. The JDA is not a taxing authority. The tax abatements offered are abatements of Whitfield County, Georgia property tax and City of Dalton, Georgia property tax. The County and the City must approve the tax incentive agreements prior to their execution.

The criteria that makes an entity eligible for tax abatements through the JDA include providing new capital investment and/or new jobs in the Dalton-Whitfield area. The amount of the tax abatement transaction is determined based upon a specific rubric. Planned new jobs, community investment, diversification, wage levels, project location, and other factors are considered in determining the amount of tax abatement offered to an entity. The tax abatement period for a project can last up to 15 years.

The entity must be willing to enter into a contractual agreement with the JDA and willing to enter into a bond financed sale leaseback transaction (Industrial Revenue Bonds) which transfers title to improvements (land, buildings, or equipment) during the life of the tax deferment/abatement plan to the JDA, as provided by Georgia state law. The local taxing jurisdiction and the public receive notice of the title transfer pursuant to an Industrial Revenue Bond validation.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

16. Tax Abatements (continued)

Entities with tax abatements are required to file an annual report with the JDA which certifies the number of jobs created, the cumulative amount of capital investment, and other applicable measurements. In the event the entity fails to meet specified goals, a percentage method described in each agreement is used to determine a shortfall. The shortfall percentage is multiplied by the amount of taxes abates for the year for the project to arrive at a recovery payment. The recovery payment is due with the annual report.

As of the end of the current year, the County abated property taxes for 35 entities totaling \$7,552,291 under these programs.

17. Hotel/Motel Lodging Tax

The County has levied an 7% lodging tax in accordance with OCGA 48-13-51. A summary of the transactions for the current year follows:

Lodging tax receipts	\$ 85,389
Disbursements for trade and tourism	\$ 85,389 100% of tax receipts

18. Joint Ventures

Under Georgia law, the County, in conjunction with other cities and counties in the Northwest Georgia area, is a member of the Northwest Georgia Regional Commission (NWGRC) and is required to pay annual dues thereto. During the current year, the County paid \$131,986 in such dues. Membership in an RC is required by the Official Code of Georgia Annotated (OCGA) Section 50-8-34, which provides for the organizational structure of the RC in Georgia. The RC Board membership includes the chief elected official in each county and municipality of the area. OCGA 50-8-39.1 provides that the member governments are liable for any debts or obligations of an RC. A copy of the NWGRC financial statements can be obtained from Northwest Georgia Regional Commission, 503 West Waugh Street, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

18. Joint Ventures (continued)

Dalton-Whitfield Regional Solid Waste Management Authority

The County participates with the City of Dalton in the Dalton-Whitfield Regional Solid Waste Management Authority (DWRSWMA). All budgetary and financial records are maintained by the City. The DWRSWMA issued separate audited financial statements dated June 8, 2026. A copy of the separately issued financial statements can be obtained at their administrative office at 4350 Gazaway Drive SE, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

The County and the City share equally in operations of the DWRSWMA, which operates solid waste disposal sites within the County. Administration is accomplished through a five-member board with each government appointing two members and those four appointing the fifth member. Current expenses are funded through user fees and, if necessary, equal transfers from both governments. The County's equity interest in this joint venture is reported as an enterprise fund in the accompanying financial statements. The County's share of the resulting income (loss) from the joint venture is shown separately as revenue (expense) in the statement of activities.

State and federal laws and regulations require the DWRSWMA to place a final cover on its landfill sites when they stop accepting waste and to perform certain maintenance and monitoring functions at each site for thirty years after closure. Although closure and post-closure care costs will be paid only near or after the date that the landfill stops accepting waste, the DWRSWMA reports a portion of the closure and post-closure care costs as a non-operating expense in each period based on landfill capacity used as of each balance sheet date. The accrual for closure and post-closure cost is summarized by location as follows:

Landfill Sites:	Westside	Old Dixie II, IV, and V	Old Dixie VI	Balefill	Total
Estimated future costs:					
Closure	Closed	Closed	\$ 15,461,000	\$ 3,221,000	\$ 18,682,000
Post-closure	1,025,000	2,671,000	8,805,000	1,629,000	14,130,000
	<u>\$ 1,025,000</u>	<u>\$ 2,671,000</u>	<u>\$ 24,266,000</u>	<u>\$ 4,850,000</u>	<u>\$ 32,812,000</u>
Percentage of capacity as of December 31, 2025	100.0%	100.0%	70.6%	67.2%	
Liability at December 31, 2025	<u>\$ 1,025,000</u>	<u>\$ 2,671,000</u>	<u>\$ 17,128,000</u>	<u>\$ 3,261,000</u>	<u>\$ 24,085,000</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

18. Joint Ventures (continued)

Dalton-Whitfield Regional Solid Waste Management Authority, continued

The DWRSWMA will record the remaining estimated cost of closure and post-closure care costs of \$8,727,000 as the remaining capacity is filled. Estimated remaining landfill life is more than 30 years. The above estimates are based on what it would cost to perform all closure and post-closure care in 2024. Actual costs when incurred may be higher due to inflation, changes in technology, or changes in laws and regulations. As of December 31, 2025, the DWRSWMA reported an ending net position of \$24,542,071, which was a decrease of \$202,700 from the December 31, 2024 net position.

The DWRSWMA landfill closure and post-closure requirements are being funded from user fees and interest earned from investments. If these revenues are inadequate or additional post-closure care requirements are determined, these costs may need to be covered by charges to future landfill users.

Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center Authority

The County participates with the City of Dalton in the Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center Authority (Convention Center). All budgetary and financial records are maintained by the City. The Convention Center issued separate audited financial statements dated May 20, 2026. A copy of the separately issued financial statements can be obtained at their administrative office at 2211 Dug Gap Battle Road, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

The County and the City share equally in operations of the Convention Center, which operates to promote tourism within the County by hosting conventions, special events, and trade shows. Current expenses are funded through user fees and, if necessary, equal transfers from both governments. The County's equity interest in this joint venture is reported as an enterprise fund in the accompanying financial statements. The County's share of the resulting income (loss) from the joint venture is shown separately as revenue (expense) in the statement of activities. As of December 31, 2025, the Convention Center reported an ending net position of \$9,002,557, which was a decrease of \$172,744 from the December 31, 2024 net position.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

18. Joint Ventures (continued)

Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority

The County participates in the Dalton-Whitfield Joint Development Authority and the Dalton-Whitfield Economic Development Authority, which are reported as one entity (JDA). All budgetary and financial records are maintained by the JDA, which is housed at the Dalton-Whitfield Chamber of Commerce. The JDA issued separate audited financial statements dated May 27, 2026. A copy of the separately issued financial statements can be obtained at their administrative office at 100 South Hamilton Street, Dalton, Georgia 30720.

The County and the City share equally in operations of the JDA, which operates to promote economic development within the County. Current expenses are funded through equal transfers from both governments and a large donation from a local advised fund. An administrative fee is collected by the JDA for collection of payments in lieu of taxes and the County's equity interest in this joint venture is shown as an investment in a joint venture in the governmental activities in the government-wide statement of net position. The County's share of resulting income (loss) from the joint venture is shown separately as revenue (expense) in the statement of activities. As of December 31, 2025, the JDA reported an ending net position of \$7,171,868, which was an increase of \$4,152,829 from the December 31, 2024 net position.

19. Risk Management

The County is exposed to various risks of loss related to torts; theft of, damage to, and destruction of assets; errors and omissions; injuries to employees; and natural disasters. The State Constitution provides that the County (a political subdivision) may be immune from liability for most forms of bodily injury and property damage arising out of its operations, if such losses are not insured. It is the policy of the County to utilize immunity as a legal defense against liability claims whenever the risk of loss is not insured and immunity may be asserted.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

19. Risk Management (continued)

Workers' Compensation Insurance

The County maintains a Workers' Compensation Self-Insurance Fund, which is an internal service fund, to account for resources used in payment of workers' compensation claims. The County has entered into a contract with a third party to administer the Workers' Compensation Program. The County maintains third party insurance coverage from a private insurance carrier for claims that exceed \$250,000 per occurrence or a \$1,000,000 aggregate, stop loss limit. The County is a member of the State of Georgia Subsequent Injury Trust Fund, which provides reimbursement to individual participants, should a claim be filed by an employee who has suffered previous injury before employment with the County. During the current year, the County was reimbursed from the Subsequent Injury Trust Fund for claims above the stop loss limit. The County accrued a liability for workers' compensation claims that were incurred prior to year-end but were not paid until the following year. For purposes of estimating the unpaid claims liability as of year-end, the County's third party administrator computed the reserve liability based on the estimated cost of each outstanding claim from claims experience of similar claims.

The follow describes the activity for the past three years:

Fiscal Year	Beginning of Year Claims Liability	Current Year Claims and Changes in Estimates	Claims Paid	End of Year Claims Liability
2025	\$ 242,892	\$ 268,744	\$ 408,794	\$ 102,842
2024	299,895	307,025	364,028	242,892
2023	475,218	509,372	684,695	299,895

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

19. Risk Management (continued)

Group Health Insurance

The County also maintains a Group Health Benefits Self-Insurance Fund, which is an internal service fund, to account for resources used in providing employee benefits for medical, dental, disability, and losses of life claims. The County maintains third-party insurance coverage from a private insurance carrier for claims that exceed \$100,000 per employee or a \$6,900,000 aggregate, stop loss limit, based on an annual policy term using a 12/15 run out formula on specific employee claims and a 12/12 run out on aggregate claims.

The follow describes the activity for the past three fiscal years:

Fiscal Year	Beginning of Year Claims Liability	Current Year Claims and Changes in Estimates	Claims Paid	End of Year Claims Liability
2025	\$ 276,945	\$ 12,060,471	\$ 11,806,770	\$ 530,646
2024	393,715	9,262,447	9,379,217	276,945
2023	308,964	9,611,995	9,527,244	393,715

20. Commitments and Contingencies

Commitments

As of the end of the current year, contractual commitments on uncompleted contracts totaled \$585,368.

Contingencies

The County is involved in several lawsuits filed in the normal course of its activities. The majority of these claims are considered minimal with a favorable outcome expected. The County's position is to vigorously defend its position or seek an out of court settlement.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

20. Commitments and Contingencies (continued)

Contingencies, continued

The County has received federal and state grants for specific purposes that are subject to review and audit by the grantor agencies. Such audits could lead to disallowance of certain expenditures previously reimbursed by those agencies. Based upon prior experience, County management believes such disallowances, if any, will not be significant.

21. New Accounting Pronouncements

The County implemented GASB Statement No. 102, *Certain Risk Disclosures*, effective for the County's current year. The requirements of this statement are effective for periods beginning after June 15, 2024. The implementation of this new standard had no impact on the County's net position.

22. Changes in Beginning Balances

Error Correction

Governmental Activities

A restatement has been made to correct PILOT revenue recognition in 2024. This was due to the temporary 2024 tax digest compared to the final 2024 tax digest differences. This restatement decreased beginning net position by \$294,076.

General Fund

A restatement has been made to correct the balance of unavailable property tax revenue at December 31, 2024. This restatement increased beginning fund balance by \$366,798.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
December 31, 2025

22. Changes in Beginning Balances (continued)

Change in Accounting Principle

Whitfield County Health Department

The balance of compensated absences at June 30, 2024 was restated to implement GASB 101, *Compensated Absences*. This restatement decreased beginning net position by \$188,747.

A summary of the changes in beginning balances is presented below:

	Beginning As Previously Reported	Change in Accounting Principle	Error Correction	Beginning As Restated
Government-Wide				
Governmental Activities	251,300,827	0	(294,076)	251,006,751
Business-type Activities	15,872,922	0	0	15,872,922
Total Primary Government	<u>\$ 267,173,749</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 266,879,673</u>
Governmental Funds				
General Fund	<u>\$ 30,022,486</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 366,798</u>	<u>\$ 30,389,284</u>
Component Unit				
Whitfield County Health Department	<u>\$ 2,887,345</u>	<u>\$ (188,747)</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 2,698,598</u>

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REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF CHANGES IN THE NET PENSION LIABILITY AND RELATED RATIOS
LAST TEN YEARS
December 31, 2025
(Unaudited)

	Year End		
	2025	2024	2023
Total pension liability			
Service cost	\$ 729,889	\$ 645,403	\$ 666,693
Interest	4,905,453	4,541,332	4,211,018
Differences between expected and actual experience	724,608	1,121,560	1,393,325
Assumption change	113,426	1,799,010	103,332
Plan change	0	0	961,768
Benefit payments, including refunds of employee contributions	(3,014,601)	(2,796,543)	(2,438,174)
Net change in total pension liability	3,458,775	5,310,762	4,897,962
Total pension liability - beginning	71,585,203	66,274,441	61,376,479
Total pension liability - ending (a)	\$ 75,043,978	\$ 71,585,203	\$ 66,274,441
Plan fiduciary net position			
Contributions - employer	\$ 0	\$ 2,357,168	\$ 3,963,335
Net investment income	6,059,934	7,494,939	(8,145,943)
Benefit payments, including refunds of employee contributions	(3,014,601)	(2,796,543)	(2,438,174)
Administrative expense	(103,386)	(100,664)	(101,253)
Other	(353,319)	(312,226)	(272,188)
Net change in plan fiduciary net position	2,588,628	6,642,674	(6,994,223)
Plan fiduciary net position - beginning	56,784,787	50,142,113	57,136,336
Plan fiduciary net position - ending (b)	\$ 59,373,415	\$ 56,784,787	\$ 50,142,113
Net pension liability - ending : (a) - (b)	\$ 15,670,563	\$ 14,800,416	\$ 16,132,328
Plan's fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total pension liability	79.12%	79.32%	75.66%
Covered payroll	\$ 18,020,405	\$ 18,109,147	\$ 18,543,209
Net pension liability as a percentage of covered payroll	86.96%	81.73%	87.00%

Year End						
2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
\$ 707,126	\$ 722,968	\$ 711,465	\$ 594,570	\$ 554,097	\$ 509,289	\$ 462,662
3,983,044	3,767,497	3,445,075	3,220,859	3,101,595	2,898,002	2,641,503
754,458	(719,242)	(287,806)	(233,582)	(425,004)	1,828,569	497,388
100,918	148,841	2,515,573	2,951,217	99,318	1,338,116	1,344,262
0	1,239,938	0	0	0	0	0
(2,139,391)	(1,911,990)	(1,754,716)	(1,731,952)	(1,638,034)	(1,614,361)	(1,525,835)
3,406,155	3,248,012	4,629,591	4,801,112	1,691,972	4,959,615	3,419,980
57,970,324	54,722,312	50,092,721	45,291,609	43,599,637	38,640,022	35,220,042
<u>\$ 61,376,479</u>	<u>\$ 57,970,324</u>	<u>\$ 54,722,312</u>	<u>\$ 50,092,721</u>	<u>\$ 45,291,609</u>	<u>\$ 43,599,637</u>	<u>\$ 38,640,022</u>
\$ 4,629,351	\$ 1,867,847	\$ 1,498,082	\$ 1,504,596	\$ 1,504,596	\$ 500,000	\$ 1,055,865
7,352,037	5,961,458	7,445,140	(1,718,103)	5,486,159	2,387,843	257,095
(2,139,391)	(1,911,990)	(1,754,716)	(1,731,952)	(1,638,034)	(1,614,361)	(1,525,835)
(99,812)	(101,503)	(101,576)	(88,314)	(81,692)	(82,961)	(75,736)
(122,658)	0	(252,674)	(1,746,162)	(276,533)	(260,299)	(274,034)
9,619,527	5,815,812	6,834,256	(3,779,935)	4,994,496	930,222	(562,645)
47,516,809	41,700,997	34,866,741	38,646,676	33,652,180	32,721,958	33,284,603
<u>\$ 57,136,336</u>	<u>\$ 47,516,809</u>	<u>\$ 41,700,997</u>	<u>\$ 34,866,741</u>	<u>\$ 38,646,676</u>	<u>\$ 33,652,180</u>	<u>\$ 32,721,958</u>
<u>\$ 4,240,143</u>	<u>\$ 10,453,515</u>	<u>\$ 13,021,315</u>	<u>\$ 15,225,980</u>	<u>\$ 6,644,933</u>	<u>\$ 9,947,457</u>	<u>\$ 5,918,064</u>
93.09%	81.97%	76.20%	69.60%	85.33%	77.18%	84.68%
\$ 19,221,276	\$ 19,277,934	\$ 19,718,258	\$ 19,284,710	\$ 18,256,183	\$ 17,477,196	\$ 15,716,628
22.06%	54.23%	66.04%	78.95%	36.40%	56.92%	37.65%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF PENSION CONTRIBUTIONS
LAST TEN YEARS
December 31, 2025
(Unaudited)

	Year End		
	2025	2024	2023
Actuarially determined contribution	\$ 2,399,913	\$ 1,978,559	\$ 2,179,013
Contributions in relation to the actuarially determined contribution	0	0	(2,179,013)
Contribution deficiency (excess)	<u>\$ 2,399,913</u>	<u>\$ 1,978,559</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>
Covered payroll	\$ 18,745,461	\$ 18,993,150	\$ 18,109,147
Contributions as a percentage of covered payroll	0.00%	0.00%	12.03%

Year End						
2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
\$ 1,928,043	\$ 1,982,067	\$ 1,909,678	\$ 1,766,854	\$ 1,415,570	\$ 1,445,990	\$ 1,310,742
<u>(3,963,335)</u>	<u>(2,608,369)</u>	<u>(2,020,982)</u>	<u>(1,498,082)</u>	<u>(1,540,596)</u>	<u>(1,504,596)</u>	<u>(500,000)</u>
<u>\$ (2,035,292)</u>	<u>\$ (626,302)</u>	<u>\$ (111,304)</u>	<u>\$ 268,772</u>	<u>\$ (125,026)</u>	<u>\$ (58,606)</u>	<u>\$ 810,742</u>
\$ 18,543,209	\$ 19,221,276	\$ 19,277,934	\$ 19,284,710	\$ 18,256,183	\$ 17,477,196	\$ 15,716,628
21.37%	13.57%	10.48%	7.77%	8.44%	8.61%	3.18%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF CHANGES IN THE TOTAL OPEB LIABILITY AND RELATED RATIOS
LAST TEN YEARS
December 31, 2025
(Unaudited)

	Year End		
	2025	2024	2023
Total OPEB liability			
Service cost	\$ 221,800	\$ 220,100	\$ 350,300
Interest	435,800	363,300	209,100
Differences between expected and actual experience	(531,800)	1,998,900	(931,400)
Changes of assumptions or other inputs	199,300	251,900	(1,723,800)
Benefit payments and implicit subsidy credit	(247,800)	(246,700)	(88,300)
Net change in total OPEB liability	77,300	2,587,500	(2,184,100)
Total OPEB liability - beginning	11,460,100	8,872,600	11,056,700
Total OPEB liability - ending (a)	\$ 11,537,400	\$ 11,460,100	\$ 8,872,600
Plan fiduciary net position			
Contributions - employer	\$ 247,800	\$ 246,700	\$ 88,300
Benefit payments	(247,800)	(246,700)	(88,300)
Net change in plan fiduciary net position	0	0	0
Plan fiduciary net position - beginning	0	0	0
Plan fiduciary net position - ending (b)	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Total OPEB liability - ending : (a) - (b)	\$ 11,537,400	\$ 11,460,100	\$ 8,872,600
Plan's fiduciary net position as a percentage of the total OPEB liability	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Covered-employee payroll	\$ 12,533,200	\$ 12,533,200	\$ 11,933,100
Net OPEB liability as a percentage of covered-employee payroll	92.05%	91.44%	74.35%

Note: 2018 was the first year of implementation. Therefore, years prior to 2018 are not reported.

Year End				
2022	2021	2020	2019	2018
\$ 359,500	\$ 319,100	\$ 250,600	\$ 280,900	\$ 274,000
198,300	265,500	270,100	265,200	252,200
788,400	(799,800)	1,379,500	(656,300)	0
230,600	608,300	781,200	(284,200)	0
(155,100)	(185,600)	(560,500)	(61,500)	(214,800)
1,421,700	207,500	2,120,900	(455,900)	311,400
9,635,000	9,427,500	7,306,600	7,762,500	7,451,100
<u>\$ 11,056,700</u>	<u>\$ 9,635,000</u>	<u>\$ 9,427,500</u>	<u>\$ 7,306,600</u>	<u>\$ 7,762,500</u>
\$ 155,100	\$ 185,600	\$ 560,500	\$ 61,500	\$ 214,800
(155,100)	(185,600)	(560,500)	(61,500)	(214,800)
0	0	0	0	0
0	0	0	0	0
<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>
<u>\$ 11,056,700</u>	<u>\$ 9,635,000</u>	<u>\$ 9,427,500</u>	<u>\$ 7,306,600</u>	<u>\$ 7,762,500</u>
0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
\$ 11,933,100	\$ 12,908,600	\$ 12,908,600	\$ 13,367,100	\$ 13,367,100
92.66%	74.64%	73.03%	54.66%	58.07%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION
December 31, 2025

Pension Plan

1. Valuation Date

The actuarially determined contribution rate was determined as of January 1, 2024, with an interest adjustment to the fiscal year.

2. Methods and Assumptions Used to Determine Contribution Rates

Actuarial cost method = Entry Age Normal

Amortization method = Closed level dollar for remaining unfunded liability

Remaining amortization period = Remaining amortization period varies for the bases, with a net effective amortization period of 17 years

Asset valuation method = Market value as of measurement date.

Net investment rate of return = 7.00%

Future salary increases = 5.00% per year with an age based scale

Cost of living adjustments = N/A

Normal retirement age = 65

Mortality = Healthy mortality rates were based on the Pub-2010 Amount Weighted Mortality Table with a blend of 50% of the General Employees Table and 50% of the Public Safety Employees Table with Scale AA to 2023. Disabled rates were derived from a 2024 experience study.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION
December 31, 2025

Pension Plan (continued)

3. Changes in Benefits

None to report.

4. Changes of Assumptions

The mortality improvements for the Pub-2010 Amount Weighted Mortality Table with a blend of 50% of the General Employees Table and 50% of the Public Safety Employees Table is projected to 2024 with Scale AA instead of 2023 with Scale AA.

OPEB Plan

1. Valuation Date

The net OPEB liability was measured as of January 1, 2025, and the total OPEB liability used to calculate the net OPEB liability was determined and measured from actuarial valuations using data as of January 1, 2025.

2. Methods and Assumptions Used to Determine Contribution Rates

During measurement period, no assets were accumulated in a trust to pay benefits.

Actuarial cost method = Entry age normal

Amortization method = Closed level dollar for remaining unfunded liability

Remaining amortization period = Remaining amortization period varies for the bases, with a net effective amortization period of 15 years.

Asset valuation method = Fair value

Discount rate = 4.16%, 3.77% at prior measurement date

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE REQUIRED SUPPLEMENTARY INFORMATION
December 31, 2025

OPEB Plan (continued)

2. Methods and Assumptions Used to Determine Contribution Rates (continued)

Healthcare cost trend rates = Pre-Medicare: 7.00% for 2025 decreasing to an ultimate rate of 5.00% by 2032

Mortality = Mortality rates were based on the PUB-10 Amount-Weighted Mortality Table, projected using 2-dimensional mortality improvement scale MP-2021.

3. Changes in Benefits

None to report.

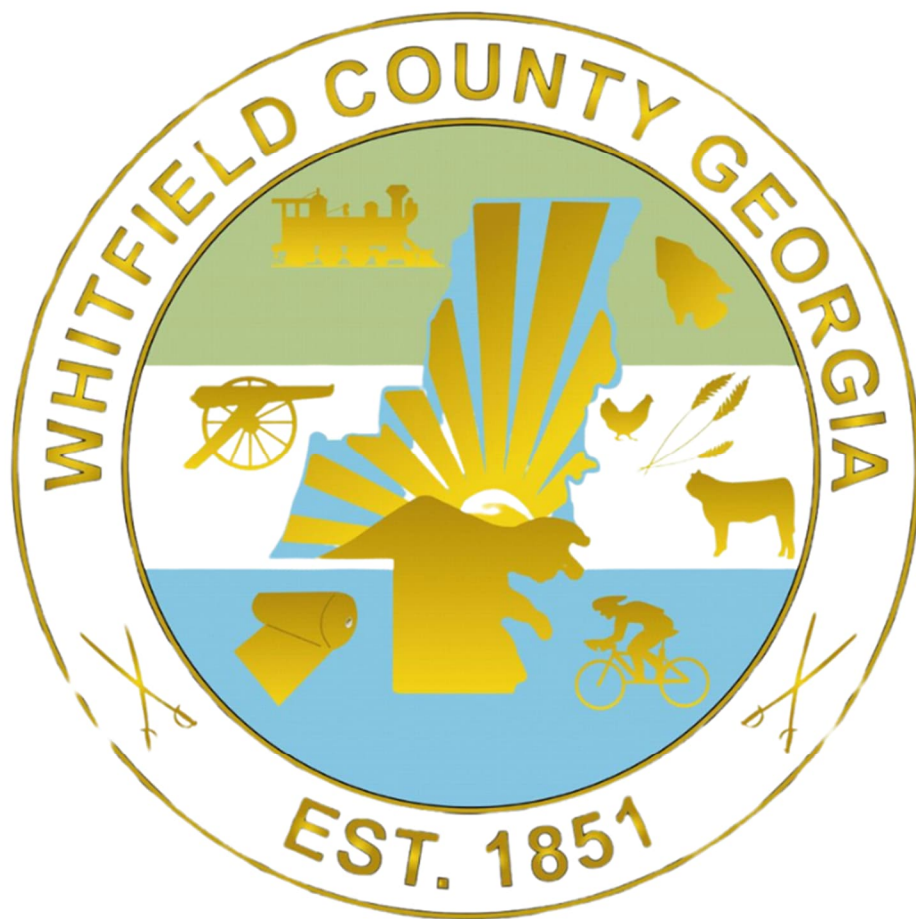
4. Changes of Assumptions

The discount rate changed from 3.77% to 4.16%.

The Medical Trend Rate was reset to 7.00% for fiscal year end 2025, decreasing 0.25% per year to an ultimate rate of 5.00%.

The mortality tables were updated to the PUB-2010 Amount-Weighted General/Safety Mortality Tables – Employees/Retirees/Disabled/Contingent Survivors.

Supplementary Information



COMBINING STATEMENTS

Nonmajor Governmental Funds

Internal Service Funds

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
December 31, 2025**

	Special Revenue Funds	Capital Project Funds	Debt Service Fund	Total Nonmajor Governmental Funds
ASSETS				
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 3,062,133	\$ 4,551,784	\$ 0	\$ 7,613,917
Receivables				
Accounts	2,013,988	0	0	2,013,988
Intergovernmental	251,108	1,068,203	0	1,319,311
Taxes	632,360	0	0	632,360
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	0	31,412	0	31,412
Total assets	\$ 5,959,589	\$ 5,651,399	\$ 0	\$ 11,610,988
LIABILITIES, DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES, AND FUND BALANCES				
Liabilities				
Accounts payable	\$ 86,516	\$ 653	\$ 0	\$ 87,169
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	44,475	778	0	45,253
Due to other funds	191,580	622,415	0	813,995
Total liabilities	322,571	623,846	0	946,417
Deferred inflows of resources				
Unavailable revenue:				
Property taxes	161,345	1,063,203	0	1,224,548
Fines and forfeitures	1,656,517	0	0	1,656,517
Total deferred inflows of resources	1,817,862	1,063,203	0	2,881,065
Fund balances				
Restricted				
Judicial	2,118,481	0	0	2,118,481
Public safety	969,386	0	0	969,386
Housing and development	81,456	0	0	81,456
Capital outlay	0	615,078	0	615,078
Committed				
Capital outlay	0	3,349,272	0	3,349,272
Assigned				
Public works	431,186	0	0	431,186
Culture and recreation	218,647	0	0	218,647
Total fund balances	3,819,156	3,964,350	0	7,783,506
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources and fund balances	\$ 5,959,589	\$ 5,651,399	\$ 0	\$ 11,610,988

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Special Revenue Funds	Capital Projects Funds	Debt Service Fund	Total Nonmajor Governmental Funds
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 872,805	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 872,805
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	563,697	0	0	563,697
Charges for services	2,206,008	0	0	2,206,008
Intergovernmental	707,661	1,263,944	0	1,971,605
Interest	9,753	36,109	0	45,862
Contributions	7,130	0	0	7,130
Other	97,096	46,619	0	143,715
Total revenues	4,464,150	1,346,672	0	5,810,822
EXPENDITURES				
Current				
Judicial	869,188	0	0	869,188
Public Safety	3,699,353	0	0	3,699,353
Public Works	541,458	0	0	541,458
Health and Welfare	243,497	0	0	243,497
Housing and Development	191,488	0	0	191,488
Capital outlay	123,888	3,201,720	0	3,325,608
Debt service	0	616,110	0	616,110
Total expenditures	5,668,872	3,817,830	0	9,486,702
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(1,204,722)	(2,471,158)	0	(3,675,880)
Other financing sources (uses)				
Transfers in	1,437,276	1,900,941	0	3,338,217
Transfers out	(94,468)	(1,020,952)	(2,528)	(1,117,948)
Sale of capital assets	45,975	0	0	45,975
Total other financing sources (uses)	1,388,783	879,989	(2,528)	2,266,244
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	184,061	(1,591,169)	(2,528)	(1,409,636)
Fund balances, January 1	3,635,095	5,555,519	2,528	9,193,142
Fund balances, June 30	\$ 3,819,156	\$ 3,964,350	\$ 0	\$ 7,783,506

INTERNAL SERVICE FUNDS

These funds are used to account for the accumulation of resources to be used for health and workers' compensation insurance costs, as the County is partially self-insured.

Health Insurance Fund – This fund is used to account for the cost of providing life and health insurance benefits to County employees and participating dependents.

Workers' Compensation Fund – This fund is used to account for workers' compensation insurance provided to the County departments.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF NET POSITION
INTERNAL SERVICE FUNDS
December 31, 2025

	<u>Health Insurance Fund</u>	<u>Workers' Compensation Fund</u>	<u>Totals</u>
ASSETS			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 436,683	\$ 2,463,865	\$ 2,900,548
Accounts receivable	<u>510,315</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>510,315</u>
Total current assets	<u>946,998</u>	<u>2,463,865</u>	<u>3,410,863</u>
LIABILITIES			
Current liabilities			
Accounts payable	416,063	5,369	421,432
Claims reserve	<u>530,646</u>	<u>102,842</u>	<u>633,488</u>
Total current liabilities	<u>946,709</u>	<u>108,211</u>	<u>1,054,920</u>
NET POSITION			
Unrestricted	<u>289</u>	<u>2,355,654</u>	<u>2,355,943</u>
Total net position	<u><u>\$ 289</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,355,654</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,355,943</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENSES,
AND CHANGES IN NET POSITION
INTERNAL SERVICE FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Health Insurance Fund	Workers' Compensation Fund	Totals
OPERATING REVENUES			
Charges for services	\$ 11,925,336	\$ 402,396	\$ 12,327,732
Other	65,000	0	65,000
Total operating revenues	<u>11,990,336</u>	<u>402,396</u>	<u>12,392,732</u>
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Premiums and administrative fees	3,001,200	0	3,001,200
Claims paid	9,077,533	227,468	9,305,001
Total operating expenses	<u>12,078,733</u>	<u>227,468</u>	<u>12,306,201</u>
Change in net position	(88,397)	174,928	86,531
Net position, January 1	<u>88,686</u>	<u>2,180,726</u>	<u>2,269,412</u>
Net position, December 31	<u><u>\$ 289</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,355,654</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,355,943</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Health Insurance Fund	Workers' Compensation Fund	Totals
Cash flows from operating activities:			
Receipts from interfund services provided	\$ 11,589,166	\$ 402,396	\$ 11,991,562
Payments to suppliers	(11,715,070)	(408,794)	(12,123,864)
Other receipts	65,000	0	65,000
Net increase (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	(60,904)	(6,398)	(67,302)
Cash and cash equivalents, January 1	497,587	2,470,263	2,967,850
Cash and cash equivalents, December 31	\$ 436,683	\$ 2,463,865	\$ 2,900,548
Reconciliation of operating income (loss) to net cash provided (used) by operating activities:			
Operating income (loss)	\$ (88,397)	\$ 174,928	\$ 86,531
Adjustments to reconcile operating income to net cash provided (used) by operating activities			
(Increase) decrease in accounts receivable	(336,170)	0	(336,170)
Increase (decrease) in accounts payable	109,962	(41,276)	68,686
Increase (decrease) in claims reserve	253,701	(140,050)	113,651
Total adjustments	27,493	(181,326)	(153,833)
Net cash provided (used) by operating activities	\$ (60,904)	\$ (6,398)	\$ (67,302)

NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS

SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS

Special revenue funds are used to account for the proceeds of specific revenue sources that are legally or donor restricted to expenditure for specified purposes.

Law Library Fund – This fund is used to account for fees received from County Courts and used to finance the Law Library's operation and purchase of reference materials.

District Attorney Forfeiture Fund – This fund is used to account for monies confiscated under Federal and Georgia law by the Whitfield County District Attorney's Office related to controlled substances offenses. Such monies are restricted to defray the cost of complex investigations and to purchase equipment relating to said investigations.

Sheriff Forfeiture Fund – This fund is used to account for monies confiscated under Federal and Georgia law by the Whitfield County Sheriff's Office related to controlled substances offenses. Such monies are restricted to defray the cost of complex investigations and to purchase equipment relating to said investigations.

National Opioid Settlement Fund – This fund is used to account for the County's share of opioid settlement payment funds that are restricted for opioid remediation efforts.

Emergency 911 Fund – This fund is used to account for monies collected under Georgia law by the telephone company on behalf of Whitfield County. These monies are remitted to the County and are restricted to providing emergency 911 services to the residents of the County.

CDBG Coronavirus Food Bank Grant Fund – This fund is used to support activities that prevent, prepare for, and respond to the COVID-19 pandemic, including the acquisition, construction, and/or improvement of facilities and services to expand food distribution capacity for residents of the County.

Whitfield County Neighborhood Stabilization Fund – This fund is used support efforts aimed at revitalizing and stabilizing neighborhoods that are experience economic decline, blight, or high rates of foreclosures.

Conasauga A.D.R. Fund – This fund is used to support programs and services that promote alternative methods of resolving disputes outside of traditional courtroom litigation.

Divorce Seminar Fund – This fund is used to provide financial support for educational seminars and programs designed to assist individuals going through a divorce.

Juvenile Services Fund – This fund is used to account for monies collected under Georgia law for probational services to juvenile offenders. Such monies are restricted to providing treatment to juvenile offenders.

Local Victim Assistance Program Fund – This fund is used to support services and resources for victims of crime within the County.

Drug Abuse Treatment and Education Fund – This fund is used to account for monies collected under Georgia law related to additional penalties on controlled substance offenses. Such monies are restricted for drug abuse treatment and education programs relating to controlled substances, alcohol, marijuana, and the purposes of the County's Drug Court.

Community Housing Improvement Program Fund – This fund is used to support the improvement, rehabilitation, and development of affordable housing in the community.

Felony Domestic Violence Grant Fund – This fund is used to provide financial support for programs and services aimed at addressing and preventing felony-level domestic violence offenses.

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SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS, continued

Accountability Courts Grant Program Fund – This fund is used to provide financial support for programs and services that create, expand, or sustain accountability courts aimed at reducing recidivism and promoting rehabilitation among individuals involved in the criminal justice system.

Jointly Funded District Fund – This fund is used to account for property tax revenue generated through the levy of a special millage for the purposes of library and senior center improvements.

Solid Waste District Fund – This fund is used to account for property tax revenue generated through the levy of an sanitation millage for the purposes of advancing sanitation improvements within the County.

Hotel Motel Tax Fund – This fund is used to account for Hotel/Motel tax collections that are restricted for tourism in Whitfield County.

CAPITAL PROJECTS FUNDS

Capital Project Funds are used to account for financial resources to be used for the acquisition or construction of specifically planned projects (other than those financed by proprietary funds).

Capital Acquisition Fund – This fund is used to account for County capital projects.

JDA Project Fund – This fund is used to account for property tax revenue generated through the levy of an economic development millage for the purposes of advancing economic development improvements within the County.

2008 Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax Fund – This fund is used to account for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2008 for a period of time not to exceed six years for the purpose of financing long-term projects.

2015 Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax Fund – This fund is used to account for the proceeds of a 1 percent local option sales tax approved in 2015 for a period of time not to exceed six years for the purpose of financing long-term projects.

DEBT SERVICE FUND

Debt service funds are used to account for the accumulation of resources and payment of general government long-term debt principal and interest from governmental resources.

Debt Service Fund – This fund is used to retire bond principal and to pay interest on general obligation bonds.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS
December 31, 2025

	Law Library	District Attorney Forfeiture	Sheriff Forfeiture	Opioid Settlement Payments	E911	CDBG Coronavirus Food Bank Grant	Whitfield County Neighborhood Stabilization	Conasauga A.D.R. Program
ASSETS								
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 113,970	\$ 39,285	\$ 175,273	\$ 212,663	\$ 240,301	\$ 0	\$ 90,056	\$ 545,534
Receivables								
Accounts	0	0	0	1,656,517	357,359	0	0	0
Intergovernmental	0	0	0	34,603	0	0	0	0
Taxes	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total assets	\$ 113,970	\$ 39,285	\$ 175,273	\$ 1,903,783	\$ 597,660	\$ 0	\$ 90,056	\$ 545,534
LIABILITIES, DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES, AND FUND BALANCES								
Liabilities								
Accounts payable	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 2,465	\$ 1,970	\$ 8,989	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	0	0	0	3,868	33,521	0	0	0
Due to other funds	0	0	0	0	0	0	8,600	0
Total liabilities	0	0	2,465	5,838	42,510	0	8,600	0
Deferred inflows of resources								
Unavailable revenues:								
Property taxes	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Fines and forfeitures	0	0	0	1,656,517	0	0	0	0
Total deferred inflows of resources	0	0	0	1,656,517	0	0	0	0
Fund balances								
Restricted								
Judicial	113,970	39,285	0	0	0	0	0	545,534
Public safety	0	0	172,808	241,428	555,150	0	0	0
Housing and development	0	0	0	0	0	0	81,456	0
Assigned								
Public works	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Culture and recreation	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Total fund balances	113,970	39,285	172,808	241,428	555,150	0	81,456	545,534
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources and fund balances	\$ 113,970	\$ 39,285	\$ 175,273	\$ 1,903,783	\$ 597,660	\$ 0	\$ 90,056	\$ 545,534

Divorce Seminar	Juvenile Service	Local Victim Assistance Program	Drug Abuse Treatment and Education	Community Housing Improvements Program	Felony Domestic Violence Grant	Accountability Courts Grant Program	Jointly Funded District	Solid Waste District	Hotel Motel Tax	Total Nonmajor Special Revenue Governmental Funds
\$ 0	\$ 115,861	\$ 3,153	\$ 532,656	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 667,373	\$ 218,626	\$ 107,382	\$ 0	\$ 3,062,133
0	0	0	0	0	0	112	0	0	0	2,013,988
0	0	3,734	5,974	0	71,892	122,489	0	12,416	0	251,108
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2,067	623,953	6,340	632,360
<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 115,861</u>	<u>\$ 6,887</u>	<u>\$ 538,630</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 71,892</u>	<u>\$ 789,974</u>	<u>\$ 220,693</u>	<u>\$ 743,751</u>	<u>\$ 6,340</u>	<u>\$ 5,959,589</u>
\$ 0	\$ 497	\$ 3,980	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 66,653	\$ 1,962	\$ 86,516
0	0	0	1,272	0	1,814	4,000	0	0	0	44,475
0	0	2,907	0	0	53,052	36,030	0	86,613	4,378	191,580
0	497	6,887	1,272	0	54,866	40,030	0	153,266	6,340	322,571
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2,046	159,299	0	161,345
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1,656,517
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2,046	159,299	0	1,817,862
0	115,364	0	537,358	0	17,026	749,944	0	0	0	2,118,481
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	969,386
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	81,456
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	431,186	0	431,186
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	218,647	0	0	218,647
0	115,364	0	537,358	0	17,026	749,944	218,647	431,186	0	3,819,156
<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 115,861</u>	<u>\$ 6,887</u>	<u>\$ 538,630</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 71,892</u>	<u>\$ 789,974</u>	<u>\$ 220,693</u>	<u>\$ 743,751</u>	<u>\$ 6,340</u>	<u>\$ 5,959,589</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
NONMAJOR GOVERNMENTAL SPECIAL REVENUE FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Law Library	District Attorney Forfeiture	Sheriff Forfeiture	Opioid Settlement Payments	E911	CDBG Coronavirus Food Bank Grant	Whitfield County Neighborhood Stabilization	Conasauga A.D.R. Program
REVENUES								
Taxes	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 1,284	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	35,561	36,477	140,847	126,611	0	0	0	0
Charges for services	0	0	0	0	2,128,822	0	0	68,264
Intergovernmental	0	0	0	70,556	0	48,934	0	0
Interest	1	0	94	0	0	0	0	1,970
Contributions	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Other	1,267	0	6,975	73,909	8,833	0	0	0
Total revenues	36,829	36,477	147,916	271,076	2,138,939	48,934	0	70,234
EXPENDITURES								
Current								
Judicial	34,152	18,481	0	0	0	0	0	31,915
Public Safety	0	0	71,823	115,555	3,511,975	0	0	0
Public Works	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Health and Welfare	0	0	0	243,497	0	0	0	0
Housing and Development	0	0	0	0	0	48,934	0	0
Capital outlay	0	0	123,888	0	0	0	0	0
Total expenditures	34,152	18,481	195,711	359,052	3,511,975	48,934	0	31,915
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	2,677	17,996	(47,795)	(87,976)	(1,373,036)	0	0	38,319
Other financing sources (uses)								
Transfers in	0	0	0	0	1,399,457	0	0	0
Transfers out	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Sale of capital assets	0	0	45,975	0	0	0	0	0
Total other financing sources (uses)	0	0	45,975	0	1,399,457	0	0	0
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	2,677	17,996	(1,820)	(87,976)	26,421	0	0	38,319
Fund balances, January 1	111,293	21,289	174,628	329,404	528,729	0	81,456	507,215
Fund balances, December 31	\$ 113,970	\$ 39,285	\$ 172,808	\$ 241,428	\$ 555,150	\$ 0	\$ 81,456	\$ 545,534

Divorce Seminar	Juvenile Service	Local Victim Assistance Program	Drug Abuse Treatment and Education	Community Housing Improvements Program	Felony Domestic Violence Grant	Accountability Courts Grant Program	Jointly Funded District	Solid Waste District	Hotel Motel Tax	Total Nonmajor Special Revenue Governmental Funds
\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 2,235	\$ 783,947	\$ 85,339	\$ 872,805
0	0	76,124	115,372	0	0	32,705	0	0	0	563,697
0	8,872	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	50	2,206,008
0	0	0	0	45,904	159,421	364,009	0	18,837	0	707,661
0	0	0	0	0	0	7,688	0	0	0	9,753
0	0	0	0	0	0	7,130	0	0	0	7,130
0	0	0	0	0	0	6,112	0	0	0	97,096
0	8,872	76,124	115,372	45,904	159,421	417,644	2,235	802,784	85,389	4,464,150
0	20,443	22,837	136,496	0	179,333	425,531	0	0	0	869,188
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3,699,353
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	541,458	0	541,458
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	243,497
0	0	0	0	57,165	0	0	0	0	85,389	191,488
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	123,888
0	20,443	22,837	136,496	57,165	179,333	425,531	0	541,458	85,389	5,668,872
0	(11,571)	53,287	(21,124)	(11,261)	(19,912)	(7,887)	2,235	261,326	0	(1,204,722)
0	0	0	0	11,261	0	26,558	0	0	0	1,437,276
(14,623)	0	(53,287)	(26,558)	0	0	0	0	0	0	(94,468)
0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	45,975
(14,623)	0	(53,287)	(26,558)	11,261	0	26,558	0	0	0	1,388,783
(14,623)	(11,571)	0	(47,682)	0	(19,912)	18,671	2,235	261,326	0	184,061
14,623	126,935	0	585,040	0	36,938	731,273	216,412	169,860	0	3,635,095
\$ 0	\$ 115,364	\$ 0	\$ 537,358	\$ 0	\$ 17,026	\$ 749,944	\$ 218,647	\$ 431,186	\$ 0	\$ 3,819,156

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
LAW LIBRARY
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 35,400	\$ 35,561	\$ 161
Interest	349	1	(348)
Other	<u>1,176</u>	<u>1,267</u>	<u>91</u>
Total revenues	<u>36,925</u>	<u>36,829</u>	<u>(96)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>36,925</u>	<u>34,152</u>	<u>2,773</u>
Total expenditures	<u>36,925</u>	<u>34,152</u>	<u>2,773</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	2,677	2,677
Fund balance, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>111,293</u>	<u>111,293</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 113,970</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 113,970</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DISTRICT ATTORNEY'S FORFEITURE
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 36,477	\$ 36,477	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>36,477</u>	<u>36,477</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>18,481</u>	<u>18,481</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>18,481</u>	<u>18,481</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	17,996	17,996	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(17,996)</u>	<u>21,289</u>	<u>39,285</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 39,285</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 39,285</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SHERIFF'S FORFEITURE
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 100,000	\$ 140,847	\$ 40,847
Interest	150	94	(56)
Other	<u>0</u>	<u>6,975</u>	<u>6,975</u>
Total revenues	<u>100,150</u>	<u>147,916</u>	<u>47,766</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Safety	72,000	71,823	177
Capital outlay	<u>128,150</u>	<u>123,888</u>	<u>4,262</u>
Total expenditures	<u>200,150</u>	<u>195,711</u>	<u>4,439</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(100,000)	(47,795)	52,205
Other financing sources (uses)			
Sale of capital assets	<u>0</u>	<u>45,975</u>	<u>45,975</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(100,000)	(1,820)	98,180
Fund balances, January 1	<u>100,000</u>	<u>174,628</u>	<u>74,628</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 172,808</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 172,808</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
OPIOID SETTLEMENT PAYMENTS
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 102,982	\$ 126,611	\$ 23,629
Intergovernmental	95,353	70,556	(24,797)
Other	158,659	73,909	(84,750)
Total revenues	<u>356,994</u>	<u>271,076</u>	<u>(85,918)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Safety	139,321	115,555	23,766
Health and Welfare	250,235	243,497	6,738
Total expenditures	<u>389,556</u>	<u>359,052</u>	<u>30,504</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(32,562)	(87,976)	(55,414)
Fund balances, January 1	<u>32,562</u>	<u>329,404</u>	<u>296,842</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 241,428</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 241,428</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
E911 SYSTEM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 0	\$ 1,284	\$ 1,284
Charges for services	2,147,639	2,128,822	(18,817)
Other	<u>10,925</u>	<u>8,833</u>	<u>(2,092)</u>
Total revenues	<u>2,158,564</u>	<u>2,138,939</u>	<u>(19,625)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Safety	<u>3,544,758</u>	<u>3,511,975</u>	<u>32,783</u>
Total expenditures	<u>3,544,758</u>	<u>3,511,975</u>	<u>32,783</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(1,386,194)	(1,373,036)	13,158
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in	<u>1,399,457</u>	<u>1,399,457</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	13,263	26,421	13,158
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(13,263)</u>	<u>528,729</u>	<u>541,992</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 555,150</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 555,150</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CDBG CORONAVIRUS FOOD BANK GRANT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 61,052	\$ 48,934	\$ (12,118)
Total revenues	<u>61,052</u>	<u>48,934</u>	<u>(12,118)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>61,052</u>	<u>48,934</u>	<u>12,118</u>
Total expenditures	<u>61,052</u>	<u>48,934</u>	<u>12,118</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
WHITFIELD COUNTY NEIGHBORHOOD STABILIZATION PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>81,456</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>81,456</u>
Total expenditures	<u>81,456</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>81,456</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(81,456)	0	81,456
Fund balances, January 1	<u>81,456</u>	<u>81,456</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 81,456</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 81,456</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CONASAUGA ADR PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	Final Budget	Actual	Variance
REVENUES			
Charges for services	\$ 40,529	\$ 68,264	\$ 27,735
Interest	540	1,970	1,430
Total revenues	<u>41,069</u>	<u>70,234</u>	<u>29,165</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	58,500	31,915	26,585
Total expenditures	<u>58,500</u>	<u>31,915</u>	<u>26,585</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(17,431)	38,319	55,750
Fund balances, January 1	<u>17,431</u>	<u>507,215</u>	<u>489,784</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 545,534</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 545,534</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DIVORCE SEMINAR
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers out	<u>(14,623)</u>	<u>(14,623)</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(14,623)	(14,623)	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>14,623</u>	<u>14,623</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
JUVENILE SERVICE
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Charges for services	\$ 25,000	\$ 8,872	\$ (16,128)
Total revenues	<u>25,000</u>	<u>8,872</u>	<u>(16,128)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>20,500</u>	<u>20,443</u>	<u>57</u>
Total expenditures	<u>20,500</u>	<u>20,443</u>	<u>57</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	4,500	(11,571)	(16,071)
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(4,500)</u>	<u>126,935</u>	<u>131,435</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 115,364</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 115,364</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
LOCAL VICTIMS ASSISTANCE PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 76,124	\$ 76,124	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>76,124</u>	<u>76,124</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>22,837</u>	<u>22,837</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>22,837</u>	<u>22,837</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	53,287	53,287	0
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers (out)	<u>(53,287)</u>	<u>(53,287)</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DRUG ABUSE TREATMENT AND EDUCATION
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Fines, fees, and forfeitures	\$ 115,373	\$ 115,372	\$ (1)
Total revenues	<u>115,373</u>	<u>115,372</u>	<u>(1)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>136,496</u>	<u>136,496</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>136,496</u>	<u>136,496</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(21,123)	(21,124)	(1)
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers (out)	<u>(26,558)</u>	<u>(26,558)</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	(47,681)	(47,682)	(1)
Fund balances, January 1	<u>47,681</u>	<u>585,040</u>	<u>537,359</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 537,358</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 537,358</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMMUNITY HOUSING IMPROVEMENTS PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 45,904	\$ 45,904	\$ 0
Total revenues	<u>45,904</u>	<u>45,904</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>57,165</u>	<u>57,165</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>57,165</u>	<u>57,165</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(11,261)	(11,261)	0
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in	<u>11,261</u>	<u>11,261</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FELONY DOMESTIC VIOLENCE COURT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Intergovernmental	\$ 203,334	\$ 159,421	\$ (43,913)
Total revenues	<u>203,334</u>	<u>159,421</u>	<u>(43,913)</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>219,834</u>	<u>179,333</u>	<u>40,501</u>
Total expenditures	<u>219,834</u>	<u>179,333</u>	<u>40,501</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(16,500)	(19,912)	(3,412)
Fund balances, January 1	<u>16,500</u>	<u>36,938</u>	<u>20,438</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 17,026</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 17,026</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
ACCOUNTABILITY COURTS GRANTS PROGRAM
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Final Budget	Actual	Variance
REVENUES			
Fines and forfeitures	\$ 32,705	\$ 32,705	\$ 0
Intergovernmental	364,009	364,009	0
Interest	7,688	7,688	0
Contributions	7,130	7,130	0
Other	6,112	6,112	0
Total revenues	<u>417,644</u>	<u>417,644</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Judicial	<u>428,298</u>	<u>425,531</u>	<u>2,767</u>
Total expenditures	<u>428,298</u>	<u>425,531</u>	<u>2,767</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	(10,654)	(7,887)	2,767
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in	<u>26,558</u>	<u>26,558</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	15,904	18,671	2,767
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(15,904)</u>	<u>731,273</u>	<u>747,177</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 749,944</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 749,944</u></u>

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
JOINTLY FUNDED DISTRICT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025**

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 0	\$ 2,235	\$ 2,235
Total revenues	<u>0</u>	<u>2,235</u>	<u>2,235</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	2,235	2,235
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>216,412</u>	<u>216,412</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 218,647</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 218,647</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SOLID WASTE DISTRICT
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 587,994	\$ 783,947	\$ 195,953
Intergovernmental	<u>0</u>	<u>18,837</u>	<u>18,837</u>
Total revenues	<u>587,994</u>	<u>802,784</u>	<u>214,790</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Public Works	<u>541,458</u>	<u>541,458</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>541,458</u>	<u>541,458</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	46,536	261,326	214,790
Fund balances, January 1	<u>(46,536)</u>	<u>169,860</u>	<u>216,396</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 431,186</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 431,186</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
HOTEL/MOTEL TAX
SPECIAL REVENUE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES			
Taxes	\$ 85,339	\$ 85,339	\$ 0
Charges for services	<u>50</u>	<u>50</u>	<u>0</u>
Total revenues	<u>85,389</u>	<u>85,389</u>	<u>0</u>
EXPENDITURES			
Current			
Housing and Development	<u>85,389</u>	<u>85,389</u>	<u>0</u>
Total expenditures	<u>85,389</u>	<u>85,389</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Fund balances, January 1	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING BALANCE SHEET
NONMAJOR CAPITAL PROJECT FUNDS
December 31, 2025

	Capital Acquisition	JDA Project	2008 SPLOST	2015 SPLOST	Total Nonmajor Capital Projects Funds
ASSETS					
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 427,186	\$ 2,917,739	\$ 1,206,859	\$ 0	\$ 4,551,784
Intergovernmental receivable	5,000	1,063,203	0	0	1,068,203
Restricted cash and cash equivalents	31,412	0	0	0	31,412
Total assets	<u>\$ 463,598</u>	<u>\$ 3,980,942</u>	<u>\$ 1,206,859</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 5,651,399</u>
LIABILITIES, DEFERRED INFLOWS OF RESOURCES, AND FUND BALANCES					
Liabilities					
Accounts payable	\$ 653	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 653
Accrued salaries and payroll liabilities	0	0	778	0	778
Due to other funds	0	0	622,415	0	622,415
Total liabilities	<u>653</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>623,193</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>623,846</u>
Deferred inflows of resources					
Unavailable revenue - property taxes	<u>0</u>	<u>1,063,203</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>1,063,203</u>
Fund balances					
Restricted:					
Capital outlay	31,412	0	583,666	0	615,078
Committed:					
Capital outlay	<u>431,533</u>	<u>2,917,739</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>3,349,272</u>
Total fund balances	<u>462,945</u>	<u>2,917,739</u>	<u>583,666</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>3,964,350</u>
Total liabilities, deferred inflows of resources and fund balances	<u>\$ 463,598</u>	<u>\$ 3,980,942</u>	<u>\$ 1,206,859</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 5,651,399</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
COMBINING STATEMENT OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES,
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
NONMAJOR CAPITAL PROJECT FUNDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Capital Acquisition	JDA Project	2008 SPLOST	2015 SPLOST	Total Nonmajor Capital Projects Funds
REVENUES					
Intergovernmental	\$ 55,202	\$ 1,208,742	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 1,263,944
Interest	0	0	22,055	14,054	36,109
Other	43,912	2,707	0	0	46,619
Total revenues	<u>99,114</u>	<u>1,211,449</u>	<u>22,055</u>	<u>14,054</u>	<u>1,346,672</u>
EXPENDITURES					
Capital outlay	1,656,880	172,171	266,602	1,106,067	3,201,720
Debt service	0	616,110	0	0	616,110
Total expenditures	<u>1,656,880</u>	<u>788,281</u>	<u>266,602</u>	<u>1,106,067</u>	<u>3,817,830</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	<u>(1,557,766)</u>	<u>423,168</u>	<u>(244,547)</u>	<u>(1,092,013)</u>	<u>(2,471,158)</u>
Other financing sources (uses)					
Transfers in	1,848,985	51,956	0	0	1,900,941
Transfers out	0	(1,020,952)	0	0	(1,020,952)
Total other financing sources (uses)	<u>1,848,985</u>	<u>(968,996)</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>879,989</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing uses	<u>291,219</u>	<u>(545,828)</u>	<u>(244,547)</u>	<u>(1,092,013)</u>	<u>(1,591,169)</u>
Fund balances, January 1	<u>171,726</u>	<u>3,463,567</u>	<u>828,213</u>	<u>1,092,013</u>	<u>5,555,519</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 462,945</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 2,917,739</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 583,666</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 3,964,350</u></u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DEBT SERVICE FUND
SCHEDULE OF REVENUES, EXPENDITURES
AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES
BUDGET (GAAP BASIS) AND ACTUAL
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	<u>Final Budget</u>	<u>Actual</u>	<u>Variance</u>
REVENUES	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0
EXPENDITURES	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over (under) expenditures	0	0	0
Other financing sources (uses)			
Transfers in (out)	<u>(2,529)</u>	<u>(2,528)</u>	<u>1</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues and other financing sources over (under) expenditures and other financing sources	(2,529)	(2,528)	1
Fund balances, January 1	<u>2,529</u>	<u>2,528</u>	<u>(1)</u>
Fund balances, December 31	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>	<u><u>\$ 0</u></u>

CUSTODIAL FUNDS

These funds are used to account for assets held by the County as a custodian to be expended in accordance with the conditions of its custodial capacity.

Tax Commissioner - This fund accounts for assets and related liabilities for the collection of taxes and tag and title fees.

Clerk of Superior Court, Probate Court, Juvenile Court, and Magistrate Court - These funds account for assets and related liabilities for the collection of court related fees.

Sheriff Department - This fund accounts for deposits held for incarcerated inmates.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CUSTODIAL FUNDS
STATEMENT OF FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
December 31, 2025

	<u>Tax Commissioner</u>	<u>Clerk of Superior Court</u>	<u>Sheriff</u>	<u>Probate Court</u>	<u>Magistrate Court</u>	<u>Juvenile Court</u>	<u>Total Custodial Funds</u>
ASSETS							
Cash and cash equivalents	\$ 13,848,197	\$ 295,716	\$ 406,671	\$ 81,230	\$ 87,693	\$ 7,819	\$ 14,727,326
Taxes receivable	<u>76,706,052</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>76,706,052</u>
Total assets	<u>90,554,249</u>	<u>295,716</u>	<u>406,671</u>	<u>81,230</u>	<u>87,693</u>	<u>7,819</u>	<u>91,433,378</u>
LIABILITIES							
Due to others	<u>89,923,481</u>	<u>170,381</u>	<u>53,953</u>	<u>37,353</u>	<u>75,417</u>	<u>7,819</u>	<u>90,268,404</u>
NET POSITION							
Restricted for individuals, organizations, and other governments	<u>\$ 630,768</u>	<u>\$ 125,335</u>	<u>\$ 352,718</u>	<u>\$ 43,877</u>	<u>\$ 12,276</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>	<u>\$ 1,164,974</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CUSTODIAL FUNDS
STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN FIDUCIARY NET POSITION
For the year ended December 31, 2025

	Tax Commissioner	Clerk of Superior Court	Sheriff	Probate Court	Magistrate Court	Juvenile Court	Total Custodial Funds
ADDITIONS							
Taxes collected for other agencies	\$ 133,655,780	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 0	\$ 133,655,780
Court fees collected for other agencies	0	2,107,638	0	282,953	920,163	0	3,310,754
Court individual cases	0	2,838,919	0	181,453	25,005	14,988	3,060,365
Sheriff fees collected	0	0	399,102	0	0	0	399,102
Sheriff inmate account deposits	0	0	1,235,637	0	0	0	1,235,637
Total additions	133,655,780	4,946,557	1,634,739	464,406	945,168	14,988	141,661,638
DEDUCTIONS							
Taxes distributed to other agencies	133,671,786	0	0	0	0	0	133,671,786
Court fees distributed to other agencies	0	2,082,496	0	284,606	920,163	14,988	3,302,253
Payments to others	0	2,838,919	0	183,666	19,032	0	3,041,617
Sheriff fees distributed to other agencies	0	0	341,666	0	0	0	341,666
Payments from inmates to others	0	0	1,219,673	0	0	0	1,219,673
Total deductions	133,671,786	4,921,415	1,561,339	468,272	939,195	14,988	141,576,995
Change in net position	(16,006)	25,142	73,400	(3,866)	5,973	0	84,643
Net position, January 1	646,774	100,193	279,318	47,743	6,303	0	1,080,331
Net position, December 31	\$ 630,768	\$ 125,335	\$ 352,718	\$ 43,877	\$ 12,276	\$ 0	\$ 1,164,974

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Part III

Statistical Section



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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

Introduction to the Statistical Section (UNAUDITED)

The contents of the statistical section of the annual comprehensive financial report presents information regarding financial trends, revenue capacity, debt service and debt capacity, demographic and economic information and operating information.

Financial Trends.....	126-134
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These schedules should help the reader understand how the County's financial performance and well-being have changed over time.

Revenue Capacity.....	135-140
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These schedules contain information in order for the reader to assess the County's most significant revenue sources.

Debt Capacity.....	141-144
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These schedules contain information in order for the reader to assess the affordability of the County's current levels of outstanding debt and the ability for the County to issue additional debt in the future.

Demographic and Economic Information.....	145-146
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These schedules offer demographic and economic indicators to help the reader understand the environment within which the County's financial activities take place.

Operating Information.....	147-149
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These schedules contain service and infrastructure data to help the reader understand how the information in the County's financial report relates to the services the County provides and the activities it performs.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

NET POSITION BY COMPONENT

	<u>2025</u>	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>
Governmental activities				
Net investment in capital assets	\$ 218,268,229	\$ 214,890,988	\$ 209,697,143	\$ 205,037,958
Restricted	20,104,816	15,631,120	16,757,836	15,757,850
Unrestricted	8,702,276	20,778,719	25,681,294	27,341,968
Total governmental activities net position	<u>\$ 247,075,321</u>	<u>\$ 251,300,827</u>	<u>\$ 252,136,273</u>	<u>\$ 248,137,776</u>
Business-type activities				
Net investment in capital assets	\$ 359,118	\$ 62,634	\$ 89,104	\$ 124,126
Unrestricted	15,582,087	15,810,288	16,828,895	19,569,567
Total business-type activities net position	<u>\$ 15,941,205</u>	<u>\$ 15,872,922</u>	<u>\$ 16,917,999</u>	<u>\$ 19,693,693</u>
Primary government				
Net investment in capital assets	\$ 218,627,347	\$ 214,953,622	\$ 209,786,247	\$ 205,162,084
Restricted	20,104,816	15,631,120	16,757,836	15,757,850
Unrestricted	24,284,363	36,589,007	42,510,189	46,911,535
Total primary government net position	<u>\$ 263,016,526</u>	<u>\$ 267,173,749</u>	<u>\$ 269,054,272</u>	<u>\$ 267,831,469</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

NET POSITION BY COMPONENT

<u>2021</u>	<u>2020</u>	<u>2019</u>	<u>2018</u>	<u>2017 - Restated</u>	<u>2016</u>
\$ 199,289,800	\$ 174,460,330	\$ 194,165,355	\$ 210,051,630	\$ 225,843,608	\$ 237,951,877
19,459,446	37,914,589	17,984,043	21,170,375	16,412,612	23,879,901
15,333,560	15,452,050	15,992,924	10,765,984	9,938,504	(4,685,019)
<u>\$ 234,082,806</u>	<u>\$ 227,826,969</u>	<u>\$ 228,142,322</u>	<u>\$ 241,987,989</u>	<u>\$ 252,194,724</u>	<u>\$ 257,146,759</u>
\$ 177,959	\$ 129,211	\$ 215,677	\$ 261,751	\$ 211,536	\$ 161,927
18,513,942	16,973,807	18,442,054	16,577,913	16,310,985	15,596,297
<u>\$ 18,691,901</u>	<u>\$ 17,103,018</u>	<u>\$ 18,657,731</u>	<u>\$ 16,839,664</u>	<u>\$ 16,522,521</u>	<u>\$ 15,758,224</u>
\$ 199,467,759	\$ 174,589,541	\$ 194,381,032	\$ 210,313,381	\$ 226,055,144	\$ 238,113,804
19,459,446	37,914,589	17,984,043	21,170,375	16,412,612	23,879,901
33,847,502	32,425,857	34,434,978	27,343,897	26,249,489	10,911,278
<u>\$ 252,774,707</u>	<u>\$ 244,929,987</u>	<u>\$ 246,800,053</u>	<u>\$ 258,827,653</u>	<u>\$ 268,717,245</u>	<u>\$ 272,904,983</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

CHANGES IN NET POSITION

	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021
Expenses					
Governmental activities:					
General government	\$ 16,133,948	\$ 15,116,378	\$ 11,853,842	\$ 9,529,580	\$ 9,872,837
Judicial	10,290,071	9,774,672	9,890,084	8,923,762	8,724,385
Public safety	51,147,139	45,281,174	44,297,001	35,116,805	38,017,889
Public works	28,260,374	28,375,351	24,592,195	24,201,335	22,000,769
Health and welfare	1,416,140	1,270,711	3,841,823	1,201,978	582,415
Culture and recreation	4,389,793	3,960,102	3,898,447	2,838,383	1,979,171
Housing and development	4,318,289	4,096,847	4,002,331	3,135,229	2,903,608
Interest on long-term debt	91,926	90,957	166,236	242,298	318,286
Total governmental activities expenses	<u>\$ 116,047,680</u>	<u>\$ 107,966,192</u>	<u>\$ 102,541,959</u>	<u>\$ 85,189,370</u>	<u>\$ 84,399,360</u>
Business-type activities:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ 86,372	\$ 76,043	\$ 144,241	\$ 121,079	\$ 177,176
Whitfield Transit System	892,521	858,552	697,021	622,879	573,655
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	(1,148,650)	1,008,535	2,633,927	(1,039,695)	(1,646,502)
Total business-type activities expenses	<u>(169,757)</u>	<u>1,943,130</u>	<u>3,475,189</u>	<u>(295,737)</u>	<u>(895,671)</u>
Total primary government expenses	<u>\$ 115,877,923</u>	<u>\$ 109,909,322</u>	<u>\$ 106,017,148</u>	<u>\$ 84,893,633</u>	<u>\$ 83,503,689</u>
Program Revenues					
Governmental activities:					
Charge for services:					
General government	\$ 3,813,381	\$ 5,474,980	\$ 2,347,549	\$ 1,242,705	\$ 1,646,471
Judicial	1,919,177	1,990,283	2,235,146	2,133,588	2,074,654
Public safety	3,189,158	3,409,632	3,817,610	3,975,839	3,455,182
Public works	1,364,106	1,194,489	374,250	247,032	233,049
Health and welfare	43,457	44,801	-	-	-
Culture and recreation	431,985	446,545	467,089	323,054	248,917
Housing and development	2,609	17,385	1,348,616	781,289	830,065
Operating grants and contributions	7,157,236	8,079,097	13,882,307	8,878,506	6,642,347
Capital grants and contributions	4,591,092	3,334,542	3,733,255	1,130,064	2,284,460
Total governmental activities program revenues	<u>\$ 22,512,201</u>	<u>\$ 23,991,754</u>	<u>\$ 28,205,822</u>	<u>\$ 18,712,077</u>	<u>\$ 17,415,145</u>
Business-type activities:					
Charge for services:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Whitfield Transit System	372,326	262,551	318,420	171,619	86,229
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	-	-	-	-	-
Operating grants and contributions	776,174	563,715	381,075	274,744	500,025
Capital grants and contributions	-	-	-	-	-
Total business-type activities program revenues	<u>\$ 1,148,500</u>	<u>\$ 826,266</u>	<u>\$ 699,495</u>	<u>\$ 446,363</u>	<u>\$ 586,254</u>
Total primary government program revenues	<u>\$ 23,660,701</u>	<u>\$ 24,818,020</u>	<u>\$ 28,905,317</u>	<u>\$ 19,158,440</u>	<u>\$ 18,001,399</u>
Net (Expense)/ Revenue					
Governmental activities	\$ (93,535,479)	\$ (83,974,438)	\$ (74,336,137)	\$ (66,477,293)	\$ (66,984,215)
Business-type activities	1,318,257	(1,116,864)	(2,775,694)	742,100	1,481,925
Total primary government net (expense)/ revenue	<u>\$ (92,217,222)</u>	<u>\$ (85,091,302)</u>	<u>\$ (77,111,831)</u>	<u>\$ (65,735,193)</u>	<u>\$ (65,502,290)</u>

	<u>2025</u>	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>	<u>2021</u>
General revenues and Other Changes in Net Position					
Governmental activities:					
Property taxes	\$ 34,134,567	\$ 32,119,003	\$ 31,725,127	\$ 35,064,617	\$ 32,243,964
Sales taxes	41,303,690	40,550,126	41,141,493	38,799,488	34,483,662
Insurance premium tax	6,315,139	5,632,927	5,295,852	4,888,585	5,022,222
Alcoholic beverage tax	388,230	400,551	401,523	422,523	427,652
Hotel/Motel tax	85,339	178,231	225,585	225,692	213,264
Miscellaneous taxes	739,025	790,075	586,878	778,827	587,470
Miscellaneous	2,559,363	2,142,634	422,319	257,827	233,712
Gain or (loss) on sale of capital assets	177,704	165,723	48,907	79,498	123,142
Investment earnings	2,650,992	1,408,079	1,626,195	274,898	11,923
Transfers	1,250,000	-	-	(259,692)	(106,959)
Total governmental activities	<u>\$ 89,604,049</u>	<u>\$ 83,387,349</u>	<u>\$ 81,473,879</u>	<u>\$ 80,532,263</u>	<u>\$ 73,240,052</u>
Business-type activities:					
Miscellaneous	\$ 26	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Transfers	(1,250,000)	-	-	259,692	106,959
Total business-type activities	<u>\$ (1,249,974)</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$ 259,692</u>	<u>\$ 106,959</u>
Total primary government	<u>\$ 88,354,075</u>	<u>\$ 83,387,349</u>	<u>\$ 81,473,879</u>	<u>\$ 80,791,955</u>	<u>\$ 73,347,011</u>
Change in Net Position					
Governmental activities	\$ (3,931,430)	\$ (587,089)	\$ 7,137,742	\$ 14,054,970	\$ 6,255,837
Business-type activities	68,283	(1,116,864)	(2,775,694)	1,001,792	1,588,884
Total primary government	<u>\$ (3,863,147)</u>	<u>\$ (1,703,953)</u>	<u>\$ 4,362,048</u>	<u>\$ 15,056,762</u>	<u>\$ 7,844,721</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

CHANGES IN NET POSITION

	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
Expenses					
Governmental activities:					
General government	\$ 10,413,798	\$ 10,161,993	\$ 9,877,894	\$ 9,442,567	\$ 8,936,272
Judicial	8,177,965	8,219,568	8,075,571	6,868,947	6,580,810
Public safety	34,718,647	34,788,649	30,482,562	33,437,317	32,838,284
Public works	14,857,237	32,925,790	35,286,715	31,557,349	30,209,653
Health and welfare	541,984	538,984	538,984	731,409	708,319
Culture and recreation	1,827,612	1,794,679	1,750,337	1,657,626	1,917,403
Housing and development	3,746,930	4,015,308	2,920,984	3,832,215	2,680,820
Interest on long-term debt	522,205	345,034	475,610	513,383	656,350
Total governmental activities expenses	<u>\$ 74,806,378</u>	<u>\$ 92,790,005</u>	<u>\$ 89,408,657</u>	<u>\$ 88,040,813</u>	<u>\$ 84,527,911</u>
Business-type activities:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ 251,053	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Whitfield Transit System	709,240	750,922	783,734	742,284	744,371
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	1,298,396	-	-	-	-
Total business-type activities expenses	<u>2,258,689</u>	<u>750,922</u>	<u>783,734</u>	<u>742,284</u>	<u>744,371</u>
Total primary government expenses	<u>\$ 77,065,067</u>	<u>\$ 93,540,927</u>	<u>\$ 90,192,391</u>	<u>\$ 88,783,097</u>	<u>\$ 85,272,282</u>
Program Revenues					
Governmental activities:					
Charge for services:					
General government	\$ 1,555,888	\$ 1,597,716	\$ 2,108,452	\$ 2,113,176	\$ 1,900,811
Judicial	1,962,345	1,849,675	1,963,686	2,871,599	2,728,927
Public safety	3,406,440	3,739,406	3,517,869	2,338,532	2,330,452
Public works	228,070	556,361	609,255	128,190	145,020
Culture and recreation	121,287	156,571	169,342	145,897	147,979
Housing and development	448,921	484,943	546,497	2,202,650	2,009,994
Operating grants and contributions	6,978,791	4,938,148	3,312,192	2,458,535	2,573,112
Capital grants and contributions	3,224,402	1,452,571	1,395,063	3,044,312	2,070,393
Total governmental activities program revenues	<u>\$ 17,926,144</u>	<u>\$ 14,775,391</u>	<u>\$ 13,622,356</u>	<u>\$ 15,302,891</u>	<u>\$ 13,906,688</u>
Business-type activities:					
Charge for services:					
Northwest Georgia Trade and Convention Center	\$ -	\$ 104,618	\$ 168,986	\$ 112,466	\$ 154,392
Whitfield Transit System	64,957	200,702	228,652	212,076	242,490
Dalton-Whitfield SWM Authority	-	1,724,867	828,712	651,831	600,385
Operating grants and contributions	595,387	304,419	360,577	289,534	290,525
Capital grants and contributions	-	-	-	135,445	132,227
Total business-type activities program revenues	<u>\$ 660,344</u>	<u>\$ 2,334,606</u>	<u>\$ 1,586,927</u>	<u>\$ 1,401,352</u>	<u>\$ 1,420,019</u>
Total primary government program revenues	<u>\$ 18,586,488</u>	<u>\$ 17,109,997</u>	<u>\$ 15,209,283</u>	<u>\$ 16,704,243</u>	<u>\$ 15,326,707</u>
Net (Expense)/ Revenue					
Governmental activities	\$ (56,880,234)	\$ (78,014,614)	\$ (75,786,301)	\$ (72,737,922)	\$ (70,621,223)
Business-type activities	<u>(1,598,345)</u>	<u>1,583,684</u>	<u>803,193</u>	<u>659,068</u>	<u>675,648</u>
Total primary government net (expense)/ revenue	<u>\$ (58,478,579)</u>	<u>\$ (76,430,930)</u>	<u>\$ (74,983,108)</u>	<u>\$ (72,078,854)</u>	<u>\$ (69,945,575)</u>

	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
General revenues and Other Changes in Net Position					
Governmental activities:					
Property taxes	\$ 31,611,939	\$ 34,220,533	\$ 32,453,402	\$ 31,513,742	\$ 28,271,752
Sales taxes	18,423,324	20,197,515	27,380,737	25,680,398	25,524,158
Insurance premium tax	4,838,448	4,560,447	4,272,930	3,962,650	3,700,351
Alcoholic beverage tax	439,003	411,188	407,996	404,559	397,186
Hotel/Motel tax	137,042	228,692	260,224	246,476	257,608
Miscellaneous taxes	576,690	717,816	700,966	842,068	792,105
Miscellaneous	454,190	262,590	191,478	1,097,834	980,016
Gain or (loss) on sale of capital assets	31,464	-	-	783,670	47,711
Investment earnings	78,421	149,271	109,718	11,719	10,674
Transfers	(43,631)	(234,383)	(197,885)	(105,229)	(79,129)
Total governmental activities	<u>\$ 56,546,890</u>	<u>\$ 60,513,669</u>	<u>\$ 65,579,566</u>	<u>\$ 64,437,887</u>	<u>\$ 59,902,432</u>
Business-type activities:					
Miscellaneous	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -	\$ -
Transfers	43,631	234,383	197,885	105,229	79,129
Total business-type activities	<u>\$ 43,631</u>	<u>\$ 234,383</u>	<u>\$ 197,885</u>	<u>\$ 105,229</u>	<u>\$ 79,129</u>
Total primary government	<u>\$ 56,590,521</u>	<u>\$ 60,748,052</u>	<u>\$ 65,777,451</u>	<u>\$ 64,543,116</u>	<u>\$ 59,981,561</u>
Change in Net Position					
Governmental activities	\$ (333,344)	\$ (17,500,945)	\$ (10,206,735)	\$ (8,300,035)	\$ (10,718,791)
Business-type activities	(1,554,714)	1,818,067	1,001,078	764,297	754,777
Total primary government	<u>\$ (1,888,058)</u>	<u>\$ (15,682,878)</u>	<u>\$ (9,205,657)</u>	<u>\$ (7,535,738)</u>	<u>\$ (9,964,014)</u>

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WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FUND BALANCES OF GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

	<u>2025</u>	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>	<u>2021</u>	<u>2020</u>	<u>2019</u>	<u>2018</u>	<u>2017</u>	<u>2016</u>
General fund:										
Nonspendable	\$ 548,330	\$ 560,010	\$ 569,234	\$ 444,771	\$ 415,908	\$ 421,669	\$ 407,940	\$ 419,191	\$ 380,294	\$ 368,221
Restricted	1,441,087	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Assigned	1,987,471	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Unassigned	<u>19,165,540</u>	<u>29,462,476</u>	<u>34,765,919</u>	<u>35,464,532</u>	<u>28,914,750</u>	<u>28,386,644</u>	<u>26,744,207</u>	<u>22,648,547</u>	<u>19,107,881</u>	<u>15,485,677</u>
Total general fund	<u>\$ 23,142,428</u>	<u>\$ 30,022,486</u>	<u>\$ 35,335,153</u>	<u>\$ 35,909,303</u>	<u>\$ 29,330,658</u>	<u>\$ 28,808,313</u>	<u>\$ 27,152,147</u>	<u>\$ 23,067,738</u>	<u>\$ 19,488,175</u>	<u>\$ 15,853,898</u>
All other governmental funds:										
Nonspendable	\$ -	\$ 3,199,512	\$ -	\$ -	\$ 5,750	\$ -	\$ 346,031	\$ 329,530	\$ 2,191,099	\$ 1,808,567
Restricted	15,082,699	13,106,942	15,167,050	14,679,032	24,304,893	37,596,763	17,334,405	21,170,375	16,412,612	23,879,901
Committed	3,349,272	3,603,881	3,689,448	2,799,149	3,174,106	756,559	1,133,233	1,036,282	710,508	492,114
Assigned	649,833	386,272	277,269	161,850	5,034	-	-	-	-	-
Unassigned	<u>-</u>	<u>(2,945,986)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(12,645)</u>	<u>(25)</u>	<u>(636)</u>	<u>(54,268)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total all other governmental funds	<u>\$ 19,081,804</u>	<u>\$ 17,350,621</u>	<u>\$ 19,133,767</u>	<u>\$ 17,627,386</u>	<u>\$ 27,489,758</u>	<u>\$ 38,352,686</u>	<u>\$ 18,759,401</u>	<u>\$ 22,536,187</u>	<u>\$ 19,314,219</u>	<u>\$ 26,180,582</u>

Note: This schedule reports using the modified accrual basis of accounting.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES, GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

	<u>2025</u>	<u>2024</u>	<u>2023</u>	<u>2022</u>
REVENUES				
Taxes	\$ 83,448,454	\$ 78,306,893	\$ 79,470,149	\$ 79,302,917
Licenses and permits	1,059,003	936,067	1,440,291	862,365
Intergovernmental revenues	11,525,529	11,987,342	17,183,099	9,863,245
Charges for services	6,261,869	5,435,446	6,481,913	5,031,675
Fines, forfeitures and penalties	1,465,984	1,710,603	1,466,647	1,659,930
Investment earnings	805,205	1,772,841	1,909,327	284,124
Contributions and donations	170,359	476,378	27,862	33,570
Miscellaneous	2,559,363	1,982,923	1,754,787	1,815,631
Total revenues	<u>107,295,766</u>	<u>102,608,493</u>	<u>109,734,075</u>	<u>98,853,457</u>
EXPENDITURES				
Current -				
General government	12,782,554	11,948,125	11,481,643	10,476,588
Judicial	9,747,988	9,322,377	8,764,985	8,610,550
Public safety	46,051,940	41,098,843	39,565,527	35,610,118
Public works	9,880,223	10,826,978	8,334,502	7,988,436
Health and welfare	1,240,866	645,988	1,064,844	660,776
Culture and recreation	4,359,710	3,176,047	2,746,594	1,715,927
Housing and development	4,002,628	3,966,437	3,848,655	3,253,426
Capital outlay	20,428,952	12,134,729	13,829,829	20,019,520
Intergovernmental	8,982,950	8,481,476	8,354,907	8,887,007
Debt service				
Principal retirement	6,886,580	7,380,823	7,303,822	7,150,941
Interest and fiscal charges	91,926	90,957	166,236	242,298
Total expenditures	<u>124,456,317</u>	<u>109,072,780</u>	<u>105,461,544</u>	<u>104,615,587</u>
Excess (deficiency) of revenues over expenditures	<u>(17,160,551)</u>	<u>(6,464,287)</u>	<u>4,272,531</u>	<u>(5,762,130)</u>
OTHER FINANCING SOURCES (USES)				
Sale of capital assets	177,704	165,723	48,907	2,738,095
Proceeds from contract payable	-	-	-	-
Debt service-principal	-	-	-	-
Loans issued	-	-	-	-
Transfers in	5,835,453	4,583,036	4,439,509	4,452,042
Transfers out	(4,585,453)	(4,583,036)	(4,439,509)	(4,711,734)
Issuance of short-term debt	6,000,000	-	-	-
Issuance of notes payable	2,784,275	-	-	-
Issuance of subscriptions payable	1,432,899	-	153,729	-
Total other financing sources (uses)	<u>11,644,878</u>	<u>165,723</u>	<u>202,636</u>	<u>2,478,403</u>
Net change in fund balances	<u>\$ (5,515,673)</u>	<u>\$ (6,298,564)</u>	<u>\$ 4,475,167</u>	<u>\$ (3,283,727)</u>
Debt service as a percentage of noncapital expenditures	6.54%	7.40%	7.72%	8.38%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES, GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
LAST TEN YEARS

2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
\$ 72,868,278	\$ 57,309,435	\$ 59,164,252	\$ 65,404,921	\$ 63,333,501	\$ 58,564,076
910,965	526,571	560,668	616,922	557,925	436,518
8,365,957	9,807,590	5,515,071	4,932,147	6,287,273	4,717,912
5,372,739	5,141,580	5,493,125	5,297,091	4,792,305	4,735,662
1,204,303	1,173,584	1,356,867	1,510,315	1,988,743	1,859,148
17,341	141,754	386,272	304,338	154,055	142,584
34,475	115,984	78,800	10,758	125,665	192,400
1,452,378	1,377,695	1,307,950	1,193,376	1,097,834	980,016
90,226,436	75,594,193	73,863,005	79,269,868	78,337,301	71,628,316
9,427,655	8,978,357	8,648,900	8,213,542	7,923,960	7,614,471
7,581,261	7,282,472	7,081,220	6,893,666	6,739,930	6,360,274
33,219,604	30,467,387	28,165,902	26,034,268	25,197,530	23,650,687
7,801,794	6,753,012	7,379,739	6,940,552	7,114,105	5,466,017
582,415	541,984	538,984	538,984	572,134	549,044
1,377,143	1,449,851	1,351,865	1,332,659	1,327,158	1,283,623
2,631,588	3,709,746	3,823,622	2,755,086	3,093,880	2,570,046
30,787,095	16,239,471	5,589,860	8,004,753	11,654,041	18,110,292
-	668,130	3,863,467	7,807,862	10,140,514	10,204,929
7,445,602	1,816,488	6,808,983	6,967,691	8,030,794	7,985,100
318,286	522,205	345,034	475,610	513,333	658,727
101,172,443	78,429,103	73,597,576	75,964,673	82,307,379	84,453,210
(10,946,007)	(2,834,910)	265,429	3,305,195	(3,970,078)	(12,824,894)
123,142	31,464	104,083	38,490	843,221	47,711
-	26,500,000	-	-	-	-
-	(2,700,000)	-	-	-	-
-	296,528	172,494	3,655,731	-	-
4,936,747	8,880,727	1,692,648	2,750,617	3,569,036	3,492,573
(4,454,465)	(8,924,358)	(1,927,031)	(2,948,502)	(3,674,265)	(3,571,701)
-	-	-	-	-	-
-	-	-	-	-	-
-	-	-	-	-	-
605,424	24,084,361	42,194	3,496,336	737,992	(31,417)
\$ (10,340,583)	\$ 21,249,451	\$ 307,623	\$ 6,801,531	\$ (3,232,086)	\$ (12,856,311)
9.68%	3.51%	10.19%	10.61%	12.01%	12.81%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
ASSESSED AND ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE OF TAXABLE PROPERTY
TEN YEAR SUMMARY
December 31, 2025

CALENDAR YEAR	REAL PROPERTY	PERSONAL PROPERTY	PUBLIC UTILITIES	LESS TAX-EXEMPT PROPERTY
2016	\$ 2,128,163,776	\$ 1,011,402,852	\$ 74,391,237	\$ (896,054,401)
2017	\$ 2,255,189,012	\$ 1,056,032,717	\$ 72,768,592	\$ (887,587,000)
2018	\$ 2,256,931,862	\$ 1,112,036,982	\$ 72,404,907	\$ (912,374,586)
2019	\$ 2,306,803,979	\$ 1,165,073,140	\$ 74,358,989	\$ (967,023,121)
2020	\$ 2,332,359,233	\$ 1,179,972,215	\$ 75,874,332	\$ (1,654,832,810)
2021	\$ 2,474,534,343	\$ 1,160,639,757	\$ 79,784,151	\$ (1,550,717,725)
2022	\$ 2,419,794,915	\$ 1,248,839,165	\$ 83,244,379	\$ (1,084,063,231)
2023	\$ 3,063,435,404	\$ 1,434,692,401	\$ 74,807,238	\$ (1,214,207,428)
2024	\$ 3,341,397,001	\$ 1,443,110,379	\$ 86,643,918	\$ (1,424,208,812)
2025	\$ 4,604,655,704	\$ 1,443,417,003	\$ 83,123,677	\$ (1,683,244,280)

NOTES:

1. Real property includes commercial and residential property.
2. All property is assessed at 40% of the estimated actual value.
3. Tax rate is per \$1,000 of assessed value

TOTAL		ASSESSED TO TOTAL ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE	TOTAL DIRECT TAX RATE
ASSESSED VALUE	ESTIMATED ACTUAL VALUE		
\$ 2,317,903,464	\$ 5,794,758,660	40%	9.561
\$ 2,496,403,321	\$ 6,241,008,303	40%	9.329
\$ 2,528,999,165	\$ 6,322,497,913	40%	9.312
\$ 2,579,212,987	\$ 6,448,032,468	40%	8.812
\$ 1,933,372,970	\$ 4,833,432,425	40%	8.312
\$ 2,164,240,526	\$ 5,410,601,315	40%	7.312
\$ 2,667,815,228	\$ 6,669,538,070	40%	7.300
\$ 3,358,727,615	\$ 8,396,819,038	40%	6.000
\$ 3,446,942,486	\$ 8,617,356,215	40%	5.556
\$ 4,447,952,104	\$ 11,119,880,260	40%	4.600

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
PROPERTY TAX RATES - ALL OVERLAPPING GOVERNMENTS
TEN YEAR SUMMARY
December 31, 2025

CALENDAR YEAR	COUNTY RATES					COUNTY SCHOOLS	CITY OF DALTON	DALTON SCHOOLS	CITY OF VARNELL	DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY OF DALTON	STATE OF GEORGIA	TOTAL OVERLAPPING
	MAINTENANCE AND OPERATING	SPECIAL FIRE DISTRICT	SOLID WASTE	JOINT DEVELOPMENT	TOTAL COUNTY							
2016	9.561	1.283	0.341	0.376	11.561	18.756	2.506	8.200	2.404	0.950	0.000	44.377
2017	9.329	2.755	0.286	0.397	12.767	18.756	2.506	8.200	2.404	0.950	0.000	45.583
2018	9.312	2.755	0.286	0.397	12.750	18.756	2.505	8.770	2.404	2.500	0.000	47.685
2019	8.812	2.755	0.286	0.397	12.250	18.756	2.482	8.770	2.352	2.500	0.000	47.110
2020	8.312	2.755	0.286	0.397	11.750	18.756	2.237	8.770	2.346	2.500	0.000	46.359
2021	7.312	2.755	0.286	0.397	10.750	18.756	2.208	8.665	2.335	2.500	0.000	45.214
2022	7.300	2.755	0.286	0.397	10.738	18.756	2.207	8.650	2.326	1.500	0.000	44.177
2023	6.000	2.755	0.286	0.000	9.041	18.500	1.936	8.460	1.895	0.990	0.000	40.822
2024 (temp)	5.556	2.755	0.286	0.000	8.597	18.756	1.841	9.420	1.736	0.990	0.000	41.340
2024 (final)	4.300	2.755	0.286	0.000	7.341	15.000	1.572	8.350	1.377	0.990	0.000	34.630
2025	4.600	2.755	0.286	0.000	7.641	14.375	1.493	7.824	1.328	0.990	0.000	33.651

Notes:

1. Tax rates are shown in dollars per \$1,000 of assessed value.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

PRINCIPAL TAXPAYERS

December 31, 2025

2025			2016		
TAXPAYER	TAXABLE ASSESSED VALUATION	PERCENT OF TOTAL ASSESSED VALUATION	TAXPAYER	TAXES LEVIED	PERCENT OF TOTAL ASSESSED VALUATION
SHAW INDUSTRIES	\$ 948,868,768	21.33%	SHAW INDUSTRIES	\$ 7,238,535	31.93%
MOHAWK INDUSTRIES/WORLD CARPETS	584,512,801	13.14%	MOHAWK INDUSTRIES	2,706,875	12.94%
ENGINEERED FLOORS/PENTZ STREET HOLDINGS	466,597,270	10.49%	ENGINEERED FLOORS	2,454,732	10.82%
TARKETT USA	115,915,110	2.61%	BEAULIEU GROUP	1,414,322	7.69%
NORTH GEORGIA EMC	78,070,044	1.76%	J & J INDUSTRIES	988,825	3.35%
QTS PROCUREMENT LLC	69,380,508	1.56%	TANDUS FLOORING	954,124	3.77%
SYNTHETIC TURF RESOURCES	66,453,321	1.49%	NORTH GEORGIA EMC	662,747	2.32%
CORE SCIENTIFIC, INC.	64,921,596	1.46%	NORFOLK SOUTHERN	559,918	1.91%
GEORGIA POWER COMPANY	58,740,447	1.32%	WINDSTREAM GEORGIA	494,472	1.57%
SOUTHWIND BUILDING PRODUCTS	37,478,883	0.84%	LEXMARK CARPET MILLS	452,944	1.55%

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
PROPERTY TAX LEVIES AND COLLECTIONS
TEN YEAR SUMMARY
December 31, 2025

DIGEST YEAR	TAXES LEVIED	REFUNDS ADJUSTMENTS	TOTAL ADJUSTED LEVY	COLLECTED WITHIN THE YEAR OF THE LEVY		COLLECTIONS IN SUBSEQUENT YEARS	TOTAL COLLECTIONS TO DATE	
				AMOUNT	PERCENTAGE OF ORIGINAL LEVY		AMOUNT	PERCENTAGE OF ADJUSTED LEVY
2016	\$ 25,089,495	\$ 218,166	\$ 25,307,661	\$ 23,059,586	91.91%	\$ 2,238,025	\$ 25,297,611	99.96%
2017	\$ 28,953,450	\$ (448,366)	\$ 28,505,084	\$ 27,056,626	93.45%	\$ 1,445,897	\$ 28,502,523	99.99%
2018	\$ 29,263,039	\$ (456,714)	\$ 28,806,325	\$ 27,388,243	93.59%	\$ 1,396,082	\$ 28,784,325	99.92%
2019	\$ 28,571,237	\$ (316,508)	\$ 28,254,729	\$ 26,646,024	93.26%	\$ 1,527,426	\$ 28,173,450	99.71%
2020	\$ 27,250,769	\$ (369,260)	\$ 26,881,509	\$ 25,432,446	93.33%	\$ 1,281,396	\$ 26,713,842	99.38%
2021	\$ 25,028,113	\$ 199,438	\$ 25,227,551	\$ 23,636,659	94.44%	\$ 1,588,646	\$ 25,225,305	99.99%
2022	\$ 25,550,231	\$ 114,695	\$ 25,664,926	\$ 23,233,524	90.93%	\$ 2,163,234	\$ 25,396,758	98.96%
2023	\$ 24,830,695	\$ (166,355)	\$ 24,664,340	\$ 1,227,181	4.94%	\$ 23,393,107	\$ 24,620,288	99.82%
2024	* \$ 25,701,932	\$ 2,012,247	\$ 27,714,179	\$ 8,582,744	33.39%	\$ 19,145,934	\$ 27,728,678	100.05%
2025	\$ 28,408,788	\$ (177,127)	\$ 28,231,661	\$ 8,343,185	29.37%	\$ 18,817,147	\$ 27,160,332	96.21%

*Temporary 2024 tax digest based on 10% estimated increase over 2023 final certified tax digest.

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
TAX REVENUES BY SOURCE - GOVERNMENTAL FUNDS
TEN YEAR SUMMARY
DECEMBER 31, 2025**

CALENDAR YEAR	PROPERTY	LOCAL OPTION SALES	SPECIAL PURPOSE LOCAL OPTION SALES	INSURANCE PREMIUM	ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGE	REAL ESTATE TRANSFER	OTHER	TOTAL
2016	28,074,028	9,848,729	15,675,429	3,700,351	397,186	88,347	780,006	58,564,076
2017	32,409,272	9,896,272	15,784,126	3,962,650	404,559	105,913	770,709	63,333,501
2018	32,382,872	10,561,298	16,819,439	4,272,930	407,996	140,684	819,702	65,404,921
2019	33,011,018	11,159,405	9,038,110	4,560,447	408,301	121,637	865,334	59,164,252
2020	33,466,092	12,153,696	6,132,305	4,838,448	439,003	137,324	712,866	57,879,734
2021	31,713,738	12,933,171	21,358,294	5,022,222	427,652	192,197	799,289	72,446,563
2022	34,415,709	14,504,025	24,067,556	4,888,585	422,523	227,907	776,612	79,302,917
2023	31,848,423	15,468,337	25,547,638	5,295,852	401,523	125,518	782,858	79,470,149
2024	30,693,584	15,337,026	25,348,966	5,632,927	400,551	186,365	707,452	78,306,871
2025	34,623,109	15,596,549	25,783,438	6,315,139	388,230	171,200	570,784	83,448,449
Percentage Change In Dollars Over 10 Years	<u>23.3%</u>	<u>58.4%</u>	<u>64.5%</u>	<u>70.7%</u>	<u>-2.3%</u>	<u>93.8%</u>	<u>-26.8%</u>	<u>42.5%</u>

Note:

Other: Includes financial institution business taxes, franchise taxes, hotel/motel taxes and fireworks excise taxes.

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RATIO OF OUTSTANDING DEBT BY TYPE
LAST TEN YEARS**

GOVERNMENTAL ACTIVITIES								
CALENDAR YEAR	REVENUE BONDS	INTER- GOVERNMENTAL LIABILITY	CAPITAL LEASES	SUBSCRIPTIONS PAYABLE	NOTES PAYABLE	TOTAL PRIMARY GOVERNMENT	PERCENT OF PERSONAL INCOME	PER CAPITA
2016	11,344,000	13,948,206	110,713	-	284,880	25,687,799	0.74%	246
2017	8,111,000	9,341,558	14,577	-	189,920	17,657,055	0.47%	169
2018	5,903,000	7,655,887	413,624	-	127,584	14,100,095	0.36%	135
2019	4,252,000	2,700,000	295,661	-	205,118	7,452,779	0.18%	69
2020	2,987,000	26,500,000	-	-	501,646	29,988,646	0.72%	287
2021	2,128,000	19,962,000	-	-	453,046	22,543,046	0.50%	219
2022	1,619,000	13,369,000	-	-	404,105	15,392,105	0.32%	149
2023	1,095,000	6,715,000	-	77,192	354,820	8,164,820	0.16%	79
2024	556,000	-	-	-	305,190	861,190	0.02%	8
2025	-	-	-	1,152,298	3,039,483	4,191,781	0.08%	39

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
RATIO OF NET GENERAL BONDED DEBT TO
ASSESSED VALUE AND NET BONDED DEBT PER CAPITA
TEN YEAR SUMMARY
December 31, 2025

CALENDAR YEAR	POPULATION	ASSESSED VALUE	GROSS BONDED DEBT	DEBT SERVICE AVAILABLE	NET BONDED DEBT	RATIO OF NET BONDED DEBT TO ASSESSED VALUE	NET BONDED DEBT PER CAPITA
2016	104,589	2,317,903,464	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2017	104,658	2,496,403,321	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2018	104,062	2,528,999,165	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2019	104,628	2,579,212,987	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2020	102,864	1,933,372,970	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2021	102,848	2,164,240,526	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2022	103,132	2,667,815,228	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2023	103,687	3,358,727,615	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2024	105,070	3,446,942,486	-	-	-	0.00%	-
2025	106,212	4,447,952,104	-	-	-	0.00%	-

Note:

Gross bonded debt includes all long-term general obligation bonds.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DIRECT AND OVERLAPPING GOVERNMENTAL ACTIVITIES DEBT
AS OF DECEMBER 31, 2025

<u>Governmental Unit</u>	<u>Debt Outstanding</u>	<u>Estimated Percentage Applicable</u>	<u>Estimated Share of Overlapping Debt</u>
Overlapping Debt			
City of Dalton Board of Education (1)	\$ 9,920,000	100%	\$ 9,920,000
Whitfield County Board of Education	-	100%	-
City of Dalton (1)	15,775,000	100%	15,775,000
City of Varnell (2)	82,278	100%	82,278
Total Overlapping Debt			<u>25,777,278</u>
County Direct Debt			
Whitfield County	\$ -	100%	<u>-</u>
Total County Direct Debt			<u>-</u>
Total Direct and Overlapping Debt			<u><u>\$ 25,777,278</u></u>

Sources:

- (1) Data provided by City of Dalton Finance Office
- (2) Data provided by City of Varnell City Manager

Note: Overlapping governments are those that coincide, at least in part, with the geographic boundaries of the County. This schedule estimates the portion of the outstanding debt of those overlapping governments that is borne by the residents and businesses of Whitfield County. Applicable percentages were estimated by determining the portion of another government unit's assessed value that is within the County's boundaries and dividing it by each unit's total assessed value. Entities are situated entirely within the geographic boundaries of the County.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA

LEGAL DEBT MARGIN INFORMATION

LAST TEN YEARS

	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
Debt limit	\$ 613,119,638	\$ 487,115,130	\$ 457,293,504	\$ 375,187,846	\$ 369,799,832	\$ 374,214,346	\$ 362,059,510	\$ 360,998,985	\$ 357,122,803	\$ 342,787,384
Total net debt applicable to limit	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Legal debt margin	<u>\$ 613,119,638</u>	<u>\$ 487,115,130</u>	<u>\$ 457,293,504</u>	<u>\$ 375,187,846</u>	<u>\$ 369,799,832</u>	<u>\$ 374,214,346</u>	<u>\$ 362,059,510</u>	<u>\$ 360,998,985</u>	<u>\$ 357,122,803</u>	<u>\$ 342,787,384</u>
Total net debt applicable to the limit as a percentage of debt limit	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%

Legal debt margin calculation for 2025

Assessed value of taxable property	\$ 4,447,952,104
Add: exempt real property	<u>1,683,244,280</u>
Total assessed value of taxable property	6,131,196,384
Debt limit (10%) of total assessed value	613,119,638
Debt applicable to limit	<u>-</u>
Legal debt margin	<u>\$ 613,119,638</u>



**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
DEMOGRAPHIC STATISTICS
TEN YEAR SUMMARY
December 31, 2025**

CALENDAR YEAR	POPULATION	PERSONAL INCOME	PER CAPITA INCOME	UNEMPLOYMENT RATE
2016	104,589	3,484,591,713	33,317	5.7%
2017	104,658	3,774,804,744	36,068	5.5%
2018	104,062	3,886,819,762	37,351	4.4%
2019	104,628	4,054,544,256	38,752	4.4%
2020	102,864	4,177,431,000	39,927	7.3%
2021	102,848	4,889,878,000	46,950	3.9%
2022	103,132	4,770,680,056	46,258	3.8%
2023	103,687	4,972,310,085	47,955	3.3%
2024	105,070	5,222,609,420	49,706	4.2%
2025	106,212	5,279,373,672	49,706	4.2%

Population source: United States Census Bureau (www.census.gov/quickfacts/)

Per Capita Income source: Bureau of Economic Analysis (apps.bea.gov/regional/bearfacts/)

Unemployment Rate source: Georgia Labor Market Explorer (www.explorer.gdol.ga.gov/ga_unemployment_rate/)

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
PRINCIPAL EMPLOYERS
December 31, 2025

2025			2016		
EMPLOYER	EMPLOYEES	PERCENT OF TOTAL EMPLOYMENT	EMPLOYER	EMPLOYEES	PERCENT OF TOTAL EMPLOYMENT
Shaw Industries, Inc.	6,133	13.49%	Shaw Industries, Inc.	7,517	16.24%
Mohawk Industries	4,172	9.18%	Mohawk Industries	6,015	12.99%
Engineered Floors	3,600	7.92%	Beaulieu Group, LLC	2,056	4.44%
Whitfield County Schools	1,899	4.18%	Whitfield County Schools	1,500	3.24%
Q cells	1,800	3.96%	Hamilton Medical Center	1,059	2.29%
Hamilton Medical Center	1,763	3.88%	Dalton Public Schools	800	1.73%
Tarkett	1,182	2.60%	Engineered Floors	750	1.62%
Dalton Public Schools	1,052	2.31%	Shiroki North America, Inc.	705	1.52%
Whitfield County	730	1.61%	J&J Flooring Group	665	1.44%
City of Dalton (incl Utilities)	692	1.52%	Whitfield County	551	1.19%

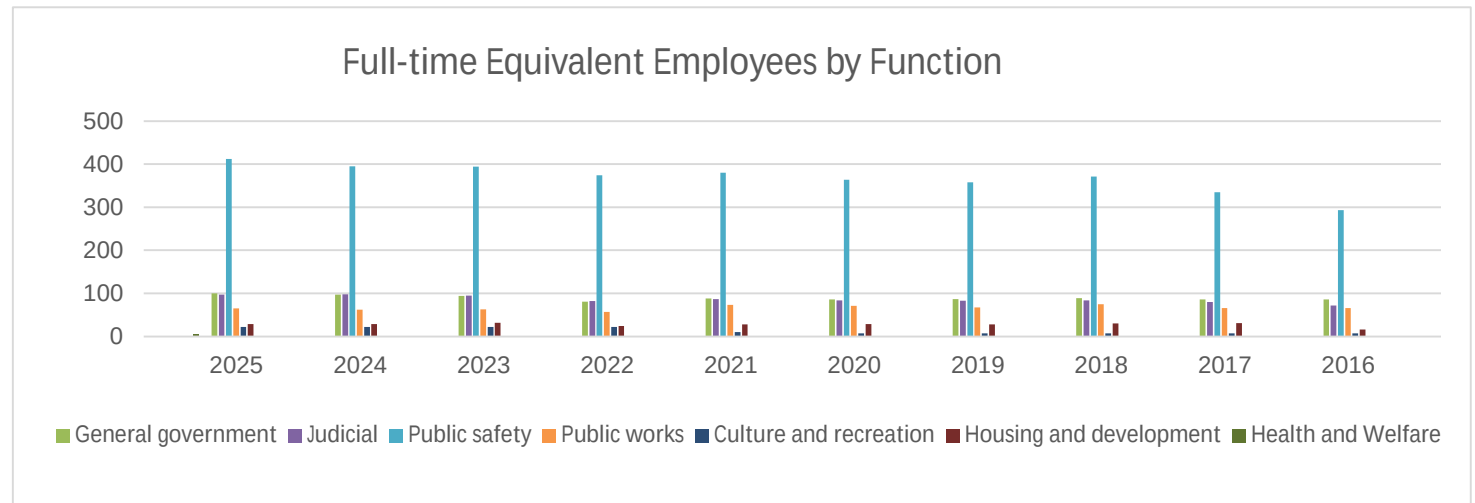
Source:

<https://locationdalton.com/regional-data/major-employers>

<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/LAUCN133130000000005>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
FULL-TIME EQUIVALENT WHITFIELD COUNTY EMPLOYEES BY FUNCTION
December 31, 2025

Function/Program	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
General government	100	97	94	81	88	86	87	89	86	86
Judicial	97	98	95	82	87	84	83	84	80	72
Public safety	412	395	394	374	380	364	358	371	335	293
Public works	65	62	63	57	73	71	67	75	66	66
Health and Welfare	5	5	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Culture and recreation	22	22	22	22	10	7	7	7	7	7
Housing and development	29	29	32	24	28	29	28	30	31	16
Total	730	708	705	640	666	641	630	656	605	504



WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA OPERATING INDICATORS BY FUNCTION

Function/Program	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
General government										
Vehicle tags issued (in dollars)	270,071	175,107	174,885	168,726	157,457	155,540	162,605	N/A	107,475	106,856
Public safety										
E-911 calls	218,307	217,617	239,205	227,539	238,079	230,750	227,498	185,955	178,449	N/A
Fire service calls	6,428	6,659	6,743	9,878	8,856	7,600	6,613	5,357	5,677	6,031
Fire average response time (minutes)	6.1	5.6	5.5	5.5	5.5	6.4	6.2	6.1	5.9	6.2
EMS service calls	15,909	16,406	16,354	16,935	17,490	16,347	16,600	16,655	15,069	13,421
EMS average response time (minutes)	9.7	9.5	9.3	9.6	10.1	9.5	9.4	10.0	9.8	8.6
Public works										
Miles of road resurfacing	34.2	31.0	25.0	28.0	22.0	4.8	18.5	23.4	27.4	27.0
Culture and recreation										
Number of program participants	3,514	3,718	4,236	3,804	3,601	2,300	3,692	4,033	4,054	3,944
Housing and development										
Building permits issued	3,229	2,266	3,263	3,050	3,287	2,621	622	665	508	517

**WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
CAPITAL ASSET STATISTICS BY FUNCTION**

Function/Program	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016
General government										
County facilities	25	24	23	21	21	21	21	21	21	21
Public safety										
Fire stations	12	12	12	12	12	12	12	11	10	10
Public works										
Miles of roads	725.13	724	724	724	711	711	664	664	711	718
Culture and recreation										
County owned ball fields	25	25	24	23	18	18	19	20	20	20

Part IV

Other Reporting Section



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SINGLE AUDIT SECTION

This section contains reports required by the Uniform Guidance and grantor agencies.

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**Independent Auditor's Report on Internal Control over Financial Reporting and on
Compliance and Other Matters Based on an Audit of Financial Statements
Performed In Accordance with Government Auditing Standards**

Honorable Chairman and Members
of the Board of Commissioners
Whitfield County, Georgia

We have audited, in accordance with the auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America and the standards applicable to financial audits contained in *Government Auditing Standards*, issued by the Comptroller General of the United States, the financial statements of the governmental activities, the business-type activities, the discretely presented component unit, each major fund, and the aggregate remaining fund information of Whitfield County, Georgia, as of and for the year ended December 31, 2025, and the related notes to the financial statements, which collectively comprise Whitfield County, Georgia's basic financial statements and have issued our report thereon dated June 26, 2026. Our report includes a reference to other auditors who audited the financial statements of Whitfield County Health Department, as described in our report on Whitfield County, Georgia's financial statements. This report does not include the results of the other auditors' testing of internal control over financial reporting or compliance and other matters that were reported on separately by those auditors.

Report on Internal Control over Financial Reporting

In planning and performing our audit of the financial statements, we considered Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over financial reporting (internal control) as a basis for designing audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances for the purpose of expressing our opinions on the financial statements, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control. Accordingly, we do not express an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control.

Our consideration of internal control was for the limited purpose described in the preceding paragraph and was not designed to identify all deficiencies in internal control that might be material weaknesses or significant deficiencies and therefore, material weaknesses or significant deficiencies may exist that were not identified. However, as described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs, we identified certain deficiencies in internal control that we consider to be material weaknesses and significant deficiencies.

A *deficiency in internal control* exists when the design or operation of a control does not allow management or employees, in the normal course of performing their assigned functions, to prevent, or detect and correct, misstatements on a timely basis. A *material weakness* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control, such that there is a reasonable possibility that a material misstatement of the entity's financial statements will not be prevented, or detected and corrected on a timely basis. We consider the deficiency described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs as item 2025-001 to be a material weakness.

A *significant deficiency* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control that is less severe than a material weakness, yet important enough to merit attention by those charged with governance. We identified certain deficiencies in internal control, described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs as items 2025-002 through 2025-003 that we consider to be significant deficiencies.

Report on Compliance and Other Matters

As part of obtaining reasonable assurance about whether Whitfield County, Georgia's financial statements are free of material misstatement, we performed tests of its compliance with certain provisions of laws, regulations, contracts, and grants agreements, noncompliance with which could have a direct and material effect on the determination of financial statement amounts. However, providing an opinion on compliance with those provisions was not an objective of our audit, and accordingly, we do not express such an opinion. The results of our tests disclosed no instances of noncompliance or other matters that are required to be reported under *Government Auditing Standards*.

Whitfield County, Georgia's Response to Findings

Government Auditing Standards requires the auditor to perform limited procedures on Whitfield County, Georgia's response to the findings identified in our audit and described in the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs. Whitfield County, Georgia's response was not subjected to the other auditing procedures applied in the audit of the financial statements and, accordingly, we express no opinion the response.

Purpose of This Report

The purpose of this report is solely to describe the scope of our testing of internal control and compliance and the results of that testing, and not to provide an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control or on compliance. This report is an integral part of an audit performed in accordance with *Government Auditing Standards* in considering the entity's internal control and compliance. Accordingly, this communication is not suitable for any other purpose.

Rushton, LLC

Gainesville, Georgia
June 26, 2026

**Independent Auditor's Report on Compliance for Each Major Program and on
Internal Control over Compliance Required by the Uniform Guidance**

Honorable Chairman and Members
of the Board of Commissioners
Whitfield County, Georgia

Report on Compliance for Each Major Federal Program

Opinion on Each Major Federal Program

We have audited Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the types of compliance requirements identified as subject to audit in the *OMB Compliance Supplement* that could have a direct and material effect on each of Whitfield County, Georgia's major federal programs for the year ended December 31, 2025. Whitfield County, Georgia's major federal programs are identified in the summary of auditor's results section of the accompanying schedule of findings and questioned costs.

In our opinion, Whitfield County, Georgia complied, in all material respects, with the types of compliance requirements referred to above that could have a direct and material effect on each of its major federal programs for the fiscal year ended December 31, 2025.

Basis for Opinion on Each Major Federal Program

We conducted our audit of compliance in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America; the standards applicable to financial audits contained in *Government Auditing Standards*, issued by the Comptroller General of the United States; and the audit requirements of Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards* (Uniform Guidance). Our responsibilities under those standards and the Uniform Guidance are further described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of Compliance section of our report.

We are required to be independent of Whitfield County, Georgia and to meet our other ethical responsibilities, in accordance with relevant ethical requirements relating to our audit. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion on compliance for each major federal program. Our audit does not provide a legal determination of Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the compliance requirements referred to above.

Responsibilities of Management for Compliance

Management is responsible for compliance with the requirements referred to above and for the design, implementation, and maintenance of effective internal control over compliance with the requirements of laws, statutes, regulations, rules, and provisions of contracts or grant agreements applicable to Whitfield County, Georgia's federal programs.

Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of Compliance

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether material noncompliance with the compliance requirements referred to above occurred, whether due to fraud or error, and express an opinion on Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance based on our audit. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance but is not absolute assurance and therefore is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards, *Government Auditing Standards*, and the Uniform Guidance will always detect material noncompliance when it exists. The risk of not detecting material noncompliance resulting from fraud is higher than for that resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control. Noncompliance with the compliance requirements referred to above is considered material if there is a substantial likelihood that, individually or in the aggregate, it would influence the judgment made by a reasonable user of the report on compliance about Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the requirements of each major federal program as a whole.

In performing an audit in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards, *Government Auditing Standards*, and the Uniform Guidance, we:

- Exercise professional judgment and maintain professional skepticism throughout the audit.
- Identify and assess the risks of material noncompliance, whether due to fraud or error, and design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks. Such procedures include examining, on a test basis, evidence regarding Whitfield County, Georgia's compliance with the compliance requirements referred to above and performing such other procedures as we considered necessary in the circumstances.
- Obtain an understanding of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over compliance relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances and to test and report on internal control over compliance in accordance with the Uniform Guidance, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of Whitfield County, Georgia's internal control over compliance. Accordingly, no such opinion is expressed.

We are required to communicate with those charged with governance regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and any significant deficiencies and material weaknesses in internal control over compliance that we identified during the audit.

Report on Internal Control over Compliance

A deficiency in internal control over compliance exists when the design or operation of a control over compliance does not allow management or employees, in the normal course of performing their assigned functions, to prevent, or detect and correct, noncompliance with a type of compliance requirement of a federal program on a timely basis. *A material weakness in internal control over compliance* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control over compliance, such that there is a reasonable possibility that material noncompliance with a type of compliance requirement of a federal program will not be prevented, or detected and corrected, on a timely basis. *A significant deficiency in internal control over compliance* is a deficiency, or a combination of deficiencies, in internal control over compliance with a type of compliance requirement of a federal program that is less severe than a material weakness in internal control over compliance, yet important enough to merit attention by those charged with governance.

Our consideration of internal control over compliance was for the limited purpose described in the Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of Compliance section above and was not designed to identify all deficiencies in internal control over compliance that might be material weaknesses or significant deficiencies in internal control over compliance. Given these limitations, during our audit we did not identify any deficiencies in internal control over compliance that we consider to be material weaknesses, as defined above. However, material weaknesses or significant deficiencies in internal control over compliance may exist that were not identified.

Our audit was not designed for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of internal control over compliance. Accordingly, no such opinion is expressed. The purpose of this report on internal control over compliance is solely to describe the scope of our testing of internal control over compliance and the results of that testing based on the requirements of the Uniform Guidance. Accordingly, this report is not suitable for any other purpose.

Rushton, LLC

Gainesville, Georgia
June 26, 2026

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF EXPENDITURES OF FEDERAL AWARDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

Federal Grant/Pass-Through Grantor/Program Title	Federal Assistance Listing Number	Pass- Through Number	Expenditures	Amounts Provided to Subrecipients
Department of Agriculture				
Forest Services Schools and Roads Cluster Passed through the Georgia Office of State Treasurer: Schools and Roads - Grants to States	10.665	486Forest	\$ 3,924	\$ 0
Department of Housing and Urban Development				
Passed through the Georgia Department of Community Affairs: Community Development Block Grants/ State's Program and Non-Entitlement Grants in Hawaii	14.228	21cv-y-155-1-6245	48,934	0
Home Investment Partnerships Program	14.239	2022-115	45,904	0
Total Department of Housing and Urban Development			94,838	0
Department of the Interior				
Payments in Lieu of Taxes	15.226	N/A	32,836	0
Passed through the Georgia Department of Natural Resources: Outdoor Recreation Acquisition, Development, and Planning	15.916	P22AP01133/13-01067	10,442	0
Total Department of the Interior			43,278	0
Department of Justice				
Passed through the Criminal Justice Coordinating Council Delinquency Prevention Program	16.548	L21-8-031	27,197	0
Crime Victim Assistance	16.575	C23-8-249	92,360	0
Violence Against Women Formula Grants	16.588	W23-8-058	69,239	0
Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant Program	16.738	B75-8-005 B75-8-006	53,009 66,450 119,459	0 0 0
State Criminal Alien Assistance Program	16.606	N/A	12,271	0
Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant Program	16.738	N/A	23,732	0
Total Department of Justice			344,258	0
Department of Transportation				
Passed through the Georgia Department of Transportation: Highway Planning and Construction	20.205	PI0020231-PLN PI0019734-PLN PI0021112-PLN PI0020071-PLN PI0020788-PLN	42,204 2,445 51,951 239,200 81,502 417,302	0 0 0 0 0 0
Federal Transit Cluster Federal Transit Formula Grants	20.507	T008488 T008887	171,567 471,139	0 0
Total Federal Transit Cluster			642,706	0
Total Department of Transportation			1,060,008	0

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF EXPENDITURES OF FEDERAL AWARDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

Federal Grant/Pass-Through Grantor/Program Title	Federal Assistance Listing Number	Pass- Through Number	Expenditures	Amounts Provided to Subrecipients
Department of the Treasury				
COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	21.027	N/A	\$ 1,576,183	\$ 0
Passed through the Georgia Governor's Office of Planning and Budget: COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	21.027	GA-0013725 GA-0013697 GA-0013857	921,345 446,725 356,776 <u>1,724,846</u>	0 0 0 <u>0</u>
Passed through the Judicial Council of Georgia Administrative Offices of the Courts: COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	21.027	2023 ARPA 3Y046,3Y002	84,138	0
Total Department of the Treasury			<u>3,385,167</u>	<u>0</u>
Appalachian Regional Commission				
Appalachian Area Development	23.002	CH2023-G037 CC-22134-LGV-25	19,628 10,970	0 0
Total Appalachian Regional Commission			<u>30,598</u>	<u>0</u>
Executive Office of the President				
High Intensity Drug Trafficking Areas Program	95.001	N/A	3,694	0
Department of Homeland Security				
Passed through the Georgia Emergency Management Agency: Hazard Mitigation Grant	97.039	HMGP-4579-0001	2,000	0
Emergency Management Performance Grants	97.042	OEM22-157	30,780	0
Homeland Security Grant Program	97.067	EMW-2022-SS-00048	14,453	0
State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program Tribal Cybersecurity Grant Program	97.137	2022-SLCGP-GA	57,704	0
Total Department of Homeland Security			<u>104,937</u>	<u>0</u>
Total Federal Awards			<u>\$ 5,070,702</u>	<u>\$ 0</u>

See accompanying notes to the schedule of expenditures of federal awards and the schedule of findings and questioned costs.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
NOTES TO THE SCHEDULE OF EXPENDITURES OF FEDERAL AWARDS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

1. Basis of Presentation

The accompanying schedule of expenditures of federal awards (the Schedule) includes the federal award activity of Whitfield County, Georgia, under programs for the federal government for the current year. The information in this schedule is presented in accordance with the requirements of Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards* (Uniform Guidance). Because this schedule presents only a selected portion of the operations of the County, it is not intended to and does not present the financial position, changes in net position or cash flows of the County.

2. Summary of Significant Accounting Policies

Expenditures reported on the Schedule are reported on the accrual basis of accounting. Such expenditures are recognized following the cost principles contained in Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards*, wherein certain types of expenditures are not allowable or are limited as to reimbursement.

3. De Minimis Indirect Cost Rate

Whitfield County, Georgia has elected not to use the 15-percent *de minimis* indirect cost rate allowed under the Uniform Guidance.

4. Payments to Subrecipients

For the current year, Whitfield County, Georgia did not pass federal funds through to subrecipients.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

1. Summary of the Auditor's Results

A. Financial Statements

Type of auditor's report issued:	Unmodified
Internal control over financial reporting:	
Material weakness(es) identified?	Yes
Significant deficiencies identified not considered material weaknesses?	Yes
Noncompliance material to financial statements noted?	None reported

B. Federal Awards

Internal control over major programs:	
Material weakness(es) identified?	None reported
Significant deficiencies identified not considered material weaknesses?	None reported
Type of auditor's report issued on compliance for major programs:	Unmodified
Any audit findings disclosed that are required to be reported in accordance with the Uniform Guidance?	None reported
Identification of major programs:	
21.027 COVID-19 Coronavirus State and Local Fiscal Recovery Funds	
Dollar threshold used to distinguish Between Type A and Type B programs:	\$1,000,000
Auditee qualified as low-risk auditee?	No

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

2. Financial Statement Findings and Responses

2025-001

Criteria: Generally accepted accounting principles require balances reported in the financial statements to be properly calculated and recorded. Internal controls should be in place to ensure the County can perform timely and accurate year-end close procedures.

Condition: The prior year financial statements were restated for errors and incorrectly reported amounts in the Governmental Activities and General Fund. A significant portion of these restatements resulted from differences between amounts recorded based on the temporary tax digest in the prior year and the final certified tax digest subsequently issued. These differences were not identified and corrected timely, resulting in material misstatement of balances in the prior period. Material adjustments were required during the audit process.

Cause: Financial statement balances were not accurately calculated due to various miscalculations and posting and classification errors.

Effect: Failure to properly design and implement internal controls over year-end close procedures and to accurately calculate financial statement balances caused financial statements to be materially misstated.

Recommendation: The County should implement procedures to review and reconcile property tax receivable and unavailable property tax revenue balances recorded based on the temporary tax digest to the final certified tax digest once it becomes available, and to adjust financial records timely for any identified differences.

Management Response: Management concurs with this finding. The County will implement formal procedures to ensure that amounts recorded based on the temporary tax digest are reviewed and reconciled to the final certified digest upon issuance. This action was taken immediately upon receipt of the comment from our auditors.

2025-002

Criteria: Segregation of employees' duties is a common practice in an effective internal control structure. Segregation of duties is when specific employee functions related to important accounting areas (such as cash receipting and cash disbursements) are separated among different individuals to significantly reduce the risk that any one individual could intentionally or unintentionally misappropriate assets.

Condition: Appropriate segregation of duties does not exist among recording, distributing, and reconciliation of cash accounts and other operational functions in the various departments throughout the County. This is especially prominent in the Tax Commissioner's Office, the Sheriff's Office, the Magistrate Court, and the Clerk of Superior Court.

Cause: There are constitutional offices of the County that lack adequate segregation of duties.

Effect: Failure to maintain adequate segregation of duties exposes the assets of the County to greater risk of misappropriation.

Recommendation: We recommend that each County office review its policies and procedures to determine where it can adequately segregate duties to alleviate the segregation of duties issues.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

2. Financial Statement Findings and Responses (continued)

2025-002, continued

Management Response: Management acknowledges the segregation of duties limitations noted. Due to staffing and budget constraints, complete segregation of duties is not practical at this time. Management has evaluated the associated risks and determined that the cost of additional personnel or controls outweighs the benefits. Accordingly, management has accepted the residual risk and will continue to monitor operations for opportunities to strengthen controls as resources permit.

2025-003

Criteria: Proper internal controls require that all voided transactions are properly approved.

Condition: During audit procedures at the offices of the Tax Commissioner's Office and the Magistrate Court, we noted no formal approval process for voided transactions.

Cause: Management is not approving voided transactions.

Effect: Failure to maintain proper supporting documentation with evidence of approval for voided transactions subjects the assets of the County to greater risk of misappropriation.

Recommendation: Supporting documentation with evidence of approval of voided transactions should be retained at the offices of the Tax Commissioner's Office and the Magistrate Court.

Management Response: Management has provided a copy of this finding to the appropriate Elected Official and they concur with this finding.

3. Prior Year Audit Findings Follow-Ups

2024-001

Condition: The prior year financial statements were restated for errors and incorrectly reported amounts in the Governmental Activities, 2020 SPLOST Fund, the Whitfield Transit System Fund. The County lacks sufficient controls and procedures regarding year-end close to ensure timely and accurate financial reporting. Material adjustments were required during the audit process.

Not corrected

2024-002

Condition: Appropriate segregation of duties does not exist among recording, distributing, and reconciliation of cash accounts and other operational functions in the various departments throughout the County. This is especially prominent in the Tax Commissioner's Office, the Sheriff's Office, the Magistrate Court, and the Clerk of Superior Court.

Not corrected

2024-003

Condition: During audit procedures at the offices of the Tax Commissioner's Office and the Magistrate Court, we noted no formal approval process for voided transactions.

Not corrected

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF FINDINGS AND QUESTIONED COSTS
For the year ended December 31, 2025

3. Prior Year Audit Findings Follow-Ups (continued)

2024-004

Condition: During audit procedures at the Building Inspections and Enforcements Department, we noted instances where deposits were not made timely. Receipts were held for more than seven days before depositing in 16 of 40 (40%) tested building permit receipts.

Corrected

4. Federal Award Findings and Questioned Costs

The audit of our basic financial statements and schedule of expenditures of federal awards disclosed no audit findings or questioned costs which are required to be reported under Title 2 U.S. Code of Federal Regulations Part 200, *Uniform Administrative Requirements, Cost Principles, and Audit Requirements for Federal Awards*.

STATE REPORTING SECTION

This section contains additional reports required by the State of Georgia.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF PROJECTS FINANCED WITH SPECIAL
PURPOSE LOCAL OPTION SALES TAX
For the year ended December 31, 2025

Project	Estimated Cost *		Expenditures		
	Original	Current	Prior Years	Current Year	Total
<u>2008 SPLOST</u>					
Road Improvements	\$ 36,289,785	\$ 36,289,785	\$ 37,009,388	\$ 266,602	\$ 37,275,990
City of Dalton road projects	11,710,215	13,862,676	13,862,676	0	13,862,676
Total	<u>\$ 48,000,000</u>	<u>\$ 50,152,461</u>	<u>\$ 50,872,064</u>	<u>\$ 266,602</u>	<u>\$ 51,138,666</u>
<u>2015 SPLOST</u>					
County-wide communication project	\$ 8,040,000	\$ 8,040,000	\$ 7,797,393	\$ 0	\$ 7,797,393
Library improvements	335,000	337,455	98,150	0	98,150
Public safety vehicles and improvements	6,400,000	6,678,226	6,678,227	1,105,189	7,783,416
Fire station and land	1,400,000	1,400,000	1,400,000	0	1,400,000
Edwards Park gymnasium	2,000,000	3,006,178	3,006,178	0	3,006,178
Recreational park projects	2,400,000	2,400,000	1,553,208	0	1,553,208
Roads, streets, and bridge projects	15,000,000	16,328,338	16,305,669	878	16,306,547
City of Dalton	24,525,000	26,567,961	26,567,961	0	26,567,961
City of Cohutta	485,000	485,000	485,000	0	485,000
City of Tunnel Hill	700,000	700,000	700,000	0	700,000
City of Varnell	315,000	315,000	315,000	0	315,000
Total	<u>\$ 61,600,000</u>	<u>\$ 66,258,158</u>	<u>\$ 64,906,786</u>	<u>\$ 1,106,067</u>	<u>\$ 66,012,853</u>
<u>2020 SPLOST</u>					
Courthouse improvements	\$ 6,000,000	\$ 6,829,931	\$ 6,903,769	\$ 356,997	\$ 7,260,766
Correctional Center improvements	850,000	2,865,000	2,518,207	200,967	2,719,174
Fire Dept. debt payoff, improvements, and vehicles	4,667,743	4,667,743	2,250,687	24,989	2,275,676
Animal Control projects	200,000	270,802	281,439	14,458	295,897
Library improvements and technology	1,200,000	1,200,000	232,108	275,807	507,915
Roads, streets, and bridge projects, and public works equipment	9,396,450	9,396,450	12,948,209	2,184,637	15,132,846
Public safety vehicles	1,469,252	2,711,468	3,658,724	661,971	4,320,695
Sewer improvements, Carbondale, Connector 3, Cleveland Highway	4,942,500	4,942,500	3,317,239	14,971	3,332,210
Westside Park/Miracle Field improvements and field construction	2,300,000	2,300,000	3,162,608	18,230	3,180,838
R'bend Park construction, infrastructure, community center, and fields	13,000,000	16,119,065	16,260,841	0	16,260,841
Rocky Face Ridge Park improvements	300,000	300,000	284,728	0	284,728
Bond interest	700,000	700,000	607,481	0	607,481
City of Dalton	19,099,000	25,154,842	30,212,261	0	30,212,261
City of Cohutta	378,560	378,560	378,560	0	378,560
City of Tunnel Hill	490,945	490,945	490,945	0	490,945
City of Varnell	1,005,550	1,005,550	1,005,550	0	1,005,550
Total	<u>\$ 66,000,000</u>	<u>\$ 79,332,856</u>	<u>\$ 84,513,356</u>	<u>\$ 3,753,027</u>	<u>\$ 88,266,383</u>

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF PROJECTS FINANCED WITH SPECIAL
PURPOSE LOCAL OPTION SALES TAX
For the year ended December 31, 2025

Project	Estimated Cost *		Expenditures		
	Original	Current	Prior Years	Current Year	Total
<u>2024 SPLOST</u>					
Fire station renovations, equipment, and vehicles	\$ 6,950,000	\$ 6,950,000	\$ 0	\$ 3,865,051	\$ 3,865,051
Correctional Center improvements	1,100,000	1,100,000	0	16,153	16,153
Courthouse improvements	1,200,000	1,200,000	0	0	0
Sheriff's Firing Range and Training Center improvements	51,000	51,000	0	0	0
Prater's Mill renovations	478,000	478,000	0	33,130	33,130
First Responder/Transit building	85,000	85,000	0	284,697	284,697
Public Safety radios and phone systems	3,000,000	3,000,000	0	156,205	156,205
Roads, streets, and bridge projects, and public works equipment	28,100,000	28,100,000	1,783,386	4,433,058	6,216,444
Sheriff's Office vehicles and equipment	1,830,950	1,830,950	0	346,834	346,834
Edward's Park improvements, equipment, and vehicles	2,250,000	2,250,000	0	1,050,918	1,050,918
Westside Park improvements, Community Center and Gymnasium	4,050,000	4,050,000	0	409,996	409,996
Rocky Face Ridge Park improvements	150,000	150,000	0	0	0
Sewer and infrastructure improvements	900,000	900,000	148,153	0	148,153
City of Dalton	26,815,050	26,815,050	1,219,493	8,982,950	10,202,443
City of Cohutta	592,000	592,000	592,000	0	592,000
City of Tunnel Hill	752,000	752,000	752,000	0	752,000
City of Varnell	1,696,000	1,696,000	1,696,000	0	1,696,000
Total	<u>\$ 80,000,000</u>	<u>\$ 80,000,000</u>	<u>\$ 6,191,032</u>	<u>\$ 19,578,992</u>	<u>\$ 25,770,024</u>
Sheriff Expenditures Financed by Issuance of Debt				<u>2,754,275</u>	
Total Expenditures for 2024 SPLOST Capital Projects Fund				<u>\$ 22,333,267</u>	

* Estimated cost represents the portion of these projects to be financed with Special Purpose Local Option Sales Tax. Actual costs that are in excess of these amounts have been financed through alternative funds.

WHITFIELD COUNTY, GEORGIA
SCHEDULE OF SUPPLEMENTAL OFFICIAL INCOME
For the year ended December 31, 2025

County Constitutional Officer	Supplemental Income Type	Amount Collected	Amount Disbursed	Amount Retained by County Officer
Tax Commissioner	Fee for collection of sales taxes	\$ 18,000	\$ 0	\$ 18,000